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CITY OF BERKELEY

BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL REGULAR MEETING

June 16, 2026

WEBVTT

1
00:00:36.230 --> 00:00:39.029
Boardroom: I've got a cut on my hand, so I'm wearing this in solidarity.

2
00:00:39.340 --> 00:00:43.470
Boardroom: You know, he always has a band-aid. Oh.

3
00:00:46.190 --> 00:00:49.179
Boardroom: He ain't even calling him our president.

4
00:00:49.720 --> 00:00:53.470
Boardroom: Hey, Ben. He didn't have any…

5
00:00:54.490 --> 00:01:06.729
Boardroom: Definitely, definitely win. Oh, God. Alright. Can you imagine just, like, Miro or something?

6
00:01:08.360 --> 00:01:20.780
Boardroom: Is this your school? No, I texted me. I think so, yeah. Yep, come on in. Yeah, but… Alright. Good evening, everyone. I'm calling the meeting to order.

7
00:01:21.420 --> 00:01:33.029
Boardroom: Today is Tuesday, June 16th, 2026, and it is 6.03 p.m. Clerk, can you please start us off? Okay, calling the roll, Councilmember Kesarwani.

8
00:01:33.480 --> 00:01:34.380
Rashi Kesarwani: Here.

9
00:01:34.810 --> 00:01:36.970
Boardroom: Taplin? President.

10
00:01:37.170 --> 00:01:42.849
Boardroom: Bartlett? Here. Dragub? Pleasant. OP? Here. Blackaby?

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11
00:01:42.850 --> 00:01:43.660
Brent Blackaby: Cheer.

12
00:01:44.120 --> 00:02:01.639
Boardroom: Lupara? Here. Humbert? Present. And Mayor Ishii? Here. Okay, all present. And Councilmember Kesarwani is participating, remotely for this meeting under the Just Cause, exemption in the Brown Act.

13
00:02:02.180 --> 00:02:07.589
Boardroom: A quorum of the councils participating in person at the noticed physical meeting location.

14
00:02:07.860 --> 00:02:21.859
Boardroom: And, Councilmember Kessarwani, please provide a general circumstances relating to your need to appear, remotely, but do not disclose any medical diagnosis or other confidential medical information.

15
00:02:22.830 --> 00:02:24.230
Boardroom: Like… Huh.

16
00:02:24.230 --> 00:02:26.430
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes, I have a childcare need.

17
00:02:26.430 --> 00:02:36.650
Boardroom: Okay. And please disclose, if there's any individuals 18 years of age or older present with you, and their relationship to you.

18
00:02:36.650 --> 00:02:39.509
Rashi Kesarwani: Nobody over 18 is here.

19
00:02:39.510 --> 00:02:58.039
Boardroom: Okay, and Councilmember Kessarani will participate through both audio and visual technology, so we can proceed. Thank you so much. Okay, so we will move on to our ceremonial matters, and for this evening, we are honoring the life of Bertha Brown.

20
00:02:58.130 --> 00:03:10.670
Boardroom: I believe her family is here. Yes, come on up! And feel free, I know there might be some other folks here from Parks and Rec or other city staff. Feel free if you'd also like to come towards the front.

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00:03:11.920 --> 00:03:13.920
Boardroom: Hi, welcome.

22
00:03:14.660 --> 00:03:28.279
Boardroom: So this evening, first of all, I want to say I'm sorry for your loss. And, this evening, we have both a proclamation, and we will also be adjourning in memory on behalf of Bertha Brown.

23
00:03:29.570 --> 00:03:32.890
Boardroom: Honoring the life of Bertha Brown.

24
00:03:32.910 --> 00:03:57.899
Boardroom: Whereas for over 30 years, Bertha Brown served as a dedicated City of Berkeley employee, working with youth and teens in the Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront Department. And whereas in 1989, Bertha started with the City as a recreation activities leader for the Young Adult Project, cultivating dance programs, talent shows, and positive messaging for teens throughout Berkeley. From 2008 until her retirement in 2019, she served as the

25
00:03:57.900 --> 00:04:22.860
Boardroom: Recreation Coordinator at the Frances Albreyer Community Center, where she initiated the Tots Around Town and Pre-Kindergarten classes, and successfully expanded the program with grant funding to several other parks and recreation sites in Berkeley. She also oversaw the Longfellow Summer Playground Program, the Latino Parenting Program, and the Young Mothers Program, whereas she further served her community as a member of the City's Human Welfare and Community Action

26
00:04:22.860 --> 00:04:24.050
Boardroom: Commission.

27
00:04:24.050 --> 00:04:44.890
Boardroom: And whereas, through her integrity, compassion, dependability, and strong work ethic, Bertha earned the respect and appreciation of colleagues, leaders, community members, and teens throughout the South Berkeley community. She will be remembered for her incredible creativity, off-the-chart dance moves, end-of-summer performances with staff, and pure love for the arts.

28
00:04:44.980 --> 00:04:57.259
Boardroom: And whereas Bertha Brown had a tremendous impact on the success, stability, and positive spirit of the Young Adult Project and Francis Albreyer Community Center, impacting multiple generations of Berkeley teens.

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29
00:04:57.280 --> 00:05:14.009
Boardroom: Now, therefore, be it resolved that I, Adina Ishii, Mayor of the City of Berkeley, hereby recognize and honor Bertha Brown for her years of dedicated service to our city, and express sincere gratitude for her outstanding contributions, loyalty, and commitment to the Berkeley community.

30
00:05:15.130 --> 00:05:16.919
Boardroom: If you'd like to say a few words.

31
00:05:17.060 --> 00:05:26.630
Boardroom: I just want to say, thank you to everyone for their, warm wishes, their prayers.

32
00:05:26.730 --> 00:05:31.439
Boardroom: And, just continue to keep us the family.

33
00:05:31.600 --> 00:05:35.559
Boardroom: In your thoughts and prayers. Thank you to the City of Berkeley.

34
00:05:36.270 --> 00:05:40.750
Boardroom: I just want to say, my mom loved Berkeley. She was…

35
00:05:41.060 --> 00:05:59.430
Boardroom: a community member when she was working here, and even after retirement. Her impact just on people has been amazing to hear the stories, and I'm so honored, and we thank you for honoring her for her commitment to the City of Berkeley. Thank you.

36
00:05:59.830 --> 00:06:06.419
Boardroom: Thank you so much for sharing your mother with us, and thank you to Scott, who also was the one who requested this as well.

37
00:06:28.680 --> 00:06:30.459
Boardroom: Yes, okay, yes.

38
00:06:37.310 --> 00:06:38.320
Boardroom: You all know what to do?

39
00:06:40.790 --> 00:06:42.450
Boardroom: Yeah.

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40
00:06:44.490 --> 00:06:45.520
Boardroom: Family Israel.

41
00:07:03.180 --> 00:07:04.320
Boardroom: Likewise.

42
00:07:35.430 --> 00:07:44.690
Boardroom: We have it, during our ceremonial matters, we actually have a brief training from Chris Lynch, I believe, who's here. Oh, there you are.

43
00:08:09.190 --> 00:08:17.909
Boardroom: Feel free whenever you're ready. Okay. Well, we were going to put the presentation up, but I know you have handouts, so why don't I start? Mark, do you think you'll be able to get it, or…

44
00:08:20.950 --> 00:08:25.969
Boardroom: Okay. Don't know if we do have handouts.

45
00:08:28.280 --> 00:08:29.059
Boardroom: Here we go.

46
00:08:30.000 --> 00:08:38.219
Boardroom: I do not have any doubt, Steve. Thank you. Madam Mayor, members of the City Council, my name's Chris Lynch. I work at a law firm called Jones Hall.

47
00:08:38.309 --> 00:08:44.559
Boardroom: We regularly work with the city as bond council and disclosure counsel when the city undertakes bond financings.

48
00:08:44.650 --> 00:09:02.200
Boardroom: In anticipation of a June 30 council meeting, at which you'll be asked to consider and approve, two bond issuances, the City Attorney asked me to come and provide some disclosure training. We have done this regularly over the years in anticipation of similar events.

49
00:09:02.200 --> 00:09:09.599
Boardroom: So my message, in a nutshell, is first, federal securities laws apply to the city when they issue bonds.

50

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00:09:09.760 --> 00:09:14.009
Boardroom: And also when they provide continuing disclosure related to those bonds.

51
00:09:14.070 --> 00:09:28.870
Boardroom: They also apply to other information or disclosures that are intended to reach investors, so I'll describe some of those other disclosures. Second, city staff and elected officials are expected to take reasonable steps

52
00:09:28.870 --> 00:09:46.060
Boardroom: to ensure that the City's disclosure includes all material facts, which are facts that a reasonable investor would take into consideration. And then third, the City has adopted written policies and procedures that should ensure that the City, complies with federal securities laws in these contexts.

53
00:09:46.810 --> 00:09:48.159
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

54
00:09:49.250 --> 00:09:55.990
Boardroom: I'll describe briefly the key federal securities laws, and then your policies and procedures.

55
00:09:56.760 --> 00:10:14.499
Boardroom: The Securities Act of 1933 and the Securities Act of 19… Securities Exchange Act of 1934 were adopted after the Great Depression, when widespread fraud adversely affected investors. The 1934 Act created the Securities and Exchange Commission, which is the federal agency that enforces

56
00:10:14.500 --> 00:10:22.770
Boardroom: federal securities laws, and so the 33 Act, the 34 Act, and two SEC rules, 10B5 and 15C212,

57
00:10:22.770 --> 00:10:29.509
Boardroom: regulate your behavior when you issue bonds. Most importantly, they prohibit fraud in the offer or sale of securities.

58
00:10:29.540 --> 00:10:45.259
Boardroom: Rule 10B5 requires that communications to investors contain all material facts and not mistake material facts. And a material fact is any fact that a reasonable investor, given the circumstances, would actually impact their decision to buy or sell your bonds.

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59
00:10:45.450 --> 00:10:46.370
Boardroom: Next slide.

60
00:10:47.400 --> 00:10:52.470
Boardroom: So… SEC Rule 15C212,

61
00:10:52.820 --> 00:11:07.129
Boardroom: requires an issuer of bonds to prepare a disclosure document at the time it issues the bonds. That document's called an official statement, and it is prepared by the issuer's staff with the assistance of municipal advisors and bond counsel and disclosure counsel like us.

62
00:11:07.130 --> 00:11:17.119
Boardroom: It has to include all material facts, which are the terms of the bonds and the financial information and operating data that are relevant to that particular series of bonds. Next slide.

63
00:11:18.200 --> 00:11:22.299
Boardroom: Rule 15C212 also requires continuing disclosure.

64
00:11:22.400 --> 00:11:38.229
Boardroom: And that continued disclosure includes updates on an annual basis of the financial information and operating data that were in the original disclosure document, and timely notice of certain events, such as rating changes, bankruptcies, defaults, draws on credit enhancement.

65
00:11:38.450 --> 00:11:39.430
Boardroom: Next slide.

66
00:11:40.280 --> 00:11:46.569
Boardroom: So, as I mentioned, on June 30, the City Council will be asked to approve two official statements.

67
00:11:46.650 --> 00:11:56.700
Boardroom: Related to the issuance of general obligation bonds. Those bonds will be payable from taxes paid by taxable properties in the city, and one for issue of

68
00:11:56.710 --> 00:12:10.180
Boardroom: bond… for bond… or tax and revenue anticipation notes. Now, those notes are paid… they have a one-year maturity date, and they're paid from any unrestricted funds that the city receives in fiscal year 26-27.

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69
00:12:10.320 --> 00:12:17.350
Boardroom: In the official statement for each of those bonds, the city will have an Appendix A that describes the city's general fund.

70
00:12:17.670 --> 00:12:34.779
Boardroom: Now, the city has given… sorry, the Securities and Exchange Commission has given clear guidance to what it expects elected officials and employees of the city involved in a bond issuance should do when they are faced with a decision of approving of an official statement related to bonds.

71
00:12:35.040 --> 00:12:52.140
Boardroom: In 1994, Orange County declared bankruptcy. They declared bankruptcy because they had pursued an investment strategy of issuing short-term notes and investing in risky investments to achieve high above-market rate of returns. They were relying on those above-market turns to balance their budget.

72
00:12:52.520 --> 00:13:06.949
Boardroom: The County Board of Supervisors approved official statements for those notes, and never disclosed the risks associated with those risky investments. It also didn't disclose the risks associated with the county's dangerously underfunded budget.

73
00:13:07.270 --> 00:13:14.869
Boardroom: In the wake of the bankruptcy, the Securities and Exchange Commission issued a report that described what it expects elected officials to do.

74
00:13:15.000 --> 00:13:32.169
Boardroom: The report highlighted that the supervisors were aware of the risky investment scheme and the county's reliance on it to balance its budget, but did not do anything to ensure that that risk was disclosed to investors. And then the SEC said what elected officials should do.

75
00:13:32.200 --> 00:13:49.939
Boardroom: the SEC wrote that officials are expected to take steps appropriate under the circumstances to ensure that the disclosure includes all material facts. Now, that could mean, when you get the official statement for the bonds and the notes next week, that you could read it word for word, but I'm not sure the SEC thinks that's…

76
00:13:49.950 --> 00:14:01.490

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Boardroom: realistic. They do think that if you are aware of some fact that could adversely affect the city's ability to repay those bonds or notes, that you would make sure it was disclosed in the disclosure document.

77
00:14:02.350 --> 00:14:14.520
Boardroom: The bottom line was that the SEC wrote that, that public officials may not authorize disclosure while recklessly disregarding facts that indicate there's a risk that the disclosure may be misleading. Next slide.

78
00:14:15.880 --> 00:14:22.650
Boardroom: So in training sessions like this, I like to include this slide because it highlights what the SEC thinks

79
00:14:22.810 --> 00:14:35.009
Boardroom: cities and other local agencies should do in order to comply with federal securities laws. First, they should adopt written disclosure policies and procedures. In 2017, the City of Berkeley adopted written policies and procedures.

80
00:14:35.010 --> 00:14:47.160
Boardroom: It established a disclosure working group that consists of the city's finance director, the accounting manager, and other members of staff that are relevant to the appropriate, to the particular financing.

81
00:14:47.690 --> 00:14:54.000
Boardroom: The disclosure group also will consult with officials, like the city's outside municipal advisors and a law firm like ours.

82
00:14:54.210 --> 00:15:04.610
Boardroom: At the time the bond are issued, the disclosure group will make sure that the official statement complies with federal securities laws before it sends it to the City Council for approval.

83
00:15:04.690 --> 00:15:15.679
Boardroom: The staff report will describe your responsibilities under federal securities laws and highlight key sections of the official statement, so you know where to look if you'd like to.

84
00:15:16.400 --> 00:15:19.769
Boardroom: The Disclosure Working Group also looks at continuing disclosure reports.

85

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00:15:20.080 --> 00:15:34.980
Boardroom: However, I want to point out that your disclosure policies also highlight that there may be other information distributed by the city in addition to its official statements and its audited financial statements and its continued disclosure that may be subject to federal securities laws.

86
00:15:34.980 --> 00:15:50.690
Boardroom: In 2013, the City of Harrisburg had failed to file its continued disclosure filings, and the SEC concluded that misleading information on the City's website and a misleading State of the City speech by the mayor were subject to federal securities law and had violated it.

87
00:15:51.650 --> 00:15:52.909
Boardroom: Next slide.

88
00:15:53.440 --> 00:15:57.460
Boardroom: Oh, sorry, stay, stay where we are, I apologize. Second, issuers should…

89
00:15:57.510 --> 00:16:17.160
Boardroom: Provide appropriate training to elected officials and employees involved in the bond training. So the city does that in three ways. First, I'm here tonight, give you this brief training. Second, you received a memorandum from the city attorney that included the Orange County report that I mentioned earlier. And then third, the staff report for each of the financings will summarize this information for a third time.

90
00:16:17.310 --> 00:16:28.709
Boardroom: Third, local agencies should disclose the big picture issues. The city of San Diego had an enforcement action for violations of federal securities laws brought against it by the SEC.

91
00:16:28.710 --> 00:16:46.570
Boardroom: In it, the SEC noted that the city had approved official statements that included misleading audited financial statements. The city had not disclosed its underfunded pension liabilities that was adversely affecting the city's ability to operate its various services.

92
00:16:46.950 --> 00:16:59.059
Boardroom: Fourth, local agencies should disclose good facts with bad facts. It's tempting to treat your official statement for bonds like a marketing piece and focusing on your strengths, but it's really important to focus on the good facts and the bad facts.

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93
00:16:59.350 --> 00:17:05.819
Boardroom: Finally, the SEC thinks you should work with competent auditors and other consultants to make sure you comply with these rules.

94
00:17:06.109 --> 00:17:06.960
Boardroom: Next slide.

95
00:17:07.310 --> 00:17:22.989
Boardroom: For many issuers, the big picture that the SEC thinks you should disclose has something to do with pensions and OPEBs. But it could also be litigation, it could be the impending departure of a large employer and a ratepayer, it could be a deferred public infrastructure work.

96
00:17:22.990 --> 00:17:38.410
Boardroom: It could be a structural imbalance in your budget. So when you get the official statement for the notes and the bonds, for your consideration on June 30, you'll see in Appendix A that we spend a fair amount of time talking about the city's reserve policies and how… where they are in their funding levels.

97
00:17:38.410 --> 00:17:56.199
Boardroom: You'll see a substantial amount of disclosure about pension and other post-employment benefits, or OPEB. You'll also see a discussion of the auditor's recent report on the unfunded liabilities and unfunded infrastructure needs, and then the structural imbalance in the general fund. Next slide.

98
00:17:56.680 --> 00:18:04.299
Boardroom: Or, I guess you're ahead of me now. Go back one, if you don't mind. Finally, you should know, that the SEC has punished individuals

99
00:18:04.440 --> 00:18:20.799
Boardroom: when they acted with an intent to defraud or recklessly disregarded information that should have been disclosed to investors. In Orange County, the two individuals' responsibility for their scheme, which were the Treasurer and assistant treasurer, the SEC concluded they had knowingly committed fraud, and they received fines and a jail sentence.

100
00:18:20.800 --> 00:18:25.630
Boardroom: In San Diego, the SEC brought securities law charges against a broad array of city staff.

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101
00:18:25.630 --> 00:18:34.700
Boardroom: And again, the SEC alleged that they had, reviewed misleading financial statements and allowed them to be published when they, when they were sent out to investors.

102
00:18:34.820 --> 00:18:44.660
Boardroom: So hopefully it's clear that city staff and elected officials should take reasonable steps to ensure that the city's disclosure documents include all material facts.

103
00:18:45.560 --> 00:18:57.500
Boardroom: If you have questions about whether there are facts you're aware of that have been included in the disclosure, you can either read the document, or you can reach out to members of staff or outside consultants to make sure they've been adequately disclosed.

104
00:18:57.650 --> 00:19:00.459
Boardroom: That's all I have, but I'm happy to answer questions.

105
00:19:01.700 --> 00:19:09.709
Boardroom: Thank you very much, Chris. I appreciate you being here and for the brief training, and also thank you to our city attorney for bringing that in the memo.

106
00:19:10.260 --> 00:19:11.130
Boardroom: Thank you.

107
00:19:13.770 --> 00:19:14.900
Boardroom: Okay.

108
00:19:15.520 --> 00:19:28.119
Boardroom: Very good. And, folks all have his contact information at the back of the presentation, so feel free to reach out if you have any additional questions, or, you know, of course, you can also speak to our city attorney.

109
00:19:28.340 --> 00:19:37.699
Boardroom: Alright, moving on to our City Manager comments. Mr. City Manager, do you have any comments this evening? I do not, Madam Mayor, thank you. Thank you. Okay. Public comment on non-agenda matters.

110
00:19:44.950 --> 00:19:48.099
Boardroom: You have to wait to see if your card is chosen.

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111
00:19:49.720 --> 00:19:52.580
Boardroom: Although there's not very many, so probably… I think there's one or two.

112
00:19:54.740 --> 00:20:01.619
Boardroom: So now is the time for public comment on non-agenda matters. If you're on the Zoom and you would like to…

113
00:20:01.780 --> 00:20:06.459
Boardroom: Provide public comments on non-agenda matters. Now is the time to raise your hand.

114
00:20:06.620 --> 00:20:13.379
Boardroom: Do the in-person speakers first, and then we'll go to the online commenters.

115
00:20:36.770 --> 00:20:42.180
Boardroom: Okay, the in-person commenters are…

116
00:20:45.460 --> 00:20:47.949
Boardroom: Angela Jernigan?

117
00:20:48.710 --> 00:20:51.050
Boardroom: Tony Wilkinson.

118
00:20:51.250 --> 00:21:00.470
Boardroom: VOP… Thomas Gregory… And… Devin… maybe Devin Banks?

119
00:21:02.190 --> 00:21:05.839
Boardroom: So, can you come up in any order and… and speak?

120
00:21:06.150 --> 00:21:10.089
Boardroom: And we'll have, one minute per speaker.

121
00:21:10.550 --> 00:21:17.459
Boardroom: And… Go ahead. I'm, I'm concerned, I don't know what my time is, but I have a minute.

122
00:21:17.900 --> 00:21:19.570
Boardroom: And it's on, TikTok.

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123
00:21:20.210 --> 00:21:25.090
Boardroom: I'm concerned about the, the, not having a time to discuss

124
00:21:25.560 --> 00:21:30.060
Boardroom: The question of the… the building of bike,

125
00:21:30.260 --> 00:21:38.540
Boardroom: lanes in the city. Sorry, are you commenting on the bike plan? No. Because that is later on the agenda, it's on the actual agenda.

126
00:21:38.540 --> 00:21:53.669
Boardroom: Oh, it wasn't before, yeah. Right now, we're on public comment on non-agenda matters. Oh, it's on the agenda? Yes, it's on the agenda. Okay, so you're welcome to speak on the consent. I'm sorry? You're welcome to speak on the consent public comment time. That'll be later. Yeah, thank you.

127
00:21:54.220 --> 00:21:57.679
Boardroom: Alright, well, maybe we'll pick another card, then.

128
00:21:58.640 --> 00:22:04.540
Boardroom: We have… Sloan?

129
00:22:05.680 --> 00:22:06.910
Boardroom: Go ahead.

130
00:22:07.730 --> 00:22:23.510
Boardroom: Hello, my name is Reverend Angela Jernigan. I serve ministry in West Berkeley, and I'm here speaking tonight, about the topic you'll be voting on next week in terms of the Community Violence Intervention Live Free funding.

131
00:22:23.510 --> 00:22:43.150
Boardroom: This is a program that was built on a highly effective national model, and it has proven to be… Sorry, this actually is also on the agenda for later tonight, because we're going to be presenting information about it. Oh, okay. But the vote is next week. Yeah. But the agenda item is tonight. It's on the agenda. Okay. Sorry.

132
00:22:43.150 --> 00:22:52.660
Boardroom: Okay, so yeah, so folks, the, the, this public comment period is for items that are not on the agenda this evening. Okay, come on up!

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133
00:22:54.620 --> 00:23:03.109
Boardroom: We saw that the agenda item, we didn't see it as an agenda item immediately, but we just wanted to echo the importance of Live Free's work. Yes, that's true.

134
00:23:06.730 --> 00:23:11.160
Boardroom: You can still speak to it later, I just… not right now. That's all. Okay, just want to make sure.

135
00:23:12.140 --> 00:23:17.520
Boardroom: Hi, I'm assuming the reduction in force plans are not on the agenda, specifically enough to…

136
00:23:17.910 --> 00:23:30.700
Boardroom: warrant later comment? I mean, it's on the budget presentation, so… I would wait till then if that's your preference. Thank you. Thank you. Alright, are there other non-agenda public comments this evening?

137
00:23:32.970 --> 00:23:34.510
Boardroom: Alright, go ahead.

138
00:23:38.230 --> 00:23:43.050
Boardroom: speakers on Zoom, First is Celeste Marks.

139
00:23:47.920 --> 00:23:50.290
Celeste Marx: Good evening, this is Dr. Steven Alpert.

140
00:23:50.460 --> 00:23:55.500
Celeste Marx: During the May 19 Council meeting, Mayor Ish interrupted my public comment remarks.

141
00:23:55.700 --> 00:24:02.730
Celeste Marx: Information provided by the First Amendment Coalition indicates that this was a clear violation of the First Amendment right to free speech.

142
00:24:03.100 --> 00:24:09.749
Celeste Marx: The Ninth Circuit has ruled that prohibiting criticism of specific members of a governing body violates the First Amendment.

143

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00:24:09.990 --> 00:24:17.400
Celeste Marx: Mayor Ishii's answer was, quote, just a reminder not to refer to individual council members, refer to us as a body, please.

144
00:24:17.960 --> 00:24:24.950
Celeste Marx: Moreover, I was not addressing Councilmember Humbert, but instead clearly referring to misinformation on his website displayed on a poster.

145
00:24:25.240 --> 00:24:43.390
Celeste Marx: For government codes 54960, I forward a formal cease and desist letter demanding that the Council acknowledge the violations, make an unconditional commitment henceforth not to interrupt any speaker addressing statements or positions publicly made by an individual council members or by other city officials.

146
00:24:43.700 --> 00:24:55.669
Celeste Marx: For Code 54960.1 and 5, the Council has 30 days to comply with… during an open session of a regular meeting or special meeting, or I can fine… I can… I can file a legal action.

147
00:24:55.670 --> 00:24:57.660
Boardroom: Your minute is over. Thank you.

148
00:24:58.870 --> 00:25:01.510
Boardroom: Next is, Martin.

149
00:25:09.450 --> 00:25:12.459
Boardroom: Martin should be able to unmute.

150
00:25:20.000 --> 00:25:21.529
Boardroom: Last call for Martin.

151
00:25:24.170 --> 00:25:24.930
Martin: Hello.

152
00:25:25.960 --> 00:25:27.060
Martin: Good evening.

153
00:25:28.210 --> 00:25:28.720
Boardroom: Yes, go ahead.

154

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00:25:28.720 --> 00:25:51.839
Martin: I certainly hope that the extended parking meters is not on the agenda this evening. I am Martin Kirkwood. I used to run a Chamber of commerce in San Francisco. I have… was quite concerned about the extended parking meter times. I have certainly seen a variety of cities doing this and seeing reduced economic activity.

155
00:25:51.870 --> 00:25:58.819
Martin: I certainly have seen, turnover rates increase. Also, people avoiding areas

156
00:25:58.880 --> 00:26:13.460
Martin: where extended parking meters, or parking times have been extended. And I was wondering, out loud here, if the city has looked into evening occupancy rates, turnaway rates, merchant support, and what the true economic benefit is

157
00:26:13.660 --> 00:26:30.150
Martin: for the emergence and for the residents and people that want to shop in the area, if it's actually going to harm or if it's going to benefit the city in reaching its $5.3 million deficit. That's my comment, and, have a nice evening.

158
00:26:30.150 --> 00:26:31.250
Boardroom: Thank you.

159
00:26:32.190 --> 00:26:37.619
Boardroom: Okay, next is a caller with a phone number ending in 000.

160
00:26:42.920 --> 00:26:48.939
1510****000: This is Mr. Reid. We're not able to give you paper today because Roy is out of town for a couple of weeks.

161
00:26:49.230 --> 00:26:52.180
1510****000: Second point about the… Parking.

162
00:26:52.580 --> 00:26:56.750
1510****000: Berkeley lost… a lot of… Berkeley businesses lost a lot of businesses.

163
00:26:56.860 --> 00:27:04.010
1510****000: Over the decades, because of parking meter. When I came to Berkeley first, tickets were $3. Now they are $60 plus.

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164
00:27:04.370 --> 00:27:06.000
1510****000: Or 49, whatever it is.

165
00:27:06.380 --> 00:27:07.779
1510****000: That was a mistake.

166
00:27:07.890 --> 00:27:13.889
1510****000: You're reducing your income from business. The more… as you walk around, see how much… how many vacants

167
00:27:14.160 --> 00:27:15.939
1510****000: Spaces in Berkeley.

168
00:27:16.220 --> 00:27:26.790
1510****000: And, it is disgusting. It's really disgusting. You're trying to make money, you try to make more money from a decent place, but actually you're losing money. I mean, from a decent place, you're losing money.

169
00:27:26.890 --> 00:27:28.859
1510****000: I will call later on. Have a good night.

170
00:27:29.040 --> 00:27:31.429
1510****000: I will call you in the next section.

171
00:27:33.910 --> 00:27:34.460
Boardroom: Okay.

172
00:27:34.830 --> 00:27:38.380
Boardroom: Thank you. Next is Della Luna.

173
00:27:41.200 --> 00:27:56.309
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: Hi, I wanted to say that the, the Zoom maneuvering, the camera control, the audio has really been excellent, for the online users, and I really wanted to just comment on that, because, I know…

174
00:27:57.000 --> 00:28:10.350
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: it was the issue before, but it's so good now, so every speaker, we're hearing them clearly, the camera's right there, and so whoever's controlling that, great work, keep it up. Thank

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you. We appreciate you, so we can, hear and see everything as needed. That's it.

175
00:28:11.650 --> 00:28:16.609
Boardroom: Thank you, Della. Thank you for our excellent partners at Berkeley Community Media. Yes.

176
00:28:17.210 --> 00:28:23.560
Boardroom: Thank you for Berkeley Community Media. Next is, Makai Freeman.

177
00:28:35.300 --> 00:28:39.010
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: It's like, hmm… On the internet.

178
00:28:39.770 --> 00:28:41.240
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Hi, I'm teaching them.

179
00:28:41.790 --> 00:28:43.060
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Each of them.

180
00:28:44.790 --> 00:28:46.389
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I'm calling to get in.

181
00:28:47.240 --> 00:28:50.710
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: put on the… Excuse me.

182
00:28:52.610 --> 00:28:56.380
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: fine, for… Parking.

183
00:28:58.180 --> 00:29:02.840
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Me, rely on R.

184
00:29:03.400 --> 00:29:04.850
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Excessive gift.

185
00:29:05.950 --> 00:29:09.509
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And then you can not… Move R.

186
00:29:11.310 --> 00:29:15.040
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Vans, and get… a fine.

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187
00:29:16.100 --> 00:29:17.470
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Financially.

188
00:29:18.150 --> 00:29:19.630
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: negatively.

189
00:29:21.320 --> 00:29:22.690
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: impacted.

190
00:29:23.890 --> 00:29:30.840
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I am wondering… If you will use… And equity name.

191
00:29:31.740 --> 00:29:35.370
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: and staff… Yes, beautiful.

192
00:29:36.440 --> 00:29:37.890
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: to handle these.

193
00:29:39.500 --> 00:29:41.090
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: issues, rare.

194
00:29:41.680 --> 00:29:42.950
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: and the field.

195
00:29:43.900 --> 00:29:45.360
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: person that owns.

196
00:29:47.010 --> 00:29:48.600
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And accessible then.

197
00:29:49.470 --> 00:29:51.020
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: But just, like, brown.

198
00:29:51.700 --> 00:29:53.000
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Maine, huh.

199
00:29:54.070 --> 00:29:55.380
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Excellent.

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200
00:29:55.970 --> 00:30:02.610
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: The second… impact on… registration.

201
00:30:04.480 --> 00:30:05.830
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Thank you so much.

202
00:30:07.840 --> 00:30:09.529
Boardroom: Thank you, Makai. Thank you.

203
00:30:10.200 --> 00:30:12.590
Boardroom: That's the last speaker.

204
00:30:14.230 --> 00:30:22.470
Boardroom: Okay, thank you very much, everyone, for your public comments. Now, I think that many of you were waiting for…

205
00:30:22.580 --> 00:30:29.270
Boardroom: The consent calendar… So… We will move on.

206
00:30:29.510 --> 00:30:39.579
Boardroom: to the consent calendar, starting off with comments from many of my Council colleagues, and please keep in mind, we have a very full agenda this evening, so if you could keep your comments brief, it would be much appreciated.

207
00:30:43.130 --> 00:30:44.470
Boardroom: Councilmember Humbert.

208
00:30:45.240 --> 00:30:52.469
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. Yeah, I will, try to speed through these comments. I just have a few.

209
00:30:53.340 --> 00:30:58.820
Boardroom: As to item number 20, the Memorandum of Understanding with the Berkeley Police Association.

210
00:30:59.140 --> 00:31:02.459
Boardroom: I just want to say that I'm…

211
00:31:02.580 --> 00:31:08.160

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Boardroom: Very pleased that we've reached accord with the Berkeley Police Association on a labor MOU.

212
00:31:08.190 --> 00:31:23.349
Boardroom: We have the best police department in the state, at minimum, and I'm thrilled that we got this done so expeditiously. Thank you to the leadership and membership of the BPA, and thank you to the city's negotiating team, led by HR Director Janelle Rodriguez.

213
00:31:26.870 --> 00:31:34.759
Boardroom: Okay, thank you. Oh, sorry, go ahead. I know I still have a couple. The bicycle plan update, which is item number…

214
00:31:34.760 --> 00:31:52.849
Boardroom: 29 on consent after a lot of hard work and very good work by the members of our Transportation and Infrastructure Commission, our City Manager, Paul Budenhagen, our Fire Chief, David Sprague, our Public Works Interim Director, Wahita Miri and his team, with input by neighbors and our treasured advocacy group.

215
00:31:53.020 --> 00:32:06.189
Boardroom: Walk Bike Berkeley, the bike plan is in very good shape and ready to be put into effect. This is consistent with our climate and street safety goals, and I couldn't be more pleased. We will be designing and building bike infrastructure.

216
00:32:06.440 --> 00:32:18.430
Boardroom: That will serve all users, including our disabled community. We have a very large percentage of Berkeleyans who would ride bikes more if we had safer streets, and this is a big step in that direction.

217
00:32:18.540 --> 00:32:23.560
Boardroom: Thank you for that, everybody. And item 31,

218
00:32:23.790 --> 00:32:28.550
Boardroom: which is Resorcery Org's Mural Reveal and Food Driver Relinquishment.

219
00:32:28.610 --> 00:32:47.140
Boardroom: I want to, and sponsored by, or authored by Councilmember Bartlett, who has offered to make me a co-sponsor, which I'm… would be very privileged to be. $250 I'd like to contribute from my discretionary D8 account.

220

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00:32:47.570 --> 00:32:57.110
Boardroom: And then, item number 33, from Councilmember Luna Parra, United for Health's Moffitt Library Clinic, I'd like to contribute 100 and…

221
00:32:57.260 --> 00:32:59.380
Boardroom: $50. Thank you.

222
00:33:00.940 --> 00:33:04.270
Boardroom: Alright, thank you very much, and Councilmember Lunaparo.

223
00:33:07.340 --> 00:33:21.310
Boardroom: Thank you. I… on item 29, I'm very excited to support the bike plan. I really want to thank the City Manager's Office, Public Works, advocates, the Fire Department,

224
00:33:21.650 --> 00:33:23.830
Boardroom: For all the work that went into this.

225
00:33:24.600 --> 00:33:30.579
Boardroom: It's… I know it's a product of immense and critical work, and I'm so grateful to everyone who participated and provided feedback.

226
00:33:30.760 --> 00:33:36.520
Boardroom: On item 31, I'd like to give $200, and I am…

227
00:33:36.920 --> 00:33:47.910
Boardroom: grateful for my colleagues for supporting item, 33 for the Moffitt Library Clinic, which provides, necessary harm reduction in Southside. Thanks.

228
00:33:48.650 --> 00:33:51.759
Boardroom: Thank you very much. I'm gonna go online to Councilmember Blackaby.

229
00:33:55.520 --> 00:33:57.440
Brent Blackaby: Thanks, Madam Mayor.

230
00:33:57.680 --> 00:34:08.929
Brent Blackaby: We received a number of comments from the public and questions from the public on items 3 through 17. I was wondering, to the city manager and finance staff.

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231
00:34:09.050 --> 00:34:16.250
Brent Blackaby: if we took, for example, just the, measure GG… or, sorry, FF increase, which was item…

232
00:34:16.420 --> 00:34:35.790
Brent Blackaby: 10. Take a second, maybe, just to address that one as kind of an illustrative of the group of, like, how we set that rate, just the process there, just to kind of make that a little more transparent, why we chose a particular tax increase, because I think it's kind of uniform, but I just… we had just one minute just to kind of talk about that, I'd really appreciate it.

233
00:34:36.330 --> 00:34:38.589
Boardroom: Sure, Councilmember Arnott, we have,

234
00:34:38.620 --> 00:34:53.460
Boardroom: Acting Deputy Director Greg Seagraves is on the line, too. I can just say at a high level that all of those taxes, all those items 3 through 16, are taxes that were approved by the voters, and all of the inflators are based on the language that's in the measure that was approved by the voters.

235
00:34:53.460 --> 00:35:01.139
Boardroom: So, it kind of depends on which, you know, which one. The one you pointed out, Greg can speak a little bit more to, he's on the, the,

236
00:35:01.140 --> 00:35:08.050
Brent Blackaby: That would be great. And I think one of the questions is, like, why the PIG versus, you know, which inflator we choose, and all that kind of stuff. Greg, that would be great.

237
00:35:09.080 --> 00:35:11.090
Greg Segraves: Hi.

238
00:35:11.260 --> 00:35:16.499
Greg Segraves: Councilmember Blackbee, I'm Gregsey Graves. So, yeah, as Paul said, the,

239
00:35:17.370 --> 00:35:30.449
Greg Segraves: the specific language of each individual tax measure determines how we set the inflator. I actually don't have the language, I'm sorry, in front of me specifically for GG, but it is whatever the voters passed.

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240
00:35:30.450 --> 00:35:30.990
Brent Blackaby: Got it.

241
00:35:30.990 --> 00:35:55.969
Greg Segraves: And that's for the special assessments that fund services directly. Obviously, the debt service for the bond measures operate a different way. We have, you know, amounts we need to pay to cover the debt service for those bonds, and those are based on the total valuation estimates we get from the county, and we assign a percentage base that gets added as a line item on those taxes to cover the debt service for each one of those bonds.

242
00:35:57.230 --> 00:36:12.770
Brent Blackaby: Great. I noticed on some of these that there was a choice of either using the personal income growth rate or, kind of a more standard CPI, and again, for each of those measures, it's pretty specific, like, you can either choose one

243
00:36:12.770 --> 00:36:27.239
Brent Blackaby: Or one of two, but it's… it's kind of each of the measures has a particular method where each year you reset that rate based on the inflator. And how's… and again, that's just sort of in the measure itself, right?

244
00:36:27.670 --> 00:36:52.569
Greg Segraves: Yeah, so we would look at if there's specific language which identifies a specific inflator we should use, of course we'd use that. If there's a choice or just a generic reference to inflation, we often pick the higher one because it tends to be a leading indicator of the other, so you can kind of… if incomes go up, then prices won't be far behind, and likewise, you know, incomes tend to follow prices if there's

245
00:36:52.570 --> 00:36:53.940
Greg Segraves: inflationary environment.

246
00:36:54.720 --> 00:37:13.569
Brent Blackaby: Okay, great. Okay, I appreciate that. I guess, and the point is, this is sort of… this is done annually, sort of standard practice. We're required to do this annually as part of each measure, and it's sort of, like, kind of just locking in the particular inflator that's… that's indicated in each provision, and we're just sort of codifying that each year.

247
00:37:13.870 --> 00:37:27.139

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Greg Segraves: Yeah, I mean, they tend to be fairly close, those measures, they're both measures of inflation, but yeah, obviously we want the funding that was intended by the voters to keep up with, you know, current economic conditions.

248
00:37:27.140 --> 00:37:31.739
Brent Blackaby: Okay, thank you. That's all I had on that. I just appreciate a little bit of that explanation of what's happening there.

249
00:37:32.030 --> 00:37:45.470
Brent Blackaby: a couple last things, and I'm done. On the discretionary, items, for item 31, on Councilmember Bartlett's item, the District 6 office would like to relinquish $250,

250
00:37:45.580 --> 00:37:55.210
Brent Blackaby: And on item 33, Councilmember Lunapar's item on the Moffitt Library Clinic, we'd also like to relinquish $250. And that's all I've got.

251
00:37:56.260 --> 00:37:59.150
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Moving on to Vice Mayor Trey Gob.

252
00:38:00.290 --> 00:38:04.439
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor.

253
00:38:04.440 --> 00:38:22.610
Boardroom: I would like to thank, the Health, Housing, and Community Services, leadership and team for working and bringing up for approval item 19, which is the Behavioral Health Services Act FI27-29 3-year integrated plan.

254
00:38:22.910 --> 00:38:34.320
Boardroom: This came before me as the, council designate to the, Behavioral Health Commission, and,

255
00:38:34.540 --> 00:38:49.069
Boardroom: While this is a very challenging time, budgetarily, between Prop 1 and other, ways in which, the federal and state budget and county all kind of interface with city.

256
00:38:49.070 --> 00:38:55.289
Boardroom: This is an important plan, to approve if it…

257

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00:38:55.490 --> 00:39:07.889
Boardroom: Would provide uninterrupted service delivery and ensure state compliance for most vulnerable populations, and stabilizing and exp… At least stabilizing the city's safety net services.

258
00:39:08.030 --> 00:39:22.079
Boardroom: On item 20, which is the MOU with the Berkeley Police Association, I just want to, state my appreciation, that we were able to reach this memorandum of Understanding.

259
00:39:22.260 --> 00:39:41.009
Boardroom: Item 23, which is the declaration of Intent for the FY27 Street Lighting Assessment. Thank you to the city staff for, I know this is also an annual, routine process, but want to appreciate,

260
00:39:41.010 --> 00:39:53.089
Boardroom: staff's work on it. Just last week, we had a meeting with some of my constituents, and the importance of street lighting came up, and this makes sure we have the funding to do that. On item 29,

261
00:39:53.270 --> 00:40:06.669
Boardroom: which is the bicycle plan update. I would like to just echo, my gratitude that's already expressed by my colleagues. I know that city staff,

262
00:40:06.670 --> 00:40:16.490
Boardroom: And, members of the public did a lot of work on this for a number of years. to the,

263
00:40:16.490 --> 00:40:28.120
Boardroom: we did receive comments, from members of the disability community, and I just want to say, you know, this, this issue is,

264
00:40:28.120 --> 00:40:36.750
Boardroom: near and dear to my heart, and, conferred with staff and my understanding. This is a plan, and,

265
00:40:36.750 --> 00:40:38.370
Boardroom: staff,

266
00:40:38.390 --> 00:40:57.850
Boardroom: who, is committed, as is the Council, to ensuring that, going forward, implementation is done, consistent with the plan. So there will be further conversations. This is not the, the end-all, be-all.

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267
00:40:59.620 --> 00:41:22.279
Boardroom: I want to thank, on item 32, my co-sponsors, Councilmembers Lunapara and Bartlett, for adopting, this is our support item to adopt a support position for SB954 to address non-housing CEQA exemptions for industrial manufacturing and environmental health protections.

268
00:41:22.570 --> 00:41:35.030
Boardroom: And finally, I would like to contribute $150 each to, from my G13 account to items 31 and 33. Thank you. Thank you very much. Councilmember Bartlett.

269
00:41:35.200 --> 00:41:41.680
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. I'd like to, first off, go ahead and call out here.

270
00:41:42.170 --> 00:41:48.530
Boardroom: That's okay, while you're looking, I'm just gonna say on deck is Councilmember Taplin, then Councilmember O'Keefe, then Councilmember Kesarwani.

271
00:41:48.900 --> 00:41:51.530
Boardroom: Great, thank you. Item 30…

272
00:41:51.980 --> 00:42:09.900
Boardroom: 33, this is the Moffitt Library, event clinic. I want to thank, Councilman for this forward, who donated $200 to this. And I'm really pleased to be a part of item 32, this, further rationalizing the CEQA, rules to make it

273
00:42:10.270 --> 00:42:17.099
Boardroom: Make life easier to do things we need to need in this state. And lastly, 31, our item, this is,

274
00:42:17.160 --> 00:42:36.869
Boardroom: Resorcery.org, they are a wonderful, food pantry, and as we know, due to the budget cuts in the federal government and the increased need, food is at an all-time, all-time need. Food banks are going empty. People are selling food in the streets now.

275
00:42:36.870 --> 00:42:44.670
Boardroom: Hunger has hit home in Alameda County in California, and so, groups like Resourcecry.org.org, Resorcery.org.

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276
00:42:44.670 --> 00:42:48.159
Boardroom: They really go a long way. It's a community-building place.

277
00:42:48.160 --> 00:42:53.270
Boardroom: There's gonna be a big mural, an event, it's a food drive. Please come, there'll be prizes.

278
00:42:53.550 --> 00:43:00.730
Boardroom: There'll be kids and smiles, there'll be, happy people, you can come to your civic duty, just come to the event, and I thank my colleagues for donating.

279
00:43:02.080 --> 00:43:04.340
Boardroom: Alright, thank you very much, Councilmember Taplin.

280
00:43:04.640 --> 00:43:14.210
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. Good evening, everyone. On item 29, I echo the remarks of my colleagues. On item 31 and 33, I would like to relinquish $250 to each. Thank you.

281
00:43:14.330 --> 00:43:16.560
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember O'Keefe.

282
00:43:18.370 --> 00:43:25.010
Boardroom: I'll be brief, like Councilmember Taplin, yes, thank you to everyone who did everything, lots of great stuff on here.

283
00:43:25.220 --> 00:43:33.469
Boardroom: Trying to save time. And I'd like to be recorded as donating $200 for items 31 and 33, and thank you to the, sponsors for bringing those.

284
00:43:35.260 --> 00:43:38.669
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Alright, moving on to Councilmember Kisarwani.

285
00:43:39.330 --> 00:43:57.759
Rashi Kesarwani: Thank you very much, Madam Mayor. I'd like to be recorded as donating $100 each to item 31 for Resorcery Org's Mural Reveal, and food drive, and Item 33, United for Health's Moffitt Library Clinic, and thank you to the authors of those two items.

286

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00:43:57.760 --> 00:44:04.170
Rashi Kesarwani: And I also wanted to express my gratitude for seeing the bike plan on the consent calendar tonight.

287
00:44:04.170 --> 00:44:05.120
Rashi Kesarwani: Thank you.

288
00:44:05.610 --> 00:44:21.419
Boardroom: Thank you very much, and to add to that, from my office 30… for items 31 and 33, $250 for each. Thank you both for bringing those forward. And thank you so much to city staff for all the work that's gone on with the bike plan. It can be very challenging to.

289
00:44:21.420 --> 00:44:28.440
Boardroom: Meet with all the constituents, and work with city staff, and make sure folks are on board. So thank you all so much for that work.

290
00:44:28.440 --> 00:44:40.849
Boardroom: And, I just wanted to clarify for folks that were concerned about fire danger with the bike plan, that the fire department will still need to review any complete street plans, so I know that that was a concern, I wanted to bring that up.

291
00:44:40.850 --> 00:44:48.980
Boardroom: And that's it from me, and is there any public comment on consent calendar or information items only?

292
00:44:49.160 --> 00:44:49.899
Boardroom: I think…

293
00:44:54.520 --> 00:44:55.520
Boardroom: Come on up!

294
00:45:01.630 --> 00:45:14.189
Boardroom: Good evening, Berkeley City Council. Amori Langmo, President of the Berkeley Firefighters Association, Local 1227. Behind me, there are 30 firefighters here, on their own free time, because of the current biannual budget.

295
00:45:14.190 --> 00:45:30.639
Boardroom: proposes the elimination of 20 positions. Even if the sales tax passes, 11 of those positions… Sorry, are you talking about the budget? Yes. Because that's not on the consent calendar. It's an action

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item that's later this evening, so, if you can wait until we have that item come up. Alright. Thank you so much. Alright.

296
00:45:34.920 --> 00:45:37.810
Boardroom: Hi, I'm Teo. Hi, I'm Teo Passell.

297
00:45:38.120 --> 00:45:47.740
Boardroom: Thank you all so much for all your kind words about the bike plan. I'm very much in support of it, and I would basically just encourage y'all to think about and work with staff on

298
00:45:47.930 --> 00:45:53.030
Boardroom: To what degree can it be relatively automatically implemented with a minimum of

299
00:45:53.330 --> 00:46:06.140
Boardroom: you know, disruption, turmoil, you know, revisiting to the council, multi-year debates, things like that. So, thank you all for your support of it, and hopefully we will see it go through. Thank you. Thank you.

300
00:46:09.800 --> 00:46:28.859
Boardroom: Hey, good evening. Jeff Lomax. So, after this evening, the sales tax rate in Berkeley will probably be approximate… on track to hit 11.5%, which is really going to hit our small businesses. Most of those small businesses… Sorry, the sales tax is… I'm getting there. Okay. Thank you. Can I have my time back, please? Thanks.

301
00:46:28.920 --> 00:46:35.069
Boardroom: Small businesses are really struggling. A lot of business owners actually work day jobs or multiple jobs.

302
00:46:35.090 --> 00:46:53.519
Boardroom: So, one thing you could do, and this would probably improve revenues on your sales tax, is why not give them a pass this year on the inflators? You already taxed them at 30% higher. So, I'm sorry, what item are you referring to on the agenda? Because if you're talking about the sales tax, it's actually an action item.

303
00:46:53.520 --> 00:47:08.790
Boardroom: May I finish? So, let me explain. Yes, go ahead and tell me which item that you're referring to. You are voting on a set of inflators that are going to… for all those parcel taxes, small businesses are already taxed at a 30% higher rate for reasons that are

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304
00:47:09.050 --> 00:47:28.650
Boardroom: I don't even understand, because they're certainly not piling into the libraries. So, as a gesture, and probably an economically rational choice, why not give a pass on those inflators, at least for the businesses on the commercial side? They're already paying tremendously higher parcel taxes, and you're later going to…

305
00:47:29.050 --> 00:47:37.719
Boardroom: pass a sales tax increase based on the premise that they're going to be generating the revenue for you. So a rational economic approach would be

306
00:47:37.910 --> 00:47:50.239
Boardroom: Give them a break on the back end, because at 11.25%, you will see a serious decline in revenues from sales tax, because that's how economics works. Thank you.

307
00:47:50.950 --> 00:47:52.140
Boardroom: Thank you.

308
00:47:52.420 --> 00:47:53.370
Boardroom: Coming up, Tom.

309
00:47:56.610 --> 00:48:14.339
Boardroom: Consent Calendar. Item 29, the bike plan. Once again, yes, thank you very much. I was able to participate in a number of, public workshops, and I'm just really happy with what we've accomplished.

310
00:48:14.510 --> 00:48:17.430
Boardroom: And, thank you again for passing it. Thanks.

311
00:48:18.130 --> 00:48:19.499
Boardroom: Thank you, Carol.

312
00:48:23.380 --> 00:48:34.790
Boardroom: Carol Morasovic. Speaking to item 19, there were… there's been a lot of misunderstanding about this transition from the mental health services

313
00:48:34.850 --> 00:48:52.930
Boardroom: act through the Behavioral Health Services Act. I want to clarify a couple of things. For example, the excellent Options Encampment

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Wellness team, which has been great, is actually, part of the plan that will be going forward, and after we.

314
00:48:53.230 --> 00:48:54.659
Boardroom: move forward through…

315
00:48:54.850 --> 00:49:11.359
Boardroom: input from review from Human Resources, and also meet and confer with the unions, presuming this is passed tonight. Options will be getting, actually, an extended contract through June 30th, 2029.

316
00:49:11.780 --> 00:49:27.809
Boardroom: And this refers to the AB339 process. Also, the mental health trauma monies, they will continue. These are monies to the underserved populations, such as African American, LGBTQ. Thank you. Thanks, Carol.

317
00:49:29.050 --> 00:49:34.799
Boardroom: Anyone else online have public comment for consent calendar and information items only, please?

318
00:49:35.040 --> 00:49:37.369
Boardroom: Yes, we currently have 8 hands raised.

319
00:49:37.870 --> 00:49:39.739
Boardroom: First is Charles Siegel.

320
00:49:43.150 --> 00:49:55.259
Charles Siegel: Hello, I'm speaking on behalf of Walk Berkeley to urge you to pass item 29, the bike plan revision. It's a good bike plan.

321
00:49:55.420 --> 00:50:09.639
Charles Siegel: And I want to thank staff for all the work they've done, listening to public input. Just listening is a lot of work in itself, but also accommodating all the public input. Staff did a great job.

322
00:50:10.010 --> 00:50:19.830
Charles Siegel: And, of course, there'll be more public input as each project is implemented, so we still have a lot of work to do in implementing these projects.

323
00:50:20.080 --> 00:50:26.059
Charles Siegel: But Council… and I also want to thank all the council members who spoke in favor of the bike plan.

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324
00:50:26.260 --> 00:50:33.510
Charles Siegel: So Council could take a step in the right direction by approving the bike and on consent tonight. Thank you.

325
00:50:34.830 --> 00:50:35.960
Boardroom: Thank you.

326
00:50:36.920 --> 00:50:40.000
Boardroom: Okay, next is, Makai Freeman.

327
00:50:46.280 --> 00:50:47.469
Boardroom: Oh, where'd she go?

328
00:50:49.260 --> 00:50:50.319
Boardroom: Oh.

329
00:50:50.320 --> 00:50:51.909
1510****000: So, this is Mr. Eid.

330
00:50:51.910 --> 00:50:52.550
Boardroom: Okay, next.

331
00:50:52.550 --> 00:50:57.810
1510****000: Will you put me first? That's okay. I'm commenting, consent item 20.

332
00:50:58.000 --> 00:50:59.479
1510****000: I like staying in memory.

333
00:50:59.670 --> 00:51:03.629
1510****000: almost Berkeley had one of the greatest police departments in the country.

334
00:51:03.800 --> 00:51:11.470
1510****000: Alex, in memory of the great express chief Dash Butler, who, in 1980s.

335
00:51:11.720 --> 00:51:20.260
1510****000: who had embezzlement in our San Francisco store. Over $1 million was embezzled by the, store manager, Robert Friedman.

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336
00:51:20.620 --> 00:51:25.080
1510****000: Not only Robert, excuse me, It's cheap poplar.

337
00:51:25.230 --> 00:51:27.630
1510****000: Help me find a detective tool.

338
00:51:28.280 --> 00:51:33.939
1510****000: to trigger the guide to court, he also appointed two policemen in front of our house in Euclid.

339
00:51:34.060 --> 00:51:39.769
1510****000: For over 2 years. I did pay them $6,000 a month. That was great, pay to him, because the…

340
00:51:39.970 --> 00:51:44.890
1510****000: The bad person threatening my life, my family's life, and my son's life.

341
00:51:45.480 --> 00:51:51.189
1510****000: Again, in memory of ex-Berkeley Police Chief Dus Butler was one of the best.

342
00:51:51.400 --> 00:51:54.200
1510****000: mischief Berkeley have ever had.

343
00:51:54.360 --> 00:51:56.859
1510****000: Thank you, and we'll talk soon.

344
00:51:57.130 --> 00:51:58.050
Boardroom: Thank you.

345
00:51:58.460 --> 00:52:01.300
Boardroom: To Makai Freeman?

346
00:52:06.580 --> 00:52:08.050
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Yeah, cleaning.

347
00:52:08.380 --> 00:52:09.980
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Man count.

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348
00:52:10.780 --> 00:52:12.249
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I have no doubt.

349
00:52:13.940 --> 00:52:15.520
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Public Works did.

350
00:52:17.200 --> 00:52:26.540
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: The heart… Yeah, I… Confirmed, and… A blind death.

351
00:52:27.580 --> 00:52:28.440
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Ended.

352
00:52:30.040 --> 00:52:31.450
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Privacy neat.

353
00:52:36.440 --> 00:52:41.070
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And it's not like… That's too in danger.

354
00:52:42.090 --> 00:52:45.930
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: The friend did not talk… About niggi.

355
00:52:46.680 --> 00:52:48.140
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: The franchise.

356
00:52:49.110 --> 00:52:50.319
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: basically check that.

357
00:52:51.260 --> 00:52:52.860
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Again, not true.

358
00:52:53.860 --> 00:52:57.660
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: That… infrastructure.

359
00:52:59.420 --> 00:53:00.949
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Will not repeat it.

360
00:53:01.850 --> 00:53:06.549
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And going on… Livia, I was… oh, sorry.

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361
00:53:08.030 --> 00:53:09.450
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Hit twice.

362
00:53:10.360 --> 00:53:11.889
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And I cannot get.

363
00:53:12.630 --> 00:53:13.979
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: of my car.

364
00:53:14.740 --> 00:53:16.240
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Going on gang calls.

365
00:53:16.800 --> 00:53:20.559
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Because the rent comes… an ongoing trip.

366
00:53:22.760 --> 00:53:23.960
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I did not know.

367
00:53:24.680 --> 00:53:26.210
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: How many individuals?

368
00:53:26.770 --> 00:53:28.260
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: But this is, this is good.

369
00:53:29.050 --> 00:53:30.490
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Happy injured.

370
00:53:31.200 --> 00:53:32.400
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Enhanced.

371
00:53:33.690 --> 00:53:35.089
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: The plan is building.

372
00:53:35.640 --> 00:53:41.610
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: They, and… incentivize One cup, please.

373
00:53:42.390 --> 00:53:43.780
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: over another.

374

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00:53:44.420 --> 00:53:48.040
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: This is a very… Bethany snub.

375
00:53:48.880 --> 00:53:50.250
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Mr. Nathan?

376
00:53:50.800 --> 00:53:52.260
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And margin.

377
00:53:53.530 --> 00:53:54.630
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: All right.

378
00:53:55.460 --> 00:53:57.040
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Desserts for the stage.

379
00:53:57.570 --> 00:53:59.080
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I count this thing.

380
00:53:59.740 --> 00:54:03.210
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And I think… Not displightful.

381
00:54:03.940 --> 00:54:05.440
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Not this new world.

382
00:54:07.030 --> 00:54:08.410
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Sweet. Green.

383
00:54:11.060 --> 00:54:11.570
Boardroom: Thank God.

384
00:54:11.570 --> 00:54:15.930
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I plan, the acting count.

385
00:54:16.500 --> 00:54:18.259
Boardroom: Thank you, Makai.

386
00:54:18.930 --> 00:54:20.960
Boardroom: Okay, next is Kelly.

387
00:54:24.890 --> 00:54:27.500

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Kelly’s iPad: Yes, can you hear me okay?

388
00:54:27.500 --> 00:54:28.360
Boardroom: Yes.

389
00:54:28.870 --> 00:54:31.099
Kelly’s iPad: Okay, on the bike plan.

390
00:54:31.460 --> 00:54:32.460
Kelly’s iPad: of…

391
00:54:32.680 --> 00:54:41.499
Kelly’s iPad: What I don't see happening when… with the $85 million that it looks like we're going to spend on this bike plan.

392
00:54:41.760 --> 00:54:59.810
Kelly’s iPad: is an assessment of before and after. We really need to do bicycle counts before we do the infrastructure, and we need to follow up with bicycle counts afterwards to see if we are successful in increasing the number of bicycle riders.

393
00:55:00.190 --> 00:55:10.620
Kelly’s iPad: Because the last bicycle counts that were done by the community show, no significant increase in bicycle riders.

394
00:55:10.620 --> 00:55:29.019
Kelly’s iPad: So we really, we really need to follow up with this, and also figure out which configuration is really the most utilized and the most successful. And we can't do that unless we do continue to do bicycle counts on a regular basis.

395
00:55:29.320 --> 00:55:30.140
Boardroom: Thank you.

396
00:55:31.230 --> 00:55:34.149
Boardroom: Next is, Jenny King.

397
00:55:39.030 --> 00:55:49.550
Jenne King: Thank you, Mayor and Council people, especially for your support tonight for Resource Reorg. We're item number 31 on the consent calendar.

398

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00:55:49.910 --> 00:55:53.279
Jenne King: Food security in Berkeley is a big issue right now.

399
00:55:53.580 --> 00:56:00.989
Jenne King: We started a pantry out front of our house a while ago. It's rolled into the need of starting a non-profit.

400
00:56:01.490 --> 00:56:18.590
Jenne King: And so we're having our first fundraiser coming up. I hope everybody comes. But I just want to put this out to the people of Berkeley. We know how to do Berkeley. We know how to feed people and take care of each other, and I really want to challenge everybody

401
00:56:18.590 --> 00:56:28.879
Jenne King: to find a way to make a difference. Right now, we're having incredibly difficult food access problems, and we can all, all do something about it.

402
00:56:29.010 --> 00:56:32.720
Jenne King: So thank you very much, for everybody who's contributing.

403
00:56:32.930 --> 00:56:37.750
Jenne King: And please come and have a piratey good time with us on the 27th.

404
00:56:38.370 --> 00:56:44.039
Boardroom: Thank you so much, and I hope you get a chance to collaborate with Berkeley Food Network as well with your work.

405
00:56:45.060 --> 00:56:47.920
Boardroom: Okay, next is Steven Copeland.

406
00:56:53.080 --> 00:57:02.809
Steven Copeland: Good evening, everyone. I'm assuming you can hear me. I am here on consent item 26, and I'm here on behalf of the second low bidder, Bay Cities.

407
00:57:03.130 --> 00:57:18.069
Steven Copeland: bring the Council up to speed. This is a public works project where, Radius is the apparent low bidder, but when they turned in their bid, they turned in two pages of the first page of the bid with two different pricings.

408

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00:57:18.420 --> 00:57:25.110
Steven Copeland: And then city staff, obtained our,

409
00:57:26.290 --> 00:57:40.299
Steven Copeland: Bid protest, we've gone back and forth in letter writing, but essentially what I wanted to brief you all on this, this, when there is a mathematical mistake, according to case law, and the case law is the Valleycrest case, you can see it within the letters that have been written.

410
00:57:40.410 --> 00:57:43.900
Steven Copeland: It's black-letter law. If there's a mathematical mistake.

411
00:57:44.060 --> 00:57:49.769
Steven Copeland: In a bid, and here there is one, because there are two different numbers for the same bid item.

412
00:57:49.910 --> 00:57:57.129
Steven Copeland: There is no discretion to waive that mistake, and that is what staff is recommending that you do by awarding this job to RADIUS.

413
00:57:57.130 --> 00:57:59.740
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks for your comment.

414
00:58:00.720 --> 00:58:02.920
Boardroom: Next is Helen Walsh.

415
00:58:06.790 --> 00:58:22.910
Helen Walsh♿: Good evening, Mayor Ishii and Council members. I am commenting on consent item number 29. My name is Helen Walsh, and I'm speaking as a Berkeley resident who has been engaged in issues related to accessibility of public right-of-way.

416
00:58:23.370 --> 00:58:33.059
Helen Walsh♿: I support safe mobility of everyone, including people who bike, walk, roll, and drive. My concern tonight is not about opposing bikeways.

417
00:58:33.060 --> 00:58:44.280
Helen Walsh♿: My concern is that the bicycle plan update is a planning document that will guide how the city allocates space in the public right-of-way, and

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418
00:58:44.660 --> 00:58:48.759
Helen Walsh♿: It is being adapted on consent without discussion.

419
00:58:49.120 --> 00:59:04.560
Helen Walsh♿: Residents with disabilities and seniors have repeatedly shared new changes in the public right… in the public right of way can unintentionally create new barriers. Barriers. These are real lived experiences in Berkeley.

420
00:59:04.560 --> 00:59:11.210
Helen Walsh♿: The plan acknowledges disability concerns, but it does not yet include a defined framework of evaluating.

421
00:59:11.210 --> 00:59:11.860
Boardroom: Helen.

422
00:59:11.860 --> 00:59:14.129
Helen Walsh♿: Okay, I sent a letter, too.

423
00:59:14.800 --> 00:59:19.220
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks, Helen, we'll look at your letter. Next is Nancy Rader.

424
00:59:21.110 --> 00:59:32.479
Nancy Rader: Good evening. Yes, Nancy Rader, representing the Berkeley Fire Safe Council. The Fire Safe Council urges you to move Item 29, the bike plan, to the actions calendar to enable discussion of an important issue.

425
00:59:32.530 --> 00:59:48.079
Nancy Rader: Which is that the final plan removes language in the draft plan that major street infrastructure projects will be evaluated for their impact on emergency response times. Instead, the final bike plan states a goal of, quote, balancing the need for new bikeways with the need

426
00:59:48.080 --> 01:00:07.170
Nancy Rader: to preserve and improve emergency personnel response times. This hoarding suggests that the City could sacrifice emergency response times, if necessary, to install bike lanes on major thoroughfares without considering how many residents benefit from emergency response versus bike lanes, or whether adequate alternative bike routes exist.

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427
01:00:07.190 --> 01:00:22.640
Nancy Rader: Therefore, we urge Council to move this item to action to reinstate the language from the final bike plan to assure Berkeley residents that the City's emergency response services will not be compromised without good evidence that street infrastructure projects will deliver greater public safety benefits. Thank you.

428
01:00:22.640 --> 01:00:24.590
Boardroom: Thank you, Nancy.

429
01:00:24.750 --> 01:00:37.309
Boardroom: All right, I think that's it for our public comments. For my council colleagues, is there… oh, 1, 2, 3, 4. Okay, sorry, I just thought we lost Quorum for a second. Did we, is there a motion?

430
01:00:39.170 --> 01:00:41.379
Boardroom: Move to approve. Second.

431
01:00:41.670 --> 01:00:43.530
Boardroom: Can we take the roll on that, please?

432
01:00:44.060 --> 01:00:45.190
Boardroom: Okay…

433
01:00:49.020 --> 01:00:53.229
Boardroom: Okay, to approve the consent calendar, Councilmember Kesarwani?

434
01:00:53.230 --> 01:00:54.000
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

435
01:00:54.750 --> 01:00:57.930
Boardroom: Kaplin? Yes. Bartlett? Yes.

436
01:00:58.070 --> 01:01:01.389
Boardroom: Trey Gibb? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes.

437
01:01:01.630 --> 01:01:02.850
Boardroom: Blackaby?

438

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01:01:02.850 --> 01:01:03.540
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

439
01:01:04.460 --> 01:01:10.020
Boardroom: Luna Parra is… To approve the consent calendar, Councilmember? Yes.

440
01:01:10.070 --> 01:01:14.619
Boardroom: Okay, Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes.

441
01:01:14.620 --> 01:01:30.369
Boardroom: Okay, motion carries. Alright, thank you, everyone. Okay, so I just want to go over what's going to be on the agenda for the rest of this evening as we move on to the action calendar, so folks just have a sense of what's going on, and I know there are a lot of you here who are here to speak about the budget, which is later this evening. So…

442
01:01:30.370 --> 01:01:38.959
Boardroom: 34 is about the residential preferential parking program. We've got…

443
01:01:39.290 --> 01:01:55.579
Boardroom: An item that's coming up, 35 as well, which is policy for disruption of remote participation during council meetings. Both of these items we expect to be relatively quick. Affirming all electric standards for the 2026 infrastructure bond, similarly, not a long presentation.

444
01:01:55.580 --> 01:02:04.509
Boardroom: 37, and through 39 are all about measures, for the potent… potentially for the November 3rd ballot.

445
01:02:04.510 --> 01:02:14.129
Boardroom: This is about language, etc, and so we expect that those will move forward, unless there's a lot of public comment on them. And then…

446
01:02:14.320 --> 01:02:28.359
Boardroom: we have a public hearing about the budget. And so, because last time we didn't get a chance to talk about the CIP, there will be a presentation on the CIP, and then the city manager will present

447
01:02:28.470 --> 01:02:41.689
Boardroom: His budget with staff, I will present my amendments to that budget, we will take Council questions, public comment, and then,

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finally, comments. We will not be voting on the budget this evening, just so folks make sure to know that.

448
01:02:41.890 --> 01:02:52.340
Boardroom: Okay, so we should move forward then to our action item, number 34, implement Residential Preferential parking program on the 1500 block of Delaware Street.

449
01:02:52.340 --> 01:03:08.840
Boardroom: I'll pass it over to Interim Director Amiri. Thank you. Good evening, Madam Mayor, Council Members Wahit Amiri, Interim Director of Public Works. This item is a standard RPP opt-in request for the south side of the 1500 block of Delaware Street. Tonight, I have with me

450
01:03:08.920 --> 01:03:21.229
Boardroom: Joshua Brett, who is one of our Public Works Assistant and Transportation Planners with the Go Berkeley program. He'll share a few slides with you guys, and then we'll open up for any questions or comments you might have.

451
01:03:23.480 --> 01:03:24.566
Boardroom: Okay,

452
01:03:34.220 --> 01:03:34.910
Boardroom: Patience.

453
01:03:35.690 --> 01:03:36.570
Boardroom: Sorry.

454
01:03:38.870 --> 01:03:40.280
Boardroom: Ugh, wait, no, I want this.

455
01:03:43.350 --> 01:03:44.450
Boardroom: It's fine.

456
01:03:44.550 --> 01:03:47.450
Boardroom: Yeah.

457
01:03:50.540 --> 01:04:02.960
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor, Mayor Ishii, City Council members… Yeah, speak right into the mic. Yeah, good evening, Mayor Ishuu, City Council members, the City Clerk, as,

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458
01:04:02.970 --> 01:04:11.949
Boardroom: Director… Interim Director Wahita Miri just said, it is a standard, residential preferential parking opt-in program.

459
01:04:13.310 --> 01:04:30.440
Boardroom: So, this is for the south side of the 1500 block of Delaware Street. And what we did, we took… initially did a parking serv… we initially, received the signatures of

460
01:04:30.600 --> 01:04:47.430
Boardroom: residents of this block. There are 11 residential addresses in total, and we obtained 9 signatures. The minimum of 51% of residents have to sign the petition for opt-in, so this is 82% in favor, so it's well above

461
01:04:47.460 --> 01:05:01.029
Boardroom: That, then after that, in… on February 4th, of this year, went twice to check the occupancy levels on that block of the street at 11 a.m.

462
01:05:01.030 --> 01:05:19.299
Boardroom: 10 out of 12 spaces were occupied, or 83%. The same. At 2.30 PM, 10 out of 12 spaces were also occupied, and 75% is the minimum parking occupancy percentage to be eligible for an RPP opt-in, so that is also above the minimum.

463
01:05:19.580 --> 01:05:27.409
Boardroom: And here, at attachment 2, you can see highlighted is the block face that is opting in.

464
01:05:27.650 --> 01:05:31.389
Boardroom: We included, in addition to the 1500 block.

465
01:05:31.510 --> 01:05:44.860
Boardroom: We included 1800 California on that, because their property directly abuts the block face where there will be RPP enforcement if this motion passes.

466
01:05:48.000 --> 01:06:00.940
Boardroom: And notices were mailed to affected residents, and they were posted on the block 14 days prior to this hearing, as well as, posted out in front of the Modell-Surec, building on MLK.

467

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01:06:02.920 --> 01:06:13.130
Boardroom: Here's a little timeline of the implementation. We received the completed petition on February 3rd. The next day, I went and performed the parking occupancy survey.

468
01:06:13.190 --> 01:06:26.040
Boardroom: Because this block is on Ohlone Park, we did, outreach to stakeholders in the Ohlone Park, informing them that this would be going before Council. That includes the Friends of Ohlone Park.

469
01:06:26.040 --> 01:06:36.830
Boardroom: as well as the several soccer clubs that use the field there. And the only response we got, we… was positive.

470
01:06:36.980 --> 01:06:40.489
Boardroom: And so, here we are tonight, on June 16th.

471
01:06:40.670 --> 01:06:45.850
Boardroom: or the City Council report, and if this mor… if this…

472
01:06:46.110 --> 01:07:01.079
Boardroom: Measure passes, we will be… begin the installation, we'll install 3 RPP signs, between June 30th and July 14th, and after those signs are installed, parking permit enforcement will begin.

473
01:07:02.020 --> 01:07:06.449
Boardroom: Thank you, Mayor and Council. This concludes the report.

474
01:07:06.570 --> 01:07:13.659
Boardroom: Thank you very much. You did great. Any questions from staff? Or, sorry, from Council?

475
01:07:14.610 --> 01:07:18.269
Boardroom: No? No questions. Alright, is there any public comments on this matter?

476
01:07:20.760 --> 01:07:24.830
Boardroom: Anyone online? I didn't see anyone.

477
01:07:26.930 --> 01:07:30.160
Boardroom: Okay, very good. Is there any comment from Councilman?

478

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01:07:31.650 --> 01:07:33.350
Boardroom: Someone would like to move the item?

479
01:07:35.520 --> 01:07:40.180
Boardroom: And would… to close the public hearing, sorry, make the motion to close public hearing. So moved. Second.

480
01:07:40.790 --> 01:07:42.350
Boardroom: Can we take the roll on that, please?

481
01:07:43.960 --> 01:07:47.599
Boardroom: Okay, to close the public hearing, Councilmember Kesarwani.

482
01:07:48.600 --> 01:07:49.230
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

483
01:07:49.760 --> 01:07:56.530
Boardroom: Kaplan? Aye. Bartlett? Yes. Tragum? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

484
01:07:56.830 --> 01:07:57.490
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

485
01:07:57.490 --> 01:08:02.190
Boardroom: Unapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mary Ishii? Yes.

486
01:08:02.570 --> 01:08:11.200
Boardroom: All right. Motion is passed. Public hearing is closed. Public hearing is closed, thank you, yes. Alright, does anyone want to make the actual motion? So moved.

487
01:08:12.300 --> 01:08:27.129
Boardroom: Okay, second from Councilmember Partly. Can we take the roll on that, please? Okay, to adopt the, to implement the residential preferential parking program on the 1500 block of Delaware Street, Councilmember Kesarwani?

488
01:08:27.130 --> 01:08:27.960
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

489
01:08:28.260 --> 01:08:34.520

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Boardroom: Kaplan? Aye. Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

490
01:08:34.529 --> 01:08:35.249
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

491
01:08:35.569 --> 01:08:48.349
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mary Ishii? Yes. Okay, motion carries. Motion carries. Item has been passed. Thank you all so much for your presentation, for the work that you put in. Appreciate all of the out,

492
01:08:48.349 --> 01:08:56.829
Boardroom: outreach you did to the community. Thank you. So, alright, moving on to item number 335, Policy for Disruption or remote participation during council meetings.

493
01:08:56.829 --> 01:09:14.699
Boardroom: Would you like to say anything about this? Sure, so just, as a brief introduction, the SB707, which was adopted last year, made several new, amendments and changes and added new provisions to the Brown Act, one of which is.

494
01:09:14.969 --> 01:09:34.609
Boardroom: For legislative bodies that meet remotely, they must adopt a policy, for how they will proceed if there is a disruption of the telephonic or internet service that allows for the remote participation by the public, and this item

495
01:09:35.049 --> 01:09:45.459
Boardroom: brings forward that policy to the Council for approval. It just sort of runs down, the process, if there is an outage.

496
01:09:45.499 --> 01:09:56.329
Boardroom: We announce the disruption, we call for a recess, we engage in good faith efforts to diagnose and restore the disrupted service.

497
01:09:56.609 --> 01:10:16.439
Boardroom: If we cannot restore the service after, one hour, we have to try for at least one hour, the law says. Then, we can reconvene the meeting by action of the Council, or, we could, adjourn the meeting. So…

498
01:10:16.679 --> 01:10:35.529

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Boardroom: This just, sort of codifies what the new state legislation requires, and it's before the Council for approval tonight. Thank you so much. Are there any questions about this item? Councilmember, or Vice Mayor Trav, is that a question? It, it is, thank you.

499
01:10:35.709 --> 01:10:56.769
Boardroom: At the bottom of page 1, there's, 5-1 subpart 4. I was just… I was hoping you could clarify what this means. The meeting shall remain in recess for at least 1 hour, or until service is restored, whichever is sooner. The at least

500
01:10:56.999 --> 01:11:08.359
Boardroom: one hour. I was hoping you could clarify. Yeah, so if there is an outage, And… it's not… restored.

501
01:11:08.579 --> 01:11:12.899
Boardroom: We have to try for at least an hour.

502
01:11:13.339 --> 01:11:18.239
Boardroom: And if it's still not able to be restored, then…

503
01:11:18.519 --> 01:11:27.359
Boardroom: We can engage in the process to reconvene, even if we do not have remote access restored.

504
01:11:27.359 --> 01:11:39.619
Boardroom: So, you have to try for at least 1 hour before moving on to the reconvening portion. However, if it is restored before 1 hour, then you can just proceed with the meeting.

505
01:11:40.359 --> 01:11:43.109
Boardroom: Okay, thank you very much. Other questions?

506
01:11:44.629 --> 01:11:48.239
Boardroom: No? Alright, does not have any public comment on this item?

507
01:11:48.559 --> 01:11:53.819
Boardroom: Again, we're on item number 35, Policy for Disruption of remote participation during council meetings.

508
01:11:55.709 --> 01:12:01.939
Boardroom: I see nobody online or in person. Alright, is… are there any comments from my Councilmember colleagues?

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509
01:12:02.779 --> 01:12:04.559
Boardroom: Is there a motion to approve?

510
01:12:06.949 --> 01:12:08.749
Boardroom: So moved. Okay.

511
01:12:09.359 --> 01:12:13.429
Boardroom: Second. Second. Okay, can you take the role, please, Clerk?

512
01:12:13.709 --> 01:12:20.969
Boardroom: Okay, to approve the policy for disruption of remote participation during council meetings, Councilmember Kesarwani? Yes.

513
01:12:20.970 --> 01:12:21.510
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

514
01:12:21.940 --> 01:12:28.270
Boardroom: Kaplan? Aye. Bartlett? Yes. Tragum? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

515
01:12:28.270 --> 01:12:28.990
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

516
01:12:29.360 --> 01:12:43.569
Boardroom: Unapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mary Ishi? Yes. Okay, motion carries. Alright, thank you all very much. We're moving on to item number 36, Affirming all electric standards for the 2026 Infrastructure Bond Measure and City Capital Projects.

517
01:12:43.570 --> 01:12:50.090
Boardroom: Is someone here from the Environment and Climate Commission that wishes to speak? Yes!

518
01:12:50.440 --> 01:12:51.380
Boardroom: Come on up.

519
01:12:51.510 --> 01:12:59.560
Boardroom: Oh, okay. You are available for questions. Alright, are there any questions from my Councilmember colleagues?

520

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01:13:00.990 --> 01:13:07.239
Boardroom: And there was a supplemental also submitted, so, is there any public comment on this item?

521
01:13:08.940 --> 01:13:17.950
Boardroom: Any public comment on, item number 36, affirming all electric standards for the 2026 infrastructure bond measure and city capital projects?

522
01:13:18.320 --> 01:13:22.949
Boardroom: I see a hand online. Oh, Councilmember Blackaby, I'm sorry, was that a question?

523
01:13:23.440 --> 01:13:26.440
Brent Blackaby: I do have a quick question and comment, but I can do it during my comment.

524
01:13:26.440 --> 01:13:27.120
Boardroom: Oh.

525
01:13:27.830 --> 01:13:28.760
Boardroom: Okay.

526
01:13:29.570 --> 01:13:36.140
Boardroom: I see no other hands for public comment on this one, so let's move to Councilmember comments, and you can start, Councilmember Bell.

527
01:13:36.140 --> 01:13:52.089
Brent Blackaby: Okay, great, thanks. Thanks, Madam Mayor. Really quickly, and to the City Manager, I mean, I think, again, the spirit of this item is wherever possible, and hopefully in every case, we do sort of an all-electric implementation, but I know that the committee

528
01:13:52.090 --> 01:14:05.759
Brent Blackaby: had suggested, and then in your SUP2, you and Director Klein have implemented this idea that there may be rare exceptions where it's not economically feasible or practical.

529
01:14:05.760 --> 01:14:14.470
Brent Blackaby: to do that in a particular case. I just wanted you to kind of… can you talk us through how that might work, and then what the process would be to come to Council in those cases?

530

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01:14:14.640 --> 01:14:39.210
Boardroom: Sure, thank you for the question, Councilmember. I just want to emphasize your earlier part of that point, which is that it is our intention that the infrastructure would be all electric, and we agree with the Commission on that. And as we put in the supplemental, there may be rare instances in which that's just really difficult to do, either from a feasibility perspective, a cost perspective, or some other

531
01:14:39.210 --> 01:14:40.450
Boardroom: their perspective.

532
01:14:40.450 --> 01:14:42.679
Boardroom: And in those cases,

533
01:14:42.700 --> 01:14:49.589
Boardroom: We would have to get council approval, for that sort of a treatment, and we would then, you know, we would bring a formal council item.

534
01:14:49.740 --> 01:14:55.100
Boardroom: Before you, in which that was all explained prior to anything happening.

535
01:14:56.590 --> 01:15:20.249
Brent Blackaby: Okay, that's helpful. So it's… the intent and the spirit is we're going for all-electric in as many cases as we can, unless there's a kind of a rare exception, and you come to us, and we have a discussion, and then we either approve it or don't approve it, but we at least have a conversation about the feasibility and weigh the trade-offs between… maybe it's going to be more expensive, but we think we should do it anyway, or in this case, hey, we'll do this other alternative, because it's just not feasible.

536
01:15:20.570 --> 01:15:21.910
Boardroom: Yes, that's exactly right.

537
01:15:21.910 --> 01:15:29.280
Brent Blackaby: Okay, with that change, I support this, and I appreciate the effort to kind of try and find a way of,

538
01:15:29.420 --> 01:15:40.950
Brent Blackaby: keeping the spirit of this and the clear direction, which is what we want to do, but then we do have an escape valve in those rare occasions where we might need to look at other options, so thank you for making that addition. And that's all I had.

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539
01:15:40.950 --> 01:15:43.820
Boardroom: Thank you very much, Councilmember Blackaby. Councilmember Humbert.

540
01:15:43.840 --> 01:16:03.119
Boardroom: Yes, excuse me, yes, thank you, Madam Mayor, and I thank you, Councilmember Blackaby, for your questions. They sort of dovetail with mine. Well, I don't have questions, but I have comments. And I want to thank our Environment and Climate Commission for bringing this item to us.

541
01:16:03.120 --> 01:16:12.609
Boardroom: I'm strongly in favor of the measure, with the supplemental language supplied by our city manager and planning director, whom I thank for engaging with this important item.

542
01:16:12.690 --> 01:16:35.210
Boardroom: We absolutely want to use low-carbon emitting electric infrastructure, but we need the flexibility in very limited and exceptional circumstances to repair or install, say, gas infrastructure. I hope we'll not have to do this and use this exception, and as time passes and technology improves, the chances of having to do so will lessen, I'm confident.

543
01:16:35.320 --> 01:16:51.499
Boardroom: I do… would like to make a friendly amendment, if this is appropriate, and, add, the following language, both as a new, therefore, be it resolved clause.

544
01:16:51.810 --> 01:16:55.179
Boardroom: And it would read as follows.

545
01:16:55.750 --> 01:17:09.590
Boardroom: The City Council's authority to grant exceptions to the all-electric construction and electrification requirements is a legislative discretionary act, and neither the granting

546
01:17:09.720 --> 01:17:24.619
Boardroom: nor the denial of any such exception shall give rise to any claim or cause of action in any court. And the reason I think this should be added is to ensure that if we have a priority project, for example, pool improvements.

547

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01:17:24.910 --> 01:17:40.579
Boardroom: that, heaven forbid, require an exception. We don't want to create a situation where a council decision and the subsequent project can be tied up for years in litigation, perhaps even due to motivations that have nothing to do with natural gas use. I just want to make sure that

548
01:17:40.660 --> 01:17:55.480
Boardroom: you know, that things can work efficiently. So, I guess I would ask the city attorney, did you listen to the language that I, that I read? Is that something that you think is appropriate?

549
01:17:55.480 --> 01:18:04.770
Boardroom: from your perspective as our counselor. I did listen. It doesn't seem to raise a red flag for us. Okay. So I'd like to, I'd like to,

550
01:18:05.440 --> 01:18:12.860
Boardroom: I'd like to move the item, with the supplemental and my friendly… my friendly amendment. Second.

551
01:18:14.890 --> 01:18:20.249
Boardroom: Thank you, that… those are my comments. Thank you. Councilmember… Vice Mayor Trega, please.

552
01:18:20.770 --> 01:18:30.599
Boardroom: Thank you. I would also like to thank the Environment and Climate Commission for bringing this forward.

553
01:18:30.650 --> 01:18:41.689
Boardroom: and to staff for all your work over the last few days. My office, has been, discussing

554
01:18:41.840 --> 01:18:57.490
Boardroom: possible, language, and the, the city manager supplemental, pretty much captures it, and I, I think the amendment we just heard is, reasonable.

555
01:18:57.490 --> 01:19:02.580
Boardroom: I would just like to confirm with the city manager,

556
01:19:02.580 --> 01:19:17.520
Boardroom: Would it be your intention to make every, feasible effort to pursue grants, to help offset, any costs associated with electrification?

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557
01:19:17.570 --> 01:19:27.410
Boardroom: Be it the Bay Area Air District, or, other regional, state, and maybe one day, again, federal entities.

558
01:19:28.600 --> 01:19:37.379
Boardroom: Yes, Councilmember, it absolutely would be. As I said, we are also very committed to the objective of all electrification, and

559
01:19:37.510 --> 01:19:43.840
Boardroom: That would include us Seeking grant funding to bridge a gap if need be.

560
01:19:44.890 --> 01:19:45.900
Boardroom: Thank you.

561
01:19:46.320 --> 01:19:49.909
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Any other comments from my Council colleagues?

562
01:19:50.210 --> 01:19:55.590
Boardroom: Is there… There was already a motion and a second, so can we take the roll on that, please?

563
01:19:56.330 --> 01:20:13.389
Boardroom: Okay, to, approve the, resolution from the Environment and Climate Commission, as revised in the, with the changes from the staff supplemental, and the new resolve clause added by Councilmember Humbert. On the motion, Councilmember Kesarwani?

564
01:20:13.390 --> 01:20:13.960
Rashi Kesarwani: Yeah.

565
01:20:14.790 --> 01:20:17.769
Boardroom: Yes? Taplin? Aye.

566
01:20:17.960 --> 01:20:23.409
Boardroom: Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

567
01:20:23.410 --> 01:20:24.150
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

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568
01:20:24.660 --> 01:20:29.350
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes.

569
01:20:29.520 --> 01:20:37.919
Boardroom: Okay, motion carries. Thank you very much to the Commission, to Commission staff, for being here, for answering our questions, and also just for the work that you did on this.

570
01:20:38.580 --> 01:20:49.939
Boardroom: Alright, very good. We are moving on to item number 37, placing a Charter Amendment measure on the November 3rd, 2026 ballot to amend multiple administrative provisions. Mr. City Clerk?

571
01:20:51.180 --> 01:20:53.970
Boardroom: Yes, so this is a…

572
01:20:54.470 --> 01:21:00.089
Boardroom: Charter Amendment that primarily covers various,

573
01:21:00.740 --> 01:21:17.400
Boardroom: topics related to elections, candidates, recall, initiative, referendum, a sort of a whole slate of, electoral, reforms for the… and language amendments for the charter,

574
01:21:17.710 --> 01:21:24.929
Boardroom: There was a, sort of, comprehensive supplemental number one, where each of the…

575
01:21:26.180 --> 01:21:33.620
Boardroom: Proposed warning changes have a description and, and comments, sort of an annotated,

576
01:21:34.000 --> 01:21:52.759
Boardroom: comments for each, proposed amendment. If you have any questions about any particular proposed changes, I'm happy to review them, or if you'd like me to sort of, run down a quick summary of the proposed changes, I'm happy to do that as well.

577
01:21:53.170 --> 01:22:08.820
Boardroom: I just want to thank you for the changes, and appreciate you bringing this forward, cleaning up this language, and also the fact that they consider also protections for our elected officials, I think is

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important, because, unfortunately, we're in a time where our elected officials are being threatened with violence.

578
01:22:08.820 --> 01:22:14.949
Boardroom: stalked and harassed. So, thank you very much for that. Do my council colleagues have any questions?

579
01:22:17.430 --> 01:22:21.359
Boardroom: Okay, is there any public comment on this item?

580
01:22:21.780 --> 01:22:29.230
Boardroom: This is item number 37, placing a charter amendment measure on the November 3rd, 2026 ballot to amend multiple administrative provisions.

581
01:22:30.360 --> 01:22:31.950
Boardroom: Anyone online?

582
01:22:32.210 --> 01:22:43.590
Boardroom: No, no hands raised. Okay, so, for our council comment period, I'm curious if any folks are interested in being involved with,

583
01:22:45.520 --> 01:23:03.590
Boardroom: filing the ballot measure arguments on this measure as provided for in the Elections Code Section 9282. I know I am interested in being involved with this, but would love to have at least one or two more folks join me. Yes, Councilmember Taplin is interested? Any other council members interested in writing arguments with me?

584
01:23:04.120 --> 01:23:09.650
Boardroom: Don't worry, there's plenty more for us to work on later. So, okay, alright.

585
01:23:09.890 --> 01:23:14.280
Boardroom: Very good. Well, Councilmember Tappman will be joining us. Are you sure, Councilmember Lunifora?

586
01:23:15.060 --> 01:23:38.000
Boardroom: Yeah, sure. Alright, she's gonna join us, very good. We call that voluntelling someone, so, alright, very good. Any other comments, this evening? Otherwise, I'd like to make a motion that we adopt this resolution, and then designate by motion that Councilmember Taplin, Mayor Ishii, and Councilmember Lunapara work on the ballot measure arguments. Second. Second, yeah.

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587
01:23:38.070 --> 01:23:53.769
Boardroom: All right, very good. Can we take the roll on that, please? And just to clarify, Mayor, that this also includes those minor formatting corrections that were in the SUP2 packet. Yes, thank you. On the motion, Councilmember Kesarwani?

588
01:23:53.770 --> 01:23:54.980
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

589
01:23:55.350 --> 01:24:02.550
Boardroom: Kaplan? Aye. Bartlett? Yes. Grega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

590
01:24:02.550 --> 01:24:03.600
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

591
01:24:03.600 --> 01:24:21.510
Boardroom: Unapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes. Okay, motion carries. Very good, thank you very much. Moving on to item number 38, placing a general obligation bond measure on the November 3rd, 2026 ballot for the acquisition or improvement of real property for public infrastructure and facilities.

592
01:24:21.640 --> 01:24:39.110
Boardroom: I'm going to pass it over to City Manager. Thank you. Thank you, Madam Mayor. I don't have a lot of comments. Our team has presented on this before, so you all have seen this. I want to thank our City Attorney Brown, and Deputy City Attorney Sam Harvey, for their work putting the language together.

593
01:24:39.170 --> 01:24:55.649
Boardroom: I will note that we did also submit some red lines up on this item that mirror the language in item 36 around the electrification, so that's also part of this bond measure. Very similar language to what you just heard on item 36.

594
01:24:55.700 --> 01:25:05.229
Boardroom: We have folks here who are available to answer questions if you have any, but we don't have any presentation. Thank you very much. Are there any questions from my Councilmember colleagues?

595
01:25:08.220 --> 01:25:21.530

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Boardroom: Okay. Is there any public comment on this item? We're on item number 38, placing a general obligation bond measure on the November 3rd, 2026 ballot for the acquisition or improvement of real property or public infrastructure and facilities.

596
01:25:22.410 --> 01:25:23.869
Boardroom: Anybody online?

597
01:25:26.500 --> 01:25:34.109
Boardroom: I do not see anybody out there. For this item. Alright, let's have Councilmember Humbert start us off with comments.

598
01:25:34.220 --> 01:25:48.399
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. I want to thank staff and the City Manager's Office, the Finance Department, Public Works, Parks, and others for all their work preparing this bond measure. It was an Herculean task.

599
01:25:48.530 --> 01:25:56.980
Boardroom: Consistent with my friendly amendment above on item 36, I'd like to please add the following language.

600
01:25:57.110 --> 01:26:06.270
Boardroom: both as a new whereas clause in Section 1 findings, and a new bullet in Section 2, Object and Purpose of Bonds.

601
01:26:07.000 --> 01:26:17.210
Boardroom: And it's essentially the same language. The City Council's authority to grant exceptions to the all-electric construction and electrification requirements

602
01:26:17.210 --> 01:26:27.330
Boardroom: is a legislative discretionary act, and neither the granting nor the denial of any such exception shall give rise to any claim or cause of action in any court.

603
01:26:28.760 --> 01:26:35.080
Boardroom: So I'd move that, as a friendly amendment. Move the item, too. Second.

604
01:26:35.470 --> 01:26:40.020
Boardroom: Hold on a minute, I want to get a chance to hear from our Council on this.

605

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01:26:42.170 --> 01:26:47.330
Boardroom: I mean, of course, feel free to make the motion and all that, but would like to hear from our council.

606
01:27:10.990 --> 01:27:13.079
Boardroom: We're just checking one thing.

607
01:27:56.370 --> 01:28:12.799
Boardroom: While our council, and when I say council, I don't mean the council, I mean our council, our attorneys are discussing this, just folks, if you can be thinking about if you'd like to be involved with the, ballot measure arguments on this item and also the next. Just think about it.

608
01:28:13.260 --> 01:28:17.600
Boardroom: If we can take, like, a 2-minute recess to discuss one thing…

609
01:28:18.810 --> 01:28:27.450
Boardroom: Would you like to see a copy of the language? You haven't. Alright, we're gonna take a brief recess so that we can review the language. Thank you.

610
01:28:29.950 --> 01:28:49.350
Boardroom: Okay, thanks, everyone. We are back. So, again, we are on item number 38, which is about the general obligation bond, and we just heard back from Council, so if you wouldn't mind summarizing for us your recommendation, please. Yes, Madam Mayor. So, our recommendation is to just strike the word legislative.

611
01:28:49.420 --> 01:29:00.260
Boardroom: So it says, the City Council authority to grant exceptions to the all-electric construction and electrification requirement is discretionary.

612
01:29:00.330 --> 01:29:10.820
Boardroom: And then it goes on to say, and neither the granting nor the denial of any such exception shall give rise to any claim or cause of action in any court.

613
01:29:10.880 --> 01:29:22.620
Boardroom: And then, in addition to that, we think that it would be advisable to add a severability clause to the bond measure language itself, and we're going to read that into the record.

614

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01:29:23.390 --> 01:29:41.090
Boardroom: Great, so this will be added as new, Section 7. If any word, phrase, sentence, part, section, subsection, or other portion of this measure, or any application thereof to any person or circumstance is declared void, unconstitutional, or invalid for any reason, then such word, phrase, sentence, part, section, subsection, or other portion

615
01:29:41.150 --> 01:30:06.040
Boardroom: Or the prescribed application thereof shall be severable, and the remaining provisions of this measure and all applications thereof, not having been declared void, unconstitutional, or invalid, shall remain in full force and effect. The people of the City of Berkeley hereby declare that they would have passed this measure, and each section, subsection, sentence, clause, and phrase thereof, irrespective of the fact that any one or more sections, subsections, sentences, clauses, or phrases have been declared invalid or unconstitutional.

616
01:30:06.040 --> 01:30:06.730
Boardroom: institutional.

617
01:30:07.290 --> 01:30:22.350
Boardroom: Thank you, Sam, for reading that in, and thank you… I would add those to my motion. Okay. You're not gonna repeat them? I'm just kidding, sorry. Alright, are there any other, oh, yes, comments now, and Councilmember Taplin, would you like to start?

618
01:30:22.440 --> 01:30:35.280
Boardroom: Yes, thank you very much. I wanted to thank City Admin and the departments, as well as the Mayor's Vision 2050 Refresh Task Force, and I wanted to volunteer to, help draft the ballot argument.

619
01:30:35.890 --> 01:30:44.889
Boardroom: Very good, thank you so much. Would anyone else like to join me? I think Councilmember Trey Gubb, you had mentioned Vice Mayor Trey Gubb, and oh, oh, also, oh, oh my gosh.

620
01:30:44.990 --> 01:31:03.579
Boardroom: Alright, I think we can have one, two… we can have up to four, right? Okay, can I put you on the sales tax, then? Because I know that, Councilmember Blackaby is also interested, so… Okay, so there will be Councilmember Blackaby, Vice Mayor Trey Gubb, and Councilmember Taplin, and myself.

621
01:31:04.290 --> 01:31:05.950
Boardroom: Yes, but there's a word limit.

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622
01:31:06.990 --> 01:31:12.259
Boardroom: Okay, thank you very much.

623
01:31:12.740 --> 01:31:23.080
Boardroom: Would someone like to make that, well, you have that motion, we had a second, we're adding on those 4 people.

624
01:31:23.180 --> 01:31:25.570
Boardroom: So can we take the roll, please?

625
01:31:26.750 --> 01:31:29.090
Boardroom: Oh, sorry, thank you. Public comment.

626
01:31:29.320 --> 01:31:34.779
Boardroom: Is there any public comment on item number 38, placing a general obligation bond measure?

627
01:31:35.260 --> 01:31:37.200
Boardroom: on the November 3rd ballot.

628
01:31:38.880 --> 01:31:40.949
Boardroom: There's someone online.

629
01:31:43.090 --> 01:31:46.009
Boardroom: speaker online, Steve.

630
01:31:48.780 --> 01:31:49.300
Boardroom: Go ahead.

631
01:31:49.300 --> 01:31:53.969
steve: Oh, good evening. Actually, this is Isabel Gaston, District 6.

632
01:31:54.180 --> 01:32:03.980
steve: Calling because I wanted to remind you that, When you started working on Projects for the bond.

633
01:32:04.980 --> 01:32:08.540
steve: The inflation was 2.4%.

634
01:32:09.680 --> 01:32:15.530

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steve: inflation, is now… 4.2%.

635
01:32:15.980 --> 01:32:20.100
steve: Now, that means that inflation has increased.

636
01:32:20.270 --> 01:32:21.340
steve: Over.

637
01:32:21.490 --> 01:32:23.300
steve: 50%.

638
01:32:23.990 --> 01:32:27.810
steve: That means it's going to be really tough for you guys to do all these projects.

639
01:32:28.240 --> 01:32:32.990
steve: Because when inflation is high, Construction costs escalate.

640
01:32:33.090 --> 01:32:38.570
steve: This is going to stall all these projects, lead to budget overruns.

641
01:32:38.700 --> 01:32:42.110
steve: And require even higher tax revenues.

642
01:32:42.300 --> 01:32:48.840
steve: or debt to complete. So when you vote on this tonight, You are voting, knowing.

643
01:32:49.660 --> 01:32:50.740
steve: Knowing.

644
01:32:51.510 --> 01:33:01.020
steve: That inflation has gone up 50%, it could go up from 4.2%, it could go up to 6%. You have to take this into consideration.

645
01:33:01.450 --> 01:33:02.400
steve: Please.

646
01:33:02.810 --> 01:33:05.300
steve: Mayor and City Council, thank you.

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647
01:33:08.710 --> 01:33:13.329
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Our… Are there any other public comments? That's it.

648
01:33:15.160 --> 01:33:17.679
Boardroom: Okay, thank you very much.

649
01:33:18.170 --> 01:33:20.529
Boardroom: Alright, can we take the roll, please?

650
01:33:20.640 --> 01:33:23.849
Boardroom: Okay, so this is on the motion, placing the…

651
01:33:24.300 --> 01:33:28.290
Boardroom: General obligation bond on the November 3rd, 2026 ballot.

652
01:33:28.330 --> 01:33:44.710
Boardroom: Including the amendments read in by the City Attorney, and also the severability clause, with the authors designated being Mayor Ishii, Councilmembers Blackaby, Tregub, and Taplin. On the motion, Councilmember Kesarwani.

653
01:33:44.920 --> 01:33:45.710
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

654
01:33:45.930 --> 01:33:53.259
Boardroom: Kaplan? Aye. Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

655
01:33:53.260 --> 01:33:53.940
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

656
01:33:54.430 --> 01:34:08.040
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes. Okay, motion carries. Alright, thank you all so much. We're moving on to item number 39, and then we will take a brief break. We're doing great on timing. Thank you, everyone.

657
01:34:08.040 --> 01:34:16.069
Boardroom: Item number 39 is placing a transactions and use sales general tax measure on the November 3rd, 2026 ballot.

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658
01:34:16.660 --> 01:34:35.569
Boardroom: And, yes, did you have anything you wanted to say on this one, Mr. City Manager? No, just that, again, thanking City Attorney Brown, Deputy City Attorney Harvey for the bond language… for the language of the measure, and also thanking staff for working on it, the leadership of Deputy City Manager White,

659
01:34:35.840 --> 01:34:53.950
Boardroom: And I'll just also give a shout out to Councilmember Castewani, who was, really pushing on this very early on, when we were all thinking about it. So, thank you, Councilmember, for, generating the idea and, staff for putting it together. Thank you very much. Are there any questions from my Council colleagues?

660
01:34:55.650 --> 01:35:05.750
Boardroom: Is there any public comments on this item? Item number 39, placing a transaction and sales use sales general tax measure on the November 3rd, 2026 ballot?

661
01:35:09.480 --> 01:35:16.809
Boardroom: I do not see any hands online. Nope. Oh. Oh, one. Isabelle… Isabel. Who's listed as Steve. Yes.

662
01:35:17.690 --> 01:35:19.539
steve: Hi, it's Steve here again.

663
01:35:19.760 --> 01:35:22.109
steve: Isabel Gaston, District 6.

664
01:35:22.270 --> 01:35:36.509
steve: I commented on this, once before, at the Budget and Finance Committee, and I just wanted to reiterate, that, you know, this is really going to be hard for low-income folks.

665
01:35:36.630 --> 01:35:51.840
steve: And, you know, Ben Bartlett, Councilmember Bartlett, sorry, I know I'm not supposed to mention people's names. You know, he already mentioned how people are hurting food-wise. My husband actually works at the food bank, too, and there's been an enormous uptick

666
01:35:52.160 --> 01:35:53.160
steve: And…

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667
01:35:53.910 --> 01:36:05.509
steve: a sales tax is regressive, we all know that, and I really think you should think long and hard. This is not a good time to do this. In fact, I think it's actually quite cruel.

668
01:36:05.710 --> 01:36:18.879
steve: And it's really pushing people to places that really… it's just… you're gonna make people leave, you know, businesses and residents. Thank you very much.

669
01:36:20.150 --> 01:36:21.330
Boardroom: Thank you, Isabelle.

670
01:36:22.700 --> 01:36:26.989
Boardroom: Oh, one more speaker. We have Michael Katz.

671
01:36:31.600 --> 01:36:43.740
Michael Katz: Good evening. Respectfully, I just want to reiterate what the last speaker said. The outlook for this does not look good. If you look at other East Bay sales tax measures this month. People are really squeezed by inflation.

672
01:36:44.090 --> 01:36:50.790
Michael Katz: They're questioning what they're getting from all levels of government, and I know you folks try really hard, and the city's in a bad way, but…

673
01:36:51.220 --> 01:37:01.139
Michael Katz: This is a regressive tax. In combination with the countywide… or the region-wide sales tax. It would give us one of the highest regressive sales tax rates in the country.

674
01:37:01.290 --> 01:37:15.860
Michael Katz: And regressive taxes hit the poor the worst. As a university city, we have a substantial population that has negative income. Students don't earn, they pay tuition and fees. So, again, I would urge you to consider

675
01:37:16.490 --> 01:37:18.539
Michael Katz: alternatives to this. Thank you.

676
01:37:19.080 --> 01:37:20.050
Boardroom: Thank you, Michael.

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677
01:37:20.810 --> 01:37:32.479
Boardroom: We have a speaker here in person. Yeah, Jeff, again. So, yeah, so we've got an economic downturn and high inflation. That's, I think, really challenges the assumptions that you're gonna realize the revenue here.

678
01:37:32.970 --> 01:37:44.670
Boardroom: Back to the small businesses, they're now effectively on track for an 11.25% sales tax rate on top of the 5% plus inflators you've just approved, so…

679
01:37:45.100 --> 01:37:51.090
Boardroom: We're creating conditions where, really, the…

680
01:37:51.770 --> 01:38:01.050
Boardroom: ability to conduct retail business in Berkeley is going to be extremely challenging. It's probably going to be no growth to low growth.

681
01:38:01.190 --> 01:38:04.850
Boardroom: With the exception of any growth we get from population increase.

682
01:38:05.070 --> 01:38:06.040
Boardroom: Let's hope.

683
01:38:06.580 --> 01:38:07.460
Boardroom: And…

684
01:38:07.600 --> 01:38:23.459
Boardroom: again, the overhead costs for businesses are already challenging, they've just gone up, and so what you're really gonna end up with, and perhaps we'll get some added sales tax from this, is we're gonna have the most Amazon-friendly city in America, because

685
01:38:23.660 --> 01:38:39.769
Boardroom: trying to cover overhead costs in this city, and I've talked to a lot of business people, I'm not making this up, I hope you have, it is really challenging. And again, adding another aggressive measure, another aggressive tax, and assuming that's going to result in $10 million is…

686
01:38:40.040 --> 01:38:59.240

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Boardroom: I would say extremely optimistic, given the current economic conditions. And people can go outside of Berkeley to find lower sales tax rates on big-ticket items. So what you're left with is people that are gonna pay 11.25% on

687
01:38:59.420 --> 01:39:09.620
Boardroom: things like the smaller purchases, and they're just gonna leave Berkeley for the things that really make a difference. And they're gonna leave Alameda County as well, because that's…

688
01:39:09.620 --> 01:39:23.270
Boardroom: where this overall increase is coming from. But it's going to be worthwhile, because under these conditions, that's what economics does. It causes people to make rational economic choices and go to where is in their economic interest.

689
01:39:24.110 --> 01:39:25.690
Boardroom: Thank you, Mr. Lomax.

690
01:39:26.890 --> 01:39:36.039
Boardroom: Alright, let's move on to my council members' comments. Oh, there's one more. Sorry, there's one more online? Yeah. Oh, apologies.

691
01:39:36.600 --> 01:39:40.660
Boardroom: Last speaker online is Cheryl Davil, a former council member.

692
01:39:43.190 --> 01:39:45.450
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Yeah, I agree with the last…

693
01:39:46.330 --> 01:39:52.379
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: a speaker, and I also feel like all these things, the bond measure.

694
01:39:52.630 --> 01:40:10.060
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: I don't… I mean, how do we know what that money's really gonna go to? Because all the things that… that $100 million… I mean, a lot of the benchmarks didn't get met, so… it's interesting.

695
01:40:10.610 --> 01:40:18.069
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: And, you know… With 47, the fascism, and all these other things.

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696
01:40:18.310 --> 01:40:24.330
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: People are leaving Berkeley. Black and brown people are barely here anymore.

697
01:40:24.510 --> 01:40:29.349
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: And you're making it very, very, very difficult.

698
01:40:29.600 --> 01:40:34.710
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: So… I don't think this is a great idea.

699
01:40:35.400 --> 01:40:42.479
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: And, I know people aren't… well, I don't know. We'll see what happens, but…

700
01:40:42.820 --> 01:40:46.989
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Berkeley's so expensive as it is already.

701
01:40:47.750 --> 01:40:50.469
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: You have all these vacant properties.

702
01:40:51.740 --> 01:41:00.730
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: I don't think this is a wise choice on a lot of the decisions that you are making this evening, and I missed the consent calendar, but…

703
01:41:01.040 --> 01:41:05.859
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: And I know that… Not… you know…

704
01:41:06.220 --> 01:41:12.159
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: that bike plan probably went through. I don't know what happened, but…

705
01:41:12.550 --> 01:41:15.570
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: That doesn't look out for a lot of the other people that.

706
01:41:15.570 --> 01:41:16.689

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Boardroom: I don't know.

707
01:41:16.690 --> 01:41:19.679
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: I understand I'm not, you know, I…

708
01:41:19.680 --> 01:41:21.470
Boardroom: item at hand, thank you.

709
01:41:22.140 --> 01:41:26.019
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: I'm not finished. Do I still have time? Because I can't see the freaking clock.

710
01:41:27.030 --> 01:41:29.070
Boardroom: You have 17 seconds left.

711
01:41:31.740 --> 01:41:42.400
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Free Palestine, end the genocide, free your minds from the evil and disrespectful, rude behaviors that you demonstrate all the time.

712
01:41:44.220 --> 01:41:45.030
Boardroom: Producer.

713
01:41:45.760 --> 01:41:55.960
Boardroom: Okay. That's it. Thank you very much. Moving on to our Councilmember… my Councilmember colleagues' comments, starting with Councilmember Blackaby Online.

714
01:41:57.300 --> 01:42:03.310
Brent Blackaby: Thanks, Madam Mayor, and thanks to Councilmember Cassarwani and staff for putting this together. I also want to acknowledge and

715
01:42:03.390 --> 01:42:11.849
Brent Blackaby: thank the commenters that we heard on this item. I agree that, you know, this is… a sales tax increase is a difficult kind of measure to consider.

716
01:42:11.850 --> 01:42:28.629
Brent Blackaby: I will say that, you know, I… and I've said this a lot over the past 18, 20 months I've been on the council, that my preference over the long term is that, you know, our revenue growth should be driven

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by business activity and housing growth and more productivity that's coming through the system, as opposed to raising taxes.

717
01:42:28.630 --> 01:42:42.860
Brent Blackaby: Where we can. But I will say the one thing that gives me some satisfaction here, that this is the right consideration, is that we're matching and coming into parity with neighboring jurisdictions, and the sales… we're not…

718
01:42:42.860 --> 01:42:52.859
Brent Blackaby: moving out of whack, but we're actually meeting and sort of closing the gap with other jurisdictions. So I think the distortionary effects are somewhat mitigated, by that fact.

719
01:42:52.860 --> 01:43:08.629
Brent Blackaby: Because we're not going to have a sales tax that's out of line with neighbors, we're basically meeting where neighbors are at. But, like, I do have concerns, you know, over time, I think we're going to be generating much more revenue, when we focus on economic output and growing the economy, and

720
01:43:08.690 --> 01:43:25.330
Brent Blackaby: adding more productive people who can afford to live here. That's going to drive revenues in the long term. But in the short term, in terms of helping us close the deficit and adjusting the sales tax rate to be at parity, that's what's going to allow me to support this particular measure. And so I think,

721
01:43:25.400 --> 01:43:29.180
Brent Blackaby: that's where I am, and I appreciate my colleagues for bringing forward. So, thank you.

722
01:43:29.350 --> 01:43:34.389
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Next is Councilmember Humbert, and then on deck is Councilmember Kesarwani.

723
01:43:35.010 --> 01:43:41.470
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor, and I'd like to associate myself with the comments of Councilmember Blackby.

724
01:43:41.520 --> 01:43:56.540
Boardroom: I want to thank the city manager, the finance department, and all other city staff who worked on this, and particularly thank Councilmember Kesarwani, who really championed it. I support placing this measure on the ballot. Thank you.

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725
01:43:56.740 --> 01:43:59.080
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember Kisarwani.

726
01:43:59.730 --> 01:44:17.489
Rashi Kesarwani: Thank you very much, Madam Mayor. I, I just… actually just wanted to echo the appreciation of staff for this, and, and I know Councilmember Blackaby already said this, you know, the reason why, when we came up with this concept, it was actually something I talked about with

727
01:44:17.590 --> 01:44:27.059
Rashi Kesarwani: with our SEIU folks early on, because we knew how devastating this budget would be, and how deep the cuts would be, and so this is…

728
01:44:27.180 --> 01:44:40.059
Rashi Kesarwani: our, proposal to the voters to try to mitigate some of the worst of those reductions. And, this would put us in line with Albany and Oakland, you know, our neighboring jurisdictions.

729
01:44:40.090 --> 01:44:53.859
Rashi Kesarwani: And, I do want to acknowledge, however, that it is a tough time for a lot of folks, and inflation is up, and grocery prices are up, and it is really hard

730
01:44:53.910 --> 01:45:08.269
Rashi Kesarwani: To, for a lot of people, I know a lot of people are struggling, just to be able to afford the basics in our community. It does give me some comfort that groceries are exempt from the sales tax.

731
01:45:08.280 --> 01:45:15.320
Rashi Kesarwani: I do understand, you know, any sales tax by its nature is regressive,

732
01:45:15.510 --> 01:45:22.310
Rashi Kesarwani: However, you know, given the… The importance of the services that we're trying to fund, and the…

733
01:45:22.600 --> 01:45:41.229
Rashi Kesarwani: the reality that this is simply going to put us on parity with our neighboring cities, you know, I think this is very much, the right approach as we look to balance, and I look forward to taking

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the vote, and, you know, thanks, staff, again, for putting this together for us.

734
01:45:41.370 --> 01:45:46.939
Boardroom: And Councilmember Kisarwani, would you like to join and be part of the, ballot argument writing?

735
01:45:47.230 --> 01:45:49.140
Rashi Kesarwani: Sure, sure, I could do that.

736
01:45:49.140 --> 01:45:55.050
Boardroom: I'm also interested, and I know that Councilmember O'Keefe is as well, so… and Councilmember, it's your turn to speak anyway, so…

737
01:45:55.730 --> 01:46:06.270
Boardroom: Great. I just want to say briefly, how much in support I am of this, and I really… I didn't know, Councilmember Kessler Wine, I didn't know this was, this was your brainchild, so… or at least you were advocating for it, so thank you so much.

738
01:46:06.310 --> 01:46:24.690
Boardroom: I think this is a really key measure. We really need new sources of revenue. This is a no-brainer one to me. You know, I do acknowledge that it is a tax increase, and that has effects, but honestly, I watch my dollars very carefully, and I did not know that we were…

739
01:46:24.690 --> 01:46:34.679
Boardroom: half a percent under the neighboring jurisdictions, and I've been asking a lot of people, this is not scientific, but I've been asking a lot of people. I haven't met a single person who was aware of that. So I feel like this is…

740
01:46:34.680 --> 01:46:45.049
Boardroom: so incremental, and because it brings us to parity with other jurisdictions, this has already been mentioned several times, I think this is, just a really smart move, and I'm…

741
01:46:45.080 --> 01:46:48.010
Boardroom: Happy to be putting out a ballot, I hope it passes.

742
01:46:48.660 --> 01:46:53.600
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Anybody else interested in joining and writing the ballot arguments for this?

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743
01:46:54.500 --> 01:47:02.960
Boardroom: We've got 3, so it's okay. Okay, very good. Alright. Is there a motion for this one?

744
01:47:05.730 --> 01:47:10.359
Boardroom: Oh, okay, Councilmember O'Keefe is moving. Moving to approve it.

745
01:47:11.450 --> 01:47:12.070
Boardroom: Second.

746
01:47:12.990 --> 01:47:20.540
Boardroom: Oh. Okay. Can we take the roll on this one, please? Okay, on the motion… Madam Mayor.

747
01:47:24.970 --> 01:47:39.500
Boardroom: Sorry, so, due to, sort of, the nuances of the Revenue and Taxation Code, we just want to make sure that the motion, is to, adopt the ordinance, proposing the transactions and use tax, and adopt the resolution placing the tax, on the ballot.

748
01:47:39.500 --> 01:47:52.319
Boardroom: The ordinance would then appear, you know, on a subsequent consent counter consistent with ordinary second reading practice, but of course would not go into effect until approved by the voters. That was exactly my motion, as you know. Thank you so much.

749
01:47:52.320 --> 01:47:54.230
Rashi Kesarwani: Well, I seconded. Okay.

750
01:47:54.230 --> 01:48:11.780
Boardroom: Very good. Thank you very much, Sam, for the clarification. All right, go ahead. Okay, so to adopt the resolution, placing the measure on the ballot, and also the first reading of the ordinance with the authors designated as Mayor Ishii, Councilmembers Kesarwani, and O'Keefe.

751
01:48:11.900 --> 01:48:14.239
Boardroom: Councilmember Kesarwani?

752
01:48:14.240 --> 01:48:15.010
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

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753
01:48:15.650 --> 01:48:22.270
Boardroom: Kaplan? Aye. Bartlett? Yes. Tregeb? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

754
01:48:22.390 --> 01:48:23.060
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

755
01:48:23.670 --> 01:48:31.150
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes. Okay, motion carries. Thank you very much, and thank you very much to staff.

756
01:48:31.280 --> 01:48:49.599
Boardroom: Alright, so we are moving on to item 40, but we're gonna take a break before then. We're gonna take a 15-minute break, and then we will move on to item 48. We will start with the CIP, then we will have the presentation of the budget, my budget amendments, and then, on from there. So, just so folks know where we're at.

757
01:48:49.600 --> 01:48:51.880
Boardroom: Thank you very much, we'll be back in 15 minutes.

758
01:48:55.480 --> 01:49:03.210
Boardroom: Okay, thanks everyone. We were moving so fast, we had to get the staff set up, so I think we're good.

759
01:49:03.380 --> 01:49:07.199
Boardroom: Alright, folks, can I have quiet, please?

760
01:49:07.610 --> 01:49:23.050
Boardroom: Thank you! Alright, so we are moving on to item number 40. I know this is a bit confusing, but we're gonna start with the CIP, and then as I said before the break, we will move on to our actual budget,

761
01:49:23.580 --> 01:49:27.700
Boardroom: presentation, and I will present my amendments.

762
01:49:27.840 --> 01:49:34.359
Boardroom: And then, we will hear from the public. So, I'm gonna pass it over to our city staff, whoever's gonna start us off.

763
01:49:41.420 --> 01:49:47.749

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Boardroom: Thank you, Mayor and Council Members. My staff, Mark Collier, is actually going to share screen.

764
01:49:55.830 --> 01:49:59.409
Boardroom: It's actually the CIP presentation.

765
01:50:00.430 --> 01:50:02.790
Boardroom: We ordered… we moved the order of things.

766
01:50:08.980 --> 01:50:10.560
Boardroom: Thank you very much.

767
01:50:12.830 --> 01:50:14.859
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

768
01:50:17.540 --> 01:50:24.370
Boardroom: So we're going to have a very robust presentation to you, regarding our 5-year CIP.

769
01:50:24.690 --> 01:50:30.229
Boardroom: We're gonna go over… I'll be going over the overview, our inventory, and different program categories.

770
01:50:30.560 --> 01:50:36.650
Boardroom: Funding highlights, Infrastructure funding by category, then by funding source.

771
01:50:36.910 --> 01:50:44.969
Boardroom: And then my colleagues will take over PRWCIP with Director Farris, PWCIP with…

772
01:50:45.080 --> 01:50:52.470
Boardroom: Interim Director Wahira Miri, and IT will be a TAC team with Director Fong and… Deputy.

773
01:50:52.720 --> 01:50:53.860
Boardroom: Barry Jennings.

774
01:50:54.250 --> 01:50:57.719
Boardroom: And then I will take it back with unfunded and next steps.

775

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01:51:02.230 --> 01:51:03.600
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

776
01:51:05.520 --> 01:51:08.539
Boardroom: So what is a capital improvement program?

777
01:51:08.820 --> 01:51:12.680
Boardroom: It… we here in the city, develop a 5-year CIP.

778
01:51:13.100 --> 01:51:23.790
Boardroom: And essentially, it identifies anticipated capital projects and projected funding. It also serves as a guide to long-term infrastructure.

779
01:51:23.790 --> 01:51:25.790
Brent Blackaby: I know. Claire, are you almost done.

780
01:51:25.790 --> 01:51:26.789
Boardroom: Sorry, Councilmember Blonde.

781
01:51:26.790 --> 01:51:29.380
Brent Blackaby: Okay, it's last minute.

782
01:51:30.210 --> 01:51:31.670
Boardroom: Councilmember Blackaby?

783
01:51:31.670 --> 01:51:32.320
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

784
01:51:32.320 --> 01:51:33.330
Boardroom: You've gone off of it.

785
01:51:37.510 --> 01:51:38.500
Boardroom: Thank you.

786
01:51:38.600 --> 01:51:50.960
Boardroom: It also serves as our long-term infrastructure planning and budget decisions, and the reason we're presenting it here today as well is because it's developed as part of our city's biannual budget process.

787
01:51:51.290 --> 01:51:59.179

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Boardroom: Year 1 and year two is capital budget. It represents our new funding appropriation for the fiscal year's projects.

788
01:51:59.450 --> 01:52:05.220
Boardroom: And it's adopted with annual operating budget, which is going to be part of our fiscal year 27…

789
01:52:05.430 --> 01:52:07.639
Boardroom: annual appropriation.

790
01:52:07.910 --> 01:52:12.470
Boardroom: And it also functions as the most actionable portion of the CIP.

791
01:52:12.970 --> 01:52:18.260
Boardroom: Year 3 and 5, it's more of a plan. It serves as a budgetary management

792
01:52:18.450 --> 01:52:23.060
Boardroom: Tool, and it's re-evaluated and updated regularly to reflect

793
01:52:23.180 --> 01:52:27.639
Boardroom: Evolving community needs, council priorities, and fiscal conditions.

794
01:52:28.110 --> 01:52:33.520
Boardroom: It's a list of projects and funding that are used for planning purposes.

795
01:52:33.740 --> 01:52:37.619
Boardroom: Our 5-year CIP includes 149 projects.

796
01:52:39.320 --> 01:52:40.840
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

797
01:52:42.070 --> 01:52:51.730
Boardroom: This is, I think, I can speak for the whole team, one of our favorite slides, because it's very visual, and it represents all of the infrastructure inventory

798
01:52:51.870 --> 01:52:53.539
Boardroom: Though we do have…

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799
01:52:53.710 --> 01:52:57.019
Boardroom: And I'm not going to go over all of them, but I do want to highlight

800
01:52:57.300 --> 01:53:03.110
Boardroom: That, as you can see here, the City of Berkeley maintains an extensive portfolio.

801
01:53:03.470 --> 01:53:05.040
Boardroom: of capital assets.

802
01:53:05.920 --> 01:53:10.010
Boardroom: We have about… some of the highlights is 213 miles of streets.

803
01:53:10.360 --> 01:53:14.579
Boardroom: 61 miles of bicycle infrastructure, 56 parks.

804
01:53:15.050 --> 01:53:19.909
Boardroom: 38 public restrooms, 5 community centers, and 3 resident camps.

805
01:53:20.010 --> 01:53:22.689
Boardroom: And of course, the behind the scenes.

806
01:53:23.180 --> 01:53:27.699
Boardroom: All technology to support departments serving the public.

807
01:53:27.860 --> 01:53:29.580
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

808
01:53:31.470 --> 01:53:38.289
Boardroom: Within our CIP, we group them into 12 different categories. I'm not gonna go through all of them.

809
01:53:39.080 --> 01:53:44.209
Boardroom: But… there are… I want to do say that the other infrastructure.

810
01:53:45.030 --> 01:53:51.920

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Boardroom: That typically will include EV charging stations, street lights, traffic signals.

811
01:53:52.220 --> 01:53:59.130
Boardroom: And other projects that cannot be categorized under the more obvious 11 other categories before it.

812
01:53:59.890 --> 01:54:01.639
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

813
01:54:06.520 --> 01:54:09.670
Boardroom: The next few slides will talk about funding highlights.

814
01:54:10.210 --> 01:54:16.770
Boardroom: So the major… the more… Not the majority of, but the more reliable funding source

815
01:54:17.000 --> 01:54:21.499
Boardroom: For our infrastructure comes from our city's annual baseline allocation.

816
01:54:21.660 --> 01:54:23.380
Boardroom: And the CIP fund?

817
01:54:24.150 --> 01:54:27.160
Boardroom: And that is actually transferred from the general fund.

818
01:54:28.270 --> 01:54:32.469
Boardroom: Historically, the baseline has been about $4 million annually.

819
01:54:32.810 --> 01:54:39.519
Boardroom: With an additional $8 million dedicated specifically to improving the streets.

820
01:54:39.900 --> 01:54:43.059
Boardroom: Paving condition index in recent years.

821
01:54:44.240 --> 01:54:46.779
Boardroom: Other funding sources are restricted.

822
01:54:47.220 --> 01:54:50.559

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Boardroom: Such as Sewer Fund for Sewer system improvements.

823
01:54:50.860 --> 01:54:54.069
Boardroom: Stormwater fund for related drainage work.

824
01:54:54.180 --> 01:54:57.980
Boardroom: Streetlight Fund for Streetlight Upgrades and Maintenance.

825
01:55:00.810 --> 01:55:16.870
Boardroom: So, speaking of T1, in 2016, this was a voter approved a $100 million T bond to improve the city's aging infrastructure. T1 has provided the funds needed to fix our city's failing infrastructure and made many of our community's buildings

826
01:55:17.050 --> 01:55:26.319
Boardroom: Safe, accessible. We paved a lot of our neglected streets, built green infrastructure, and replaced outdated and non-compliant place structures.

827
01:55:26.650 --> 01:55:28.649
Boardroom: Phase 1 has been completed.

828
01:55:28.920 --> 01:55:32.680
Boardroom: 39 projects total, $40 million spent.

829
01:55:33.680 --> 01:55:38.890
Boardroom: And something that this team is really proud of, $23 million of that was leveraged funds.

830
01:55:40.060 --> 01:55:42.660
Boardroom: Phase 2 is still in progress.

831
01:55:43.270 --> 01:55:45.299
Boardroom: 37 projects.

832
01:55:46.000 --> 01:55:51.630
Boardroom: We're using the remaining $60 million, plus an additional $4.1 million earned in interest.

833
01:55:52.060 --> 01:55:56.970
Boardroom: And $43 million of that is used in leverage, to leverage funds, other funds.

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834
01:55:58.810 --> 01:56:02.480
Boardroom: Will you rely on voter-approved funding, such as Measure T1?

835
01:56:02.880 --> 01:56:06.420
Boardroom: Which has significantly advanced our capital project delivery.

836
01:56:07.610 --> 01:56:09.199
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

837
01:56:11.320 --> 01:56:15.640
Boardroom: Other funding highlights for our CIP program are grants.

838
01:56:17.990 --> 01:56:22.569
Boardroom: We have effectively leveraged Measure T1 and other funding sources.

839
01:56:22.670 --> 01:56:26.140
Boardroom: To secure significant grant awards for capital projects.

840
01:56:26.350 --> 01:56:31.479
Boardroom: We currently have $65.4 million in active grant funding.

841
01:56:32.030 --> 01:56:35.090
Boardroom: Reflecting our readiness and competitiveness.

842
01:56:35.830 --> 01:56:41.350
Boardroom: Without measures like T1 and other funding sources providing essential matching funds.

843
01:56:41.880 --> 01:56:45.839
Boardroom: Our ability to qualify for many grants would have been very limited.

844
01:56:46.610 --> 01:56:50.699
Boardroom: A detailed list of the $65.4 million in capital grants.

845
01:56:50.870 --> 01:56:53.830
Boardroom: It's included in the agenda packet.

846

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This information provided by Zoom. The City of Berkeley cannot certify the following text since we did not create it.

01:56:55.450 --> 01:56:57.140
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

847
01:57:02.180 --> 01:57:08.609
Boardroom: This slide talks about the most recent voter-approved Measure FF, approved in 2024.

848
01:57:09.090 --> 01:57:13.939
Boardroom: Measure FF is a long-term investment strategy focused on maintaining and improving

849
01:57:14.090 --> 01:57:20.229
Boardroom: Berkeley's transportation infrastructure, with emphasis on streets, sidewalks, safety, and environmental performance.

850
01:57:21.600 --> 01:57:28.189
Boardroom: The table to the top right, my right, is our budget for the next two years.

851
01:57:28.720 --> 01:57:36.010
Boardroom: For 2027, we are proposing to spend $24.1 million in Measure FF.

852
01:57:36.350 --> 01:57:40.229
Boardroom: And in fiscal year 28, about $14.5 million.

853
01:57:40.790 --> 01:57:42.760
Boardroom: What, that 2 years?

854
01:57:42.950 --> 01:57:44.549
Boardroom: We'll hope to improve.

855
01:57:45.370 --> 01:57:48.919
Boardroom: It's over 4 center line miles of roadway rehab.

856
01:57:49.070 --> 01:57:54.850
Boardroom: Over 15 transportation safety projects, and green infrastructure compliance projects.

857
01:57:56.380 --> 01:58:08.249

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Boardroom: Staff intends to leverage Measure FF funds to strengthen our CIP by pursuing additional capital grants using the same successful strategy employed with Measure T1.

858
01:58:09.300 --> 01:58:16.889
Boardroom: Later in this presentation, we'll walk through what Measure FF is funding, and how it fits into the city's long-term CIP.

859
01:58:17.690 --> 01:58:19.090
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

860
01:58:23.210 --> 01:58:31.570
Boardroom: This slide will give you the overall funding picture for our 5-year CIP. The key takeaway here is that within the next 5 years.

861
01:58:31.930 --> 01:58:37.729
Boardroom: Our total for the 5-year CIP is $410.6 million.

862
01:58:38.320 --> 01:58:43.960
Boardroom: The first year in 2027, we have a total funding of $100.1 million.

863
01:58:44.300 --> 01:58:49.850
Boardroom: And in fiscal year 2028, $83.7 million.

864
01:58:51.010 --> 01:58:59.119
Boardroom: I just do want to highlight that the zero budget for IT in the out years of 29, 30, and 31 is because

865
01:58:59.220 --> 01:59:03.499
Boardroom: They do not have an… baseline CIB fund allocation.

866
01:59:04.370 --> 01:59:06.959
Boardroom: And there is an insufficient fund balance.

867
01:59:07.310 --> 01:59:09.269
Boardroom: in their IT cost allocation.

868
01:59:11.110 --> 01:59:15.430
Boardroom: The street decline, as you can see, in funding from 27 to 28.

869

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01:59:15.550 --> 01:59:20.999
Boardroom: can be explained by Measure FF funding received in 27 equals 18 months' worth.

870
01:59:21.180 --> 01:59:24.349
Boardroom: Versus 28, it's only the full 12 months.

871
01:59:26.750 --> 01:59:32.629
Boardroom: Measure FF funding can be found in streets category, sidewalks, and transportation.

872
01:59:33.620 --> 01:59:39.320
Boardroom: The top 3 program categories in our 5-year CIP are streets at 34%,

873
01:59:39.670 --> 01:59:45.000
Boardroom: Sewer at 30… at 29%, and transportation at 10.6%.

874
01:59:46.750 --> 01:59:50.089
Boardroom: The street includes $67.4 million.

875
01:59:51.630 --> 01:59:56.930
Boardroom: $42.1 million in… Measure FF.

876
01:59:57.800 --> 02:00:01.389
Boardroom: Sidewalls include $11.8 million in Measure FF,

877
02:00:01.950 --> 02:00:06.119
Boardroom: And transportation includes $20.4 million in Measure FF.

878
02:00:08.680 --> 02:00:10.030
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

879
02:00:12.680 --> 02:00:19.249
Boardroom: This slide is telling the same story, but instead of broken down by categories, it's broken down by funding source.

880
02:00:20.420 --> 02:00:28.829
Boardroom: Our general fund slash CIP fund hovers around $12 million for the next 2 years in 27 and 28.

881

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02:00:29.040 --> 02:00:36.180
Boardroom: And again, that is our most reliable funding source for the time being, and the most… discretionary?

882
02:00:36.810 --> 02:00:42.880
Boardroom: PRW special funds and parks tax with increased one-time funding in fiscal year 27.

883
02:00:43.050 --> 02:00:45.130
Boardroom: At $6.125 million.

884
02:00:45.570 --> 02:00:50.080
Boardroom: And in 2028, it reverts back to a more baseline recurring funding.

885
02:00:50.230 --> 02:00:52.679
Boardroom: At $2.75 million.

886
02:00:52.790 --> 02:00:55.480
Boardroom: with total PRW special funds of…

887
02:00:55.810 --> 02:01:00.930
Boardroom: $3.53 million in 28, and $7 million in 27.

888
02:01:01.790 --> 02:01:08.890
Boardroom: IT is currently funding their biannual capital budget with their IT cost allocation, which is an internal service fund.

889
02:01:11.000 --> 02:01:15.769
Boardroom: Public Works Special Funds total $75.6 million in 27.

890
02:01:15.900 --> 02:01:19.030
Boardroom: And $61.4 million in 28.

891
02:01:19.750 --> 02:01:26.509
Boardroom: The two highest contributor of the PW's Public Works CIP budget are the Sewer Fund and, again, Measure FF.

892
02:01:27.850 --> 02:01:31.839
Boardroom: The grant's total in 27 is $5.1 million.

893

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02:01:32.430 --> 02:01:41.110
Boardroom: And in 28, it's $5.9 million. And I want to highlight that the $65.4 million grant slide that we just talked about earlier.

894
02:01:41.290 --> 02:01:46.569
Boardroom: Are… the majority of those current grants have already been appropriated in prior fiscal years.

895
02:01:48.380 --> 02:01:49.720
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

896
02:01:52.150 --> 02:01:59.560
Boardroom: So the next few slides, I'm going to hand it over to my colleagues. They're going to highlight their recent capital improvement project accomplishments.

897
02:01:59.930 --> 02:02:13.740
Boardroom: As well as go over their biannual 27 and 28 CIP budget. We will hand it over to Scott Ferris first, and then Wahit Amiri, and then Kevin Fong and Barry Jennings. Thank you.

898
02:02:14.670 --> 02:02:16.060
Boardroom: Okay.

899
02:02:16.530 --> 02:02:21.879
Boardroom: So, sorry, when you turn off one, sometimes you turn off both.

900
02:02:22.330 --> 02:02:23.870
Boardroom: Is it on now?

901
02:02:24.100 --> 02:02:27.049
Boardroom: Testing. Okay, testing. Yeah, alright. Testing 1, 2, 3.

902
02:02:27.640 --> 02:02:29.110
Boardroom: Alright,

903
02:02:29.600 --> 02:02:42.939
Boardroom: I've been told I'm too passionate about my projects, so I speak too long, so I'm gonna try and be impassionate here and just get through them so that we're not here all night. Yeah.

904
02:02:43.390 --> 02:02:44.720

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Boardroom: So,

905
02:02:45.120 --> 02:02:58.429
Boardroom: I'm gonna start with Willard here. It's a T1-funded project. It's the most awarded CIP project the city has ever had. We've won 5 significant awards, and are finalists for a sixth.

906
02:02:58.590 --> 02:03:06.620
Boardroom: And so, this is what we can do with, with, with funding. It's an amazing project, and it's been an amazing amenity for that community.

907
02:03:06.870 --> 02:03:08.289
Boardroom: Next slide, Mark.

908
02:03:10.290 --> 02:03:19.019
Boardroom: So, we're gonna talk briefly about our accomplishments. The Willard's up there, we finished a project at Ohlone and Civic Center.

909
02:03:19.220 --> 02:03:22.770
Boardroom: Next slide.

910
02:03:26.340 --> 02:03:33.140
Boardroom: Here, we're looking at some, the South Adeline projects, and which we're going to,

911
02:03:33.540 --> 02:03:47.540
Boardroom: cut a ribbon for, like, 3 or 4 smaller projects on Saturday at 1215 for anybody who wants to come on out. The Milwaukee Forest is complete, the landscaping project in front of the here there is complete.

912
02:03:47.540 --> 02:03:56.089
Boardroom: And the dog park should be complete tomorrow. And we've got a few other little amenities we've added in South Berkeley, so the community's really excited.

913
02:03:56.220 --> 02:04:02.839
Boardroom: Ribbon cutting, 1215, somewhere in, the landscaping area on Saturday.

914
02:04:03.310 --> 02:04:04.330
Boardroom: Next slide.

915

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02:04:05.470 --> 02:04:12.300
Boardroom: Oh, and I wanna, just really quick, another T1-funded project, so…

916
02:04:12.560 --> 02:04:17.359
Boardroom: A lot of, a lot of capital improvements up at camps.

917
02:04:17.850 --> 02:04:19.740
Boardroom: Thank you.

918
02:04:19.980 --> 02:04:36.169
Boardroom: The big one was the Casadero storm damage, so we did a lot of repair, a lot of rebuilding of cabins, and you see there, the stage got rebuilt, and a variety of other things that combination contractors and my staff dealt with.

919
02:04:36.300 --> 02:04:39.319
Boardroom: We've had sports courts improvement at Echo Lake.

920
02:04:39.580 --> 02:04:54.650
Boardroom: And, at both ECHO and Tuolumne, we installed, generators and a switch that allows us to, essentially operate when the electricity goes down. We've had a lot of brownouts in both, in both

921
02:04:55.310 --> 02:05:04.189
Boardroom: areas in the last several years, and so now when, we lose electricity, we'll have the dining hall and the main hall will be,

922
02:05:04.700 --> 02:05:08.729
Boardroom: will be, able to operate. Next slide.

923
02:05:11.310 --> 02:05:22.709
Boardroom: Lots of accomplishments at the waterfront, F&D redecking, it looks beautiful, Terry, thank you very much for that referral. South Cove West parking lot is finished.

924
02:05:24.070 --> 02:05:33.190
Boardroom: And looks great, along with, the east and the middle docks. So, all that work has been completed this year. Next slide.

925
02:05:35.880 --> 02:05:44.860
Boardroom: So, projects near completion. MLK YAPA, Martin Luther King Jr. Youth Services Facility, is,

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926
02:05:45.320 --> 02:05:56.849
Boardroom: on its way, and a lot of the shell is complete now. They're working inside, and that project should be done in January of 2027, so we're not far.

927
02:05:56.990 --> 02:05:59.919
Boardroom: That's a $15 million T1 project.

928
02:06:00.130 --> 02:06:01.890
Boardroom: The Santa Fe right-of-way?

929
02:06:02.160 --> 02:06:11.419
Boardroom: That's, largely a grant-funded project. We have $5.5 million worth of state grants on that project, and that

930
02:06:11.540 --> 02:06:29.250
Boardroom: That project has started construction. We've started the remediation of the soil, about 2 weeks ago, and, we're hoping to get bids back on the above-ground improvements in the next week or two, and award that, and start that construction late summer, early fall.

931
02:06:30.260 --> 02:06:36.950
Boardroom: So, D&E Doc is almost done. We've been waiting on PG&E and the East Bay Mud, and…

932
02:06:37.250 --> 02:06:47.459
Boardroom: That we have dates for hookups for both of those, and so we hope to be cutting a ribbon in the marina for the dredging and the D&E doc, projects.

933
02:06:47.670 --> 02:06:49.440
Boardroom: Sometime in July.

934
02:06:50.090 --> 02:06:51.220
Boardroom: Next slide, Marco.

935
02:06:53.350 --> 02:06:59.620
Boardroom: So here you see a kind of a breakdown by funding source, for 27 and 28.

936
02:06:59.770 --> 02:07:04.239

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Boardroom: We have a fair amount more money in 27, largely because

937
02:07:04.400 --> 02:07:13.800
Boardroom: We've, we're using, Parks Tax Fund Balance to finish a couple of large projects. The MLK…

938
02:07:14.290 --> 02:07:19.039
Boardroom: Youth Services Center, the Tom Bates Complex, and Santa Fe right-of-Way.

939
02:07:20.660 --> 02:07:21.689
Boardroom: Next slide.

940
02:07:22.870 --> 02:07:25.340
Boardroom: Oh, you go back to the… go back one side, Mark.

941
02:07:25.860 --> 02:07:27.689
Boardroom: And what…

942
02:07:28.180 --> 02:07:33.680
Boardroom: you see this year, in fiscal 27 and 28, you'll see an allocation from the CAMPS Fund?

943
02:07:33.980 --> 02:07:46.010
Boardroom: That hasn't happened since 2013. So, we've… when the Berkeley Tuolumne camp burnt down, which was the main, fund driver for the camps fund.

944
02:07:46.240 --> 02:07:57.869
Boardroom: We were operating in the red, and so we did no capital projects funded by the Camps Fund. And it's just now that the fund is recovering. Now, the Tuolumne Campus, since its fourth year of operation.

945
02:07:57.960 --> 02:08:09.310
Boardroom: We're very close to selling out this summer, and so we're, gonna spend about a million dollars and do… of camp improvements out of the Camps Fund, which is new.

946
02:08:10.850 --> 02:08:12.739
Boardroom: Go ahead, Mark, next slide.

947
02:08:13.600 --> 02:08:16.380

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Boardroom: So, what are we gonna do in 27 and 28?

948
02:08:16.560 --> 02:08:24.369
Boardroom: In the waterfront, we're gonna replace some finger docks, and we're gonna try and start to move the garbage containers off.

949
02:08:24.500 --> 02:08:31.870
Boardroom: the seawall, and back into the parking lot, so they're away from the ocean. We're gonna,

950
02:08:32.310 --> 02:08:35.249
Boardroom: Start to design ODOC parking lot.

951
02:08:35.640 --> 02:08:43.590
Boardroom: We're gonna finish O&K Electrical, the Skates parking lot, which construction will start probably in the next month.

952
02:08:43.930 --> 02:09:01.029
Boardroom: will be, redone. And, we will do a kind of a maintenance project at the South Cove East parking lot. We just finished the South Cove West. We did the South Cove East about 8 years ago, and in order to keep it properly maintained, we're gonna seal and re-stripe.

953
02:09:02.090 --> 02:09:03.430
Boardroom: And,

954
02:09:03.910 --> 02:09:13.210
Boardroom: We're gonna do some, we're gonna redo the landscaping along the Bay Trail on the southern portion from University to Emeryville.

955
02:09:13.370 --> 02:09:21.150
Boardroom: And that $700,000 is… was funded in FY26, but the project will happen in… in 27.

956
02:09:22.990 --> 02:09:23.990
Boardroom: Next slide.

957
02:09:26.800 --> 02:09:28.880
Boardroom: So, in parks.

958
02:09:28.990 --> 02:09:37.589

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Boardroom: We've got several projects here. We're working on the Cedar Rose, playgrounds. The 5 to 12 is out to bid. Actually, it's…

959
02:09:37.760 --> 02:09:52.969
Boardroom: about to be awarded. I think we're coming in the next meeting and awarding it, and then we're gonna… we're gonna finish the 2 to 5. We've got some money in here for design and construction for James Kenney Sports Fields.

960
02:09:53.640 --> 02:10:07.270
Boardroom: That, that project is, sorely needed. There is no ADA access to that facility, and it is one of the only facilities that hasn't been touched in the last, 15 to 20 years.

961
02:10:08.010 --> 02:10:14.760
Boardroom: Additionally, we've got some funding in here for our MLK Yacht facility.

962
02:10:15.340 --> 02:10:23.940
Boardroom: I'm not sure you all are aware, but we lost a part of a FEMA grant, and so we went ahead and did Phase 1 and Phase 2,

963
02:10:24.090 --> 02:10:34.060
Boardroom: We've kind of split it into two projects. We'll add the solar and the storage in Phase 2, so that is largely what you see funded there in… in fiscal 27.

964
02:10:34.480 --> 02:10:35.799
Boardroom: Next slide.

965
02:10:38.710 --> 02:10:54.670
Boardroom: Also in parks, we've got, we're gonna do a park restroom. I think that's gonna be either Cedar Rose or Cordinesis, and, we're gonna finish that Santa Fe right-of-way project that was funding I talked about earlier, along with Tom Bates.

966
02:10:54.940 --> 02:11:01.589
Boardroom: And the sports complex there, we're gonna fix a leak at King Pool. And,

967
02:11:02.470 --> 02:11:11.929
Boardroom: We've got a project at Aquatic Park that's going to be several phases, the Dreamland Area Project, and the first phase is a combination of,

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968
02:11:12.280 --> 02:11:14.569
Boardroom: work between Public Works and Parks.

969
02:11:14.720 --> 02:11:25.010
Boardroom: There's gonna be a bioswell where the Dreamland parking lot is, and we're gonna create some parking out on Boulevard in order to allow for,

970
02:11:25.250 --> 02:11:35.559
Boardroom: have parking for Dreamland while we complete Phase 1, and while we wait for the funding for Phase 2, which will be the Dreamland area kind of plan that we put together.

971
02:11:36.120 --> 02:11:37.380
Boardroom: Next slide.

972
02:11:39.740 --> 02:11:49.309
Boardroom: At camps, I talked about that, a million dollars, and here's how we're gonna spend it. We're gonna replace the, the water line at Echo Lake.

973
02:11:51.020 --> 02:11:58.759
Boardroom: We draw from 3 water sources up at Echo Lake. We have a small cistern, a well, and we draw water out of the lake.

974
02:11:58.800 --> 02:12:17.590
Boardroom: And so the lake line, which you see featured here in the right-hand photo, is a line that goes from camp to about a quarter mile, all the way down to Echo Lake and draws water out of the lake. And that little lake line has deteriorated and needs full replacement. So we're gonna do the design and the,

975
02:12:17.840 --> 02:12:21.039
Boardroom: Design of that in fiscal 28.

976
02:12:21.570 --> 02:12:25.470
Boardroom: And… Hopefully the construction soon after.

977
02:12:26.120 --> 02:12:30.029
Boardroom: And… next slide.

978

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02:12:32.400 --> 02:12:35.539
Boardroom: Okay, now I'm gonna pass it off to Wahit.

979
02:12:36.040 --> 02:12:43.879
Boardroom: All right. Thanks, Scott. Good evening, Madam Mayor, Council Members Wahita Miriam, Director of Public Works.

980
02:12:44.210 --> 02:13:03.400
Boardroom: Over the past two fiscal years, Public Works Transportation has delivered major capital projects that put adopted city plans into action. These projects support climate goals, Vision Zero, equity, and safer travel for people walking, biking, rolling, taking transit, and driving.

981
02:13:03.700 --> 02:13:09.729
Boardroom: Examples in front of you include the MLK Vision Zero Hybrid quick-build Safety Improvements.

982
02:13:10.410 --> 02:13:21.009
Boardroom: our famous Southside Complete Streets project, Wolseyaton Intersection Improvements, the Parker Addison Bikeway, Sacramento Pedestrian Safety Improvements, and

983
02:13:21.460 --> 02:13:35.079
Boardroom: the recently construction initiation of the Looney Greenway Safety Improvements Projects. The important point is that these are not isolated projects. These come from adopted plans and community direction.

984
02:13:35.210 --> 02:13:41.070
Boardroom: And they're being delivered through a coordinated capital effort Next slide, please.

985
02:13:44.040 --> 02:13:54.829
Boardroom: Public Works Engineering also delivered critical work that residents may not always see directly, but that supports the city's core infrastructure every single day.

986
02:13:55.290 --> 02:14:01.329
Boardroom: In the fiscal year 24 and 25, street maintenance and rehabilitation projects

987
02:14:01.520 --> 02:14:14.930

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Boardroom: We completed work at citywide locations identified in our 5-year paving plan, totaling about 30 lane miles of street paving, and about 14.5 lane miles of service ceiling. That's quite a bit.

988
02:14:15.300 --> 02:14:27.570
Boardroom: Kudos to our team members. From July 2024 to approximately June of 2026, the 50-50 Sidewalk Repair Program completed an estimated 350 repairs.

989
02:14:27.680 --> 02:14:38.920
Boardroom: reducing trip hazards and improving access. The team also completed structural rehabilitation of approximately 1,600 linear feet of Strawberry Creek culvert.

990
02:14:39.050 --> 02:14:45.120
Boardroom: protecting important underground infrastructure. While those accomplishments in mind.

991
02:14:45.650 --> 02:14:52.409
Boardroom: Let's look at the proposed fiscal year 27 and 28 Public Works CIP budget in the next slide, please.

992
02:14:54.760 --> 02:15:03.640
Boardroom: So, Public Works is proposing a significant two-year capital investment, approximately $92 million in fiscal year 27.

993
02:15:03.780 --> 02:15:11.199
Boardroom: And about $79 million in fiscal year 28. So combined together, that's about $171

994
02:15:11.320 --> 02:15:23.279
Boardroom: million dollars over the next 2 years of the capital budget cycle. The largest funding source that you might have picked up already, the category is sanitary sewer.

995
02:15:23.510 --> 02:15:30.090
Boardroom: Measure FF, the CIP Fund, Stormwater, and, equipment replacement.

996
02:15:30.280 --> 02:15:36.529
Boardroom: Measure FF is especially important because it expands… Transportation, sidewalk.

997

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02:15:36.640 --> 02:15:55.000
Boardroom: pavement, and very importantly, safety investments citywide. One important note is that the fiscal year 27 includes Measure FF revenue collected since the measure went into effect in January of this year, 2025, so that's why the fiscal year 27 Measure FF amount is higher than

998
02:15:55.110 --> 02:16:00.569
Boardroom: Your normal standard 12-month year, but it'll pan out, level out at the 14th year.

999
02:16:01.140 --> 02:16:06.469
Boardroom: I'll walk through the Public Works program areas, starting with Sanitary Sue, and the next slide, please.

1000
02:16:09.450 --> 02:16:17.680
Boardroom: Sanitary sewer is one of the largest public works capital investments, with approximately $48 million proposed over the next two fiscal years.

1001
02:16:18.030 --> 02:16:25.940
Boardroom: This work supports public health, environmental protection, system reliability, and compliance with the 2014 consent decree.

1002
02:16:26.230 --> 02:16:32.959
Boardroom: The city is required to rehabilitate sewer infrastructure at a rate of approximately 4.2 miles per year.

1003
02:16:33.090 --> 02:16:35.309
Boardroom: Based on a 3-year rolling average.

1004
02:16:35.410 --> 02:16:44.650
Boardroom: In fiscal years 27 and 28, the sewer rehabilitation project includes a little over $24 million in the fiscal year 27,

1005
02:16:45.270 --> 02:16:48.539
Boardroom: A little over $22 million in fiscal year 28.

1006
02:16:48.780 --> 02:16:57.569
Boardroom: This continues a long-running program that has rehabilitated much of the city's sewer infrastructure system since 1980s.

1007
02:16:57.830 --> 02:17:03.370

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Boardroom: The Urgent Sewer Project funds priority repairs identified through conditions assessment.

1008
02:17:03.629 --> 02:17:10.019
Boardroom: The city inspects roughly 20 to 25 miles of sewer mains and associated maintenance holes.

1009
02:17:10.420 --> 02:17:24.460
Boardroom: each year to identify infiltration, inflows, and obviously structural deficiencies that deteriorate the system. In fiscal year 27, we'll also complete the Sanitary Sewer Master Plan. We're very excited.

1010
02:17:24.650 --> 02:17:35.049
Boardroom: Which includes hydraulic modeling, CIP recommendations, and a fee study to actually evaluate whether our current rates sustain the program long range.

1011
02:17:35.379 --> 02:17:42.040
Boardroom: The next slide will cover facilities, which supports the buildings and structures that allow city services to operate.

1012
02:17:46.850 --> 02:17:47.540
Boardroom: Okay.

1013
02:17:48.040 --> 02:17:55.890
Boardroom: The facilities program includes approximately 20 proposed projects. These investments keep city buildings and structures safe.

1014
02:17:56.120 --> 02:18:00.180
Boardroom: Functional, resilient, and in a state of good repair.

1015
02:18:00.490 --> 02:18:05.839
Boardroom: Key areas including planning for monetization of the zero-waste Transfer Station.

1016
02:18:06.350 --> 02:18:09.350
Boardroom: Public safety building, server room redundancy.

1017
02:18:09.600 --> 02:18:17.919
Boardroom: And IT resilience upgrades. Roof replacements, so no more leaking on the fifth floor, or in the men's bathroom when you're sitting down.

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1018
02:18:18.100 --> 02:18:28.660
Boardroom: And building envelope repairs, and other deferred maintenance. The common theme is operational continuity, right? Operational continuity, not luxury.

1019
02:18:29.000 --> 02:18:32.270
Boardroom: These projects are not only about buildings.

1020
02:18:32.389 --> 02:18:37.949
Boardroom: They're about making sure the city services can continue during normal operations.

1021
02:18:38.280 --> 02:18:43.820
Boardroom: Emergencies and future climate or seismic events.

1022
02:18:44.049 --> 02:18:45.249
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

1023
02:18:46.230 --> 02:18:53.809
Boardroom: Sidewalks, obviously, are a major accessibility and safety priority for public works in the city.

1024
02:18:54.020 --> 02:19:02.809
Boardroom: The proposed Public Works sidewalk program includes 19 projects, with a strong emphasis on ADA improvements, curb ramps.

1025
02:19:02.940 --> 02:19:15.810
Boardroom: pathways, and public right-of-way access. The City is planning approximately 200 sidewalk repairs located… locations for the fiscal year 26 sidewalk repair project. At the same time.

1026
02:19:15.969 --> 02:19:22.899
Boardroom: The 50-50 Sidewalk Repair Program has a waitlist of approximately 1,400 locations.

1027
02:19:23.360 --> 02:19:39.739
Boardroom: Again, 1,400 locations, and roughly over 200 more gets added every single year, so it's a chasing game, as you can tell. Clearing that backlog by 2031 would require more than $7 million in additional funding.

1028
02:19:39.740 --> 02:19:45.100

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Boardroom: Measure FF obviously is critical here. Without Measure FF, the Safe Streets Initiative.

1029
02:19:45.129 --> 02:19:50.320
Boardroom: Sidewalk investments would be roughly 30% of the proposed funding levels.

1030
02:19:50.510 --> 02:19:56.979
Boardroom: With Measure FF, we can make more meaningful progress on accessibility, tripping hazards.

1031
02:19:57.430 --> 02:20:02.730
Boardroom: pathways, and the ADA Transition Plan as a whole. The principle here is simple.

1032
02:20:03.030 --> 02:20:11.199
Boardroom: When we make Berkeley safer and more accessible for at-risk people, or users, we make it safer and more accessible for everyone in Berkeley.

1033
02:20:11.950 --> 02:20:12.880
Boardroom: Next, please.

1034
02:20:15.620 --> 02:20:16.870
Boardroom: Stormwater.

1035
02:20:17.200 --> 02:20:30.739
Boardroom: Stormwater, includes about 9 proposed projects and approximately $10.6 million over fiscal year 27 and 28. This program is driven largely by regulatory compliance.

1036
02:20:30.960 --> 02:20:37.069
Boardroom: water quality, Obviously, flood resilience and climate adaptation.

1037
02:20:37.540 --> 02:20:44.089
Boardroom: Under the municipal Regional Stormwater Permit, some street rehabilitation projects trigger what we call GI.

1038
02:20:44.450 --> 02:21:07.099
Boardroom: means green infrastructure requirements. The fiscal year 26 green infrastructure project will design and construct LIDs, short for low-impact development improvements triggered by the recent street

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rehabilitation work. The permit also requires the city to reach 100% reduction in trash discharges to the bay compared to the

1039
02:21:07.150 --> 02:21:19.620
Boardroom: 2009 baseline. The city has achieved about, or approximately 94%. That's a great accomplishment for our team members. Again, 94% reduction. Huge.

1040
02:21:19.830 --> 02:21:25.000
Boardroom: But additional trash capture facilities are needed to reach the full goal.

1041
02:21:25.200 --> 02:21:32.650
Boardroom: Major efforts include the Berkeley Aquatic Park Stonewater Improvement Project, Cordenesis Creek Restoration at 9th Street.

1042
02:21:32.830 --> 02:21:37.320
Boardroom: Storm drain and trash capture work, stormwater quality improvements.

1043
02:21:37.480 --> 02:21:52.330
Boardroom: The Clean Water Program, and completion of the Stormwater Master Plan, which we're excited about. That Master Plan will help identify deficiencies, prioritize future capital projects, and incorporate climate adaptation strategies.

1044
02:21:52.770 --> 02:21:53.619
Boardroom: Next, please.

1045
02:21:56.050 --> 02:22:08.919
Boardroom: The streets program includes the City's annual street rehabilitation program, the bridge preventative maintenance, and the coordination between the Measure Effort Program. So, together, these investments total more than

1046
02:22:09.440 --> 02:22:18.519
Boardroom: $58 million in fiscal year 27 and 28 to improve safety, accessibility, and pavement conditions citywide.

1047
02:22:18.870 --> 02:22:20.630
Boardroom: I'll keep it there. Next slide.

1048
02:22:22.930 --> 02:22:23.640

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Boardroom: Okay.

1049
02:22:25.170 --> 02:22:33.380
Boardroom: With the Core Street Rehabilitation Program and Measure FF Road Rehab funding combined, we are proposing more than $58 million

1050
02:22:33.380 --> 02:22:46.219
Boardroom: for streets in fiscal year 27 and 28. That includes close to $38 million in the street rehab program, and about $20 million in additional Measure FF road rehab funding.

1051
02:22:46.820 --> 02:23:00.890
Boardroom: The combined program is expected to improve about 25 center lines of streets over the next 2 years. The work is spread across all 8 council districts and is aligned with, again.

1052
02:23:00.890 --> 02:23:11.960
Boardroom: policy priorities, including equity zone, bikeways, bus routes, high-injury streets, and the city's Dig Once policy approach.

1053
02:23:12.360 --> 02:23:24.839
Boardroom: Council's 2022 commitment of an additional $8 million annually for paving made a huge difference. Before that, the city was averaging roughly about 2 to 3 centimiles of paving per year.

1054
02:23:25.060 --> 02:23:39.610
Boardroom: Since that investment, we have increased output to nearly 10 centimiles per year over fiscal year 24 through 26, and for a pavement engineer, they would be jumping up backwards, and that's a great accomplishment, so…

1055
02:23:40.080 --> 02:23:52.309
Boardroom: It's in the right direction. So, obviously, the data is moving in the right direction, as I mentioned. Citywide PCI improved from 55 in 2023 to about 57 at the end of 2025.

1056
02:23:52.620 --> 02:24:06.779
Boardroom: But PCI 57, unfortunately, is still at-risk category, and the city has more than $300 million in deferred pavement maintenance. So we are making progress, but the work is still far from complete.

1057
02:24:08.320 --> 02:24:09.290
Boardroom: Next, please.

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1058
02:24:11.740 --> 02:24:15.559
Boardroom: Our ever-famous transportation projects, are where

1059
02:24:15.560 --> 02:24:34.620
Boardroom: many of the city's adopted safety and mobility plans become real improvements on the ground. The proposed transportation CIP is approximately $25.6 million over fiscal year 27 and 28, and includes both regular transportation projects and the Measure FF safety projects.

1060
02:24:34.760 --> 02:24:39.969
Boardroom: These investments prioritize making it safer for people of all ages and abilities to walk.

1061
02:24:40.330 --> 02:24:44.860
Boardroom: roll, bike, take transit, and move around Berkeley in general.

1062
02:24:45.070 --> 02:24:59.420
Boardroom: They include safe routes to school, bicycle boulevards, pedestrian safety improvements, traffic signal modernization, transit access, and corridor projects. The funding sources include Measure FF, obviously, the state.

1063
02:24:59.670 --> 02:25:15.749
Boardroom: allotted local grants, state transportation tax, MTC funding, the UC Berkeley settlement, Measure BB, and other regional and local resources. The next slide highlights examples of our transportation projects that we're proposing in the CIP.

1064
02:25:18.890 --> 02:25:34.680
Boardroom: This slide highlights several projects within the proposed transportation CIP. Adeline Transportation Improvement will deliver quick-build improvements and advance permanent design, including safety, accessibility, protected bike facilities, signal improvements.

1065
02:25:34.900 --> 02:25:46.199
Boardroom: and AC Transit bus stop improvements. The Cedar Street Midian Crossing and Cedar Street Pedestrian Safety Crossing Improvements support safer crossings along an important corridor

1066
02:25:46.340 --> 02:25:56.970
Boardroom: and connect with the bike plan and the pedestrian plan priorities. Citywide Traffic Calming Program provides stable funding to expand neighborhood traffic calming as a whole.

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1067
02:25:57.950 --> 02:26:08.400
Boardroom: We were at Claremont, last night. The Claremont Avenue Complete Streets Corridor Project, will support the public process and design work for a major safety corridor.

1068
02:26:09.280 --> 02:26:21.210
Boardroom: Boney Greenway improvements will widen and repave the Greenway, add lighting, and improve crossing. Oxford for All will obviously advance complete streets, design between Hurst and Bancroft.

1069
02:26:21.450 --> 02:26:38.359
Boardroom: The Telegraph Multimilial Project will continue complete streets design from Dwight to the Oakland border, including protected bike lanes, transit improvements, pedestrian safety, and ADA upgrades. We'll also continue safe routes to School work for Washington Elementary.

1070
02:26:38.410 --> 02:26:45.509
Boardroom: Berkeley High, along with the Vision Zero Quick Build and Action Plan work that's ahead of us. Next slide, please.

1071
02:26:46.480 --> 02:27:01.110
Boardroom: All right, the final slide before I stop talking. So, the final public works category is equipment replacement and other infrastructure that Erica touched upon a little bit at the beginning. So, equipment replacement includes 5 proposed equipment.

1072
02:27:01.330 --> 02:27:06.789
Boardroom: replacement projects, and 6 other infrastructure projects. So in fiscal year 27,

1073
02:27:06.960 --> 02:27:11.640
Boardroom: The vehicle replacement program is proposed at about $9.6 million.

1074
02:27:12.160 --> 02:27:16.980
Boardroom: And in fiscal year 28, that goes down to about 4.9, close to $5 million.

1075
02:27:17.470 --> 02:27:24.890
Boardroom: The equipment replacement fund is supported by monthly charges to departments for vehicles and equipment replacement.

1076
02:27:25.100 --> 02:27:31.230

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Boardroom: Departments are responsible for covering shortfalls when replacement costs exceed available balances.

1077
02:27:31.510 --> 02:27:37.409
Boardroom: So the fiscal year 27 plan is to replace approximately 66 vehicles, or pieces of equipment.

1078
02:27:37.850 --> 02:27:41.049
Boardroom: And add one new all-electric rear

1079
02:27:41.410 --> 02:27:44.610
Boardroom: truck for zero waste. For 28,

1080
02:27:45.230 --> 02:28:01.850
Boardroom: The numbers are about 61 replacements, including some mowers. So, as a general rule, the City Public Works, whenever the marketing operation allows us, we will move towards electrical… electric vehicles. With that said.

1081
02:28:02.180 --> 02:28:08.860
Boardroom: And that concludes the Public Works slides. I'm gonna hand it over to my colleague, to take over the IT slides.

1082
02:28:09.660 --> 02:28:10.619
Boardroom: Thanks, Maid.

1083
02:28:15.570 --> 02:28:20.280
Boardroom: Good evening, Madam Mayor and members of the Council. I'm Kevin Fong, Director of IT.

1084
02:28:20.590 --> 02:28:31.349
Boardroom: And fortunately, or unfortunately, depending on how you look at it, we don't have a lot of slides, but it does not mean we're not passionate. I mean, I'm so passionate, I brought help along, so…

1085
02:28:31.550 --> 02:28:36.419
Boardroom: Tonight, I'm pleased to present some of the key IT milestones and accomplishments from the past year.

1086
02:28:36.590 --> 02:28:49.900
Boardroom: So the IT team significantly strengthens the stability and security of city operations by accelerating our cloud migrations,

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ensuring full regulatory compliance, and replacing outdated, inefficient systems, which we're still doing.

1087
02:28:50.760 --> 02:28:56.630
Boardroom: Our achievements are built upon four strategic pillars, and I'll start with the first one, better online services.

1088
02:28:57.540 --> 02:29:14.530
Boardroom: To build a more resilient infrastructure, we transitioned to a cloud-first architecture. Central to this effort was the Accela Cloud migration in October of 2025, an achievement that eliminated on-site server failure risk and delivered an immediate 40% increase in portal performance.

1089
02:29:14.970 --> 02:29:23.030
Boardroom: For context, this platform securely processes about $15 million in annual permitting, and another $30 million in business licenses.

1090
02:29:24.110 --> 02:29:34.089
Boardroom: For our city workforce, we collaborated with HHR, Payroll, Audit, and the City Manager's Office to launch the Employee Access Portal on March 23rd of this year.

1091
02:29:34.240 --> 02:29:45.799
Boardroom: This secure self-service module allows over 1,500 city employees to manage their pay stubs and W-2s independently, which has already reduced HR administrative tickets by 30%.

1092
02:29:47.170 --> 02:29:53.760
Boardroom: Our second pillar is stronger security and reliability, driven by a rigorous, multi-layered protection strategy.

1093
02:29:54.010 --> 02:30:01.709
Boardroom: First, on identity verification, we achieved a 100% citywide compliance with our hardware-based multi-factor authentication.

1094
02:30:01.910 --> 02:30:08.320
Boardroom: We kind of dubbed that as the Berkeley Two-Step, if any of you remember that, but I won't do the dance here, so…

1095
02:30:09.660 --> 02:30:14.319
Boardroom: Second, for endpoint security, we completed a full hardware and software refresh.

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1096
02:30:14.540 --> 02:30:20.710
Boardroom: Recently deploying Windows 11 Enterprise across all our city workstations to meet modern security standards.

1097
02:30:20.940 --> 02:30:36.369
Boardroom: And third, for some employee safety, we accelerated the launch of BeWarned. This is a multi-platform internal emergency system designed specifically to notify staff of critical health and safety issues by pushing alerts instantly to all city-issued devices.

1098
02:30:37.840 --> 02:30:43.209
Boardroom: Our third pillar is more reliable infrastructure, focusing on facility builds and connectivity.

1099
02:30:43.510 --> 02:30:54.539
Boardroom: A major milestone was reaching 95% citywide facility Wi-Fi coverage, which included overcoming the complex challenges and engineering challenges of deploying on the open waters at the marina.

1100
02:30:55.750 --> 02:31:08.319
Boardroom: We also successfully delivered the core technology infrastructure for the fire headquarters relocation. Despite utility permitting delays, our team engineered a temporary connection solution to ensure the department moved in completely on schedule.

1101
02:31:08.820 --> 02:31:19.600
Boardroom: Additionally, we standardized our meeting room audio-visual hardware, replacing legacy systems to unify the user experience, and we directly achieved a $68,000 annual savings.

1102
02:31:20.740 --> 02:31:28.189
Boardroom: Finally, Pillar 4, financial improvement or operational improvements, targeted the elimination of inefficient, obsolete systems.

1103
02:31:28.390 --> 02:31:38.939
Boardroom: To achieve regulatory compliance, we launched new technology that lets 311 securely handle credit card payments by phone in full compliance with PCI standards.

1104
02:31:39.330 --> 02:31:53.139
Boardroom: It makes payments easier, improves revenue collection times, and eliminates the city's liability. For context, during a single week in

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May 2026, our 311 center securely processed over $37,000 in credit card payments by phone.

1105
02:31:54.550 --> 02:32:00.200
Boardroom: To accelerate the modernization of our financial infrastructure, we restructured our approach to accounts receivables.

1106
02:32:00.630 --> 02:32:04.570
Boardroom: remove general billing from the scope, allowing specialized end systems.

1107
02:32:04.790 --> 02:32:16.030
Boardroom: to handle direct invoicing. As a result, revenue data now bypasses our legacy fund system entirely, protecting data integrity and accelerating the sunsetting of our aging mainframe infrastructure.

1108
02:32:16.860 --> 02:32:33.120
Boardroom: So, in summary, we established a new baseline for IT excellence. By modernizing our environment and eliminating operational risk, we've successfully cleared the path to our future roadmap, including the final decommissioning of legacy systems and upcoming public safety cloud upgrades.

1109
02:32:33.260 --> 02:32:34.520
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

1110
02:32:36.360 --> 02:32:43.279
Boardroom: So I'm gonna pass this on to Deputy Director Barry, who's gonna talk about, infrastructure, security, and the applications.

1111
02:32:45.470 --> 02:32:46.760
Boardroom: Thank you, Kevin.

1112
02:32:47.740 --> 02:32:55.360
Boardroom: So this slide that we're looking at summarizes information technology's proposed capital investments for FY27 and 28.

1113
02:32:55.760 --> 02:33:07.360
Boardroom: These projects focus on three core areas. Infrastructure, cybersecurity, and business applications that support city operations and services delivered to the community.

1114
02:33:07.760 --> 02:33:20.999

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Boardroom: Just as the city invests in roads, facilities, and other critical public assets, we must also invest in the information technology infrastructure that supports virtually every city service today.

1115
02:33:21.630 --> 02:33:36.330
Boardroom: The largest investment is in cybersecurity and infrastructure. These funds support the technology that keeps city operations running, protects sensitive information, and reduces the risk of service disruptions caused by cyber threats or equipment failures.

1116
02:33:36.690 --> 02:33:48.520
Boardroom: The Asset Management Project improves our ability to track and manage city technology assets, helping us plan replacements before equipment fails, ensuring public funds are used efficiently.

1117
02:33:49.020 --> 02:33:59.850
Boardroom: On the application side, the Clarity Project is a planning department-led initiative for a new permitting system, with IT supporting integration efforts into IRMA.

1118
02:33:59.960 --> 02:34:02.750
Boardroom: To improve connectivity between systems.

1119
02:34:02.860 --> 02:34:16.910
Boardroom: As Berkeley transitions to a new permitting platform, this investment ensures information can flow seamlessly between systems, reducing manual work, improving data accuracy, and helping staff process permits more efficiently.

1120
02:34:17.080 --> 02:34:23.009
Boardroom: Since technical requirements are still being finalized, the current $150,000 estimate is preliminary.

1121
02:34:23.640 --> 02:34:36.080
Boardroom: The Remote Site Redundancy Project improves resiliency at city facilities by providing backup connectivity options, helping critical operations remain available, even when a primary network connection is disruptive.

1122
02:34:36.360 --> 02:34:44.320
Boardroom: Overall, these investments represent a relatively modest capital commitment. $485,000 in FY27,

1123
02:34:44.430 --> 02:34:54.399

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Boardroom: and $685,000 in FY28. But they help protect millions of dollars in existing technology investments and support the reliable delivery of city services.

1124
02:34:55.390 --> 02:35:10.829
Boardroom: The key takeaway is that these investments help protect the city's ability to deliver services. By maintaining secure systems, reliable infrastructure, and resilient technology, we can continue supporting city operations and serving the community effectively.

1125
02:35:11.210 --> 02:35:16.239
Boardroom: With this, I'll hand it back to Mari Carr to talk about unfunded capital needs.

1126
02:35:23.170 --> 02:35:24.620
Boardroom: Thank you, colleagues.

1127
02:35:26.880 --> 02:35:38.549
Boardroom: Now, you guys understand why this was a 40-slide presentation. There's been a tremendous amount of work that's happened, is currently happening, and is planned to happen.

1128
02:35:39.610 --> 02:35:51.300
Boardroom: However, even with this remarkable progress and strong pipeline of projects already scheduled for the next annual budget, and planned through 2031,

1129
02:35:51.400 --> 02:35:59.460
Boardroom: We still face a significant challenge, which is our unfunded capital needs mean substantial.

1130
02:35:59.820 --> 02:36:04.260
Boardroom: I… oh, Mark, can you please go to the next slide?

1131
02:36:07.560 --> 02:36:08.580
Boardroom: Thank you.

1132
02:36:10.110 --> 02:36:18.050
Boardroom: I… Reload… reloaded the 5-year CIP budget just to show, again, that the proposed 5-year CIP investment

1133
02:36:18.180 --> 02:36:22.500
Boardroom: It's $4.106 million in the next 5 years.

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1134
02:36:22.840 --> 02:36:27.190
Boardroom: However, Even after that 5-year investment.

1135
02:36:27.680 --> 02:36:34.040
Boardroom: We project an estimated $2.12 billion in unfunded capital needs.

1136
02:36:34.160 --> 02:36:36.130
Boardroom: At the end of the 5-year period.

1137
02:36:36.520 --> 02:36:44.640
Boardroom: What does that mean? That means that our annual capital allocation are insufficient to address infrastructure needs.

1138
02:36:45.000 --> 02:36:47.680
Boardroom: At the scale and pace required.

1139
02:36:47.880 --> 02:36:58.720
Boardroom: Resulting in increased risk of facility failure, escalating repair costs, service disruptions, and inequitable conditions across neighborhoods.

1140
02:36:58.830 --> 02:37:06.890
Boardroom: To put this into perspective, information technology faces approximately $22.6 million in unfunded capital needs.

1141
02:37:07.750 --> 02:37:14.669
Boardroom: Our beloved Parks, Rec, and Waterfront Department has an estimated $281.5 million gap.

1142
02:37:15.130 --> 02:37:21.510
Boardroom: And of course, Public Works carries the largest portion at approximately $1.8 billion.

1143
02:37:23.300 --> 02:37:29.230
Boardroom: In a moment, each department director will briefly highlight their most pressing unfunded needs.

1144
02:37:29.490 --> 02:37:35.189
Boardroom: Beginning with IT, followed by Parks, Recs, and Waterfront, and concluding with Public Works.

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1145
02:37:41.160 --> 02:37:43.540
Boardroom: Might be faster just to switch seats.

1146
02:37:44.690 --> 02:37:46.050
Boardroom: So, thank you, Marikar.

1147
02:37:46.320 --> 02:37:47.630
Boardroom: So you may have heard the…

1148
02:37:48.180 --> 02:38:00.340
Boardroom: You may have heard the term funds. I mentioned it earlier. For those that don't know, funds is a city's 1980s-era custom-built software system that manages our day-to-day financial operations.

1149
02:38:00.660 --> 02:38:04.990
Boardroom: It's old, it's outdated, and it needs to be replaced immediately.

1150
02:38:05.610 --> 02:38:15.510
Boardroom: I want to be completely transparent about our fiscal reality. Right now, the funding required to fully retire funds is entirely unavailable within our internal IT budget.

1151
02:38:15.890 --> 02:38:26.789
Boardroom: We're forecasting at least 2 years of intense, dedicated effort to finally get off this legacy system at a total estimated cost between $3.2 and $3.7 million in today's dollars.

1152
02:38:28.030 --> 02:38:39.390
Boardroom: Our continued reliance on this system carries a massive operational risk as well. The outside contractors who custom-built funds 40 years ago are nearing retirement or discontinuing service.

1153
02:38:39.510 --> 02:38:49.170
Boardroom: Because of their unique, specialized knowledge, an unplanned departure would leave the city stranded with a critical support deficit. If it breaks, we won't have anyone to fix it.

1154
02:38:49.510 --> 02:39:02.280
Boardroom: Sunsetting this system is therefore our highest priority to ensure long-term business continuity. The largest and most complex

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remaining pieces, the land management and parcel tax data modules, are simply too high risk to leave unaddressed.

1155
02:39:02.470 --> 02:39:10.940
Boardroom: Consequently, for the upcoming budget cycle beginning in FY29, we'll be working directly with the Budget Office to try to secure baseline CIP funding.

1156
02:39:11.180 --> 02:39:16.800
Boardroom: Dedicated capital is the only way we can mitigate this risk and officially shut this system down.

1157
02:39:17.640 --> 02:39:32.959
Boardroom: I will close and say that the good news is that we aren't waiting around to take action. Our focus for this upcoming fiscal year is aggressively moving our accounts receivable, general billing, and customer master modules currently in funds over to our modern platforms, such as Tyler Technology.

1158
02:39:33.680 --> 02:39:42.359
Boardroom: So we do have a clear path forward, we just need the capital resources to finish the job. So thank you. I'll pass this, I guess, to Scott?

1159
02:39:45.710 --> 02:39:46.840
Boardroom: Thanks, Kevin.

1160
02:39:47.030 --> 02:39:48.699
Boardroom: Next slide, Mark.

1161
02:39:57.410 --> 02:39:58.940
Boardroom: Next slide.

1162
02:39:59.110 --> 02:40:00.050
Boardroom: Of this postcone.

1163
02:40:00.460 --> 02:40:01.500
Boardroom: Keep going.

1164
02:40:02.840 --> 02:40:03.890
Boardroom: Keep going.

1165

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02:40:07.540 --> 02:40:15.680
Boardroom: I took out the… Oh, we did? Okay. Yeah, yellow strips.

1166
02:40:16.840 --> 02:40:18.460
Boardroom: Okay. Well…

1167
02:40:20.720 --> 02:40:30.140
Boardroom: We have a fair amount of unfunded in Parks, Recreation, and Waterfront. We've made a lot of progress with, T1, about $50 million of T1,

1168
02:40:30.240 --> 02:40:37.810
Boardroom: was allocated to fix up our parks and our waterfronts.

1169
02:40:38.020 --> 02:40:41.710
Boardroom: We've… our camps are in relatively good shape.

1170
02:40:41.910 --> 02:40:46.250
Boardroom: But we still have a significant amount of unfunded

1171
02:40:47.280 --> 02:40:52.710
Boardroom: And, as Marikar pointed out, even though we're doing,

1172
02:40:53.880 --> 02:41:03.419
Boardroom: a tremendous amount of capital over the next 5 years, we're not making any progress on that unfunded list. And the same thing is true in parks.

1173
02:41:03.710 --> 02:41:09.010
Boardroom: We have, as we… Things break.

1174
02:41:09.150 --> 02:41:24.029
Boardroom: things wear and tear, and so as we complete projects, other ones become issues or break. We had a, just yesterday, or just Saturday, we had a slight… a small sinkhole appear in the South Cove.

1175
02:41:24.430 --> 02:41:33.370
Boardroom: which we're really worried about, and hoping that the bond measure passes in November, and we'll have the funds to replace the seawall, which was the genesis

1176
02:41:33.520 --> 02:41:35.379

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Boardroom: Of that sinkhole.

1177
02:41:35.580 --> 02:41:37.800
Boardroom: And, but throughout,

1178
02:41:37.960 --> 02:41:45.530
Boardroom: Parks, we have a variety of unfunded needs that need to be, funded so that we're not closing facilities.

1179
02:41:45.800 --> 02:41:52.489
Boardroom: In… I think in 2015, we closed the Berkeley Pier.

1180
02:41:52.650 --> 02:41:55.380
Boardroom: We closed, the Berkeley…

1181
02:41:55.870 --> 02:42:03.510
Boardroom: the trellis at the Rose Garden shortly after, and fortunately, with T1 funds, we were able to reestablish that.

1182
02:42:03.730 --> 02:42:09.919
Boardroom: Working on the pier, but as we… as scene gets… as things get older, they need to be fixed.

1183
02:42:10.250 --> 02:42:17.229
Boardroom: And so, we've got a couple… we've got a community center that's not seismically safe, and very small that needs to be fixed.

1184
02:42:17.360 --> 02:42:21.900
Boardroom: And so… Our unfunded needs keep growing.

1185
02:42:22.020 --> 02:42:29.330
Boardroom: And, we're excited for the potential bond measure. That'll make a lot of progress.

1186
02:42:29.930 --> 02:42:38.960
Boardroom: We hate… Thanks, Scott. For public works, I'll keep it pretty simple. The key takeaway is that,

1187
02:42:39.280 --> 02:42:45.029
Boardroom: On the public works side, unfunded capital needs is approximately $1.8 billion.

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1188
02:42:45.510 --> 02:42:47.779
Boardroom: Yes, 1.8 billion.

1189
02:42:48.920 --> 02:42:59.070
Boardroom: That reflects the scale of infrastructure we're responsible for maintaining, which is obviously streets, sidewalks, sewer, stormwater, transportation, facilities, fleet.

1190
02:42:59.840 --> 02:43:04.520
Boardroom: Many other core assets that residents rely on every single day.

1191
02:43:04.670 --> 02:43:08.550
Boardroom: So this CIP, obviously, is not a full solution.

1192
02:43:09.000 --> 02:43:17.890
Boardroom: It's the city's best, efforts to prioritize limited resources, protect essential services, prioritization.

1193
02:43:18.360 --> 02:43:24.690
Boardroom: leverage outside funding wherever we can, feasibly. So, with that said, I'll hand it over back to AmeriCar.

1194
02:43:38.660 --> 02:43:41.610
Boardroom: Okay, I need to eat more spinach. Can't even press that.

1195
02:43:44.040 --> 02:43:55.860
Boardroom: We don't want to end this amazing presentation, with a $2.2 billion unfunded need. We did just want to highlight that that is something that we need to work towards addressing.

1196
02:43:56.290 --> 02:44:05.650
Boardroom: What we do as we wrap up, it is important to highlight that there's been some progress made, despite the significant unfunded capital needs.

1197
02:44:05.800 --> 02:44:10.509
Boardroom: We expect to see materialize, in the sidewalk and pathways.

1198
02:44:10.980 --> 02:44:13.370
Boardroom: Streets and roads and sewers.

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1199
02:44:18.780 --> 02:44:22.110
Boardroom: If you guys can read that, the bottom table.

1200
02:44:22.310 --> 02:44:32.599
Boardroom: The streets, the sidewalks and pathways, started off the first, the 5-year CIP with about $66 million of unfunded need.

1201
02:44:32.920 --> 02:44:38.909
Boardroom: At the end of the 5-year period, it's gonna be about $54.7 million.

1202
02:44:39.630 --> 02:44:42.220
Boardroom: Unfunded capital for streets and roads.

1203
02:44:42.350 --> 02:44:46.840
Boardroom: We'll start off at about $263.1 million.

1204
02:44:46.980 --> 02:44:54.110
Boardroom: At the end of the 5-year period, we're expecting to see that decrease to $167 million.

1205
02:44:54.730 --> 02:45:03.629
Boardroom: and sewers, starting at $138 million, the 5-year period, at the end of the 5-year period. This is the most significant,

1206
02:45:04.150 --> 02:45:09.219
Boardroom: Decrease is gonna be at about $32.7 million unfunded need.

1207
02:45:10.590 --> 02:45:15.209
Boardroom: This improvement… is not done. It will not happen by accident.

1208
02:45:15.490 --> 02:45:19.380
Boardroom: It is the result of targeted strategic solutions.

1209
02:45:19.870 --> 02:45:24.220
Boardroom: We have increased our CIP fund funding for streets and roads.

1210
02:45:24.930 --> 02:45:29.809
Boardroom: Measure FF revenues supporting sidewalks and pathways, streets and roads.

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1211
02:45:31.180 --> 02:45:38.770
Boardroom: And a completed sewer study… rate study that led to phased rate adjustments beginning in fiscal year 2016.

1212
02:45:39.880 --> 02:45:45.719
Boardroom: These steps… Show that when we invest intentionally.

1213
02:45:46.000 --> 02:45:49.459
Boardroom: We close gaps and strengthen our infrastructure.

1214
02:45:50.330 --> 02:46:00.050
Boardroom: That concludes our presentation of the 5-year proposed CIP, and we can now move on to discussion and questions. Thank you. Oh, next steps.

1215
02:46:02.100 --> 02:46:16.009
Boardroom: So for next steps, we're here now June 16th. We're gonna go over… we went over the CIP, as well as the annual budget. It's the next, I believe, the next item, or third item in the 40… agenda item 40.

1216
02:46:16.280 --> 02:46:25.510
Boardroom: With June 23rd, we're hopeful that we're back here in front of you, to adopt a 2027-28 budget and a 5-year CIP.

1217
02:46:25.820 --> 02:46:29.220
Boardroom: July 1st is the beginning of fiscal year 27.

1218
02:46:29.440 --> 02:46:36.159
Boardroom: The adopted budget and balancing measure will take into effect, and the fiscal year 27 capital budget is available.

1219
02:46:36.590 --> 02:46:37.560
Boardroom: Thank you.

1220
02:46:39.020 --> 02:46:54.210
Boardroom: Thank you very much. I know that was a lot to present and to gather and to work on, so thank you all very much for presenting it. Last time they presented this, there was some argument about which department was most important. It was…

1221
02:46:54.290 --> 02:47:07.709

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Boardroom: Very amusing, but I say that just to say that you all are very passionate about the work you do, and you've accomplished so much. It's just really, it's really incredible. Really amazing to see all the work that you've done. I really am very grateful.

1222
02:47:07.980 --> 02:47:20.220
Boardroom: So I want to take questions from my Council colleagues on the CIP, starting with Councilmember Taplin. Oh, okay. Councilmember Blackaby, did you have a question?

1223
02:47:21.630 --> 02:47:23.339
Brent Blackaby: I do have a couple quick questions.

1224
02:47:25.390 --> 02:47:33.330
Brent Blackaby: I don't know how quick, actually, but they're relatively quick. Slide 37, if you could just pop that back up again, Marty Carr.

1225
02:47:33.460 --> 02:47:40.540
Brent Blackaby: And 38. So, I note at the bottom of 37, again, we're gonna invest, you know.

1226
02:47:40.870 --> 02:47:47.420
Brent Blackaby: $400 million over 5 years on capital projects.

1227
02:47:47.420 --> 02:48:02.479
Brent Blackaby: And our total unfunded capital needs were basically kind of flat. We still, you know, so basically we're replenishing capital, but then capital needs are accumulating at the same time, and we're doing some replenishment. So we're kind of staying steady state.

1228
02:48:02.710 --> 02:48:16.759
Brent Blackaby: On the other hand, on the next slide, as you indicated, like, we're making significant investments in streets and sewers such that the backlog for streets and the backlog for sewers are significantly reduced. Like, we're making good progress there.

1229
02:48:16.840 --> 02:48:23.019
Brent Blackaby: So, I think my question is, so given that overall we're sort of keeping… we're kind of treading water.

1230
02:48:23.250 --> 02:48:26.059
Brent Blackaby: But we are making real progress in a couple areas.

1231

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02:48:26.510 --> 02:48:34.039
Brent Blackaby: Do we have a sense of where are the areas where we're getting worse? Because a few areas are getting better, then some areas are getting worse, and do we have a sense of what areas those are…

1232
02:48:34.370 --> 02:48:35.410
Brent Blackaby: Getting worse.

1233
02:48:36.440 --> 02:48:37.550
Brent Blackaby: If that makes sense.

1234
02:48:41.040 --> 02:48:58.849
Boardroom: I'll give a, big picture answer, and then for specific program categories, I'll rely on my colleagues to answer. So, there, some of them will probably be facilities, because they have a very, their own, their funding source is really just the general fund, or the CIP fund.

1235
02:48:59.020 --> 02:49:02.130
Boardroom: Which is, they're at the mercy of what's available.

1236
02:49:02.710 --> 02:49:19.449
Boardroom: And the annual baseline, which is not very much for facilities, I believe it is $900,000 annually for our 95 buildings that we manage, which is, getting older as I sit here and talk. And…

1237
02:49:20.520 --> 02:49:23.290
Boardroom: Do you guys want to answer it specifically?

1238
02:49:27.590 --> 02:49:28.990
Boardroom: Go ahead, dude.

1239
02:49:31.380 --> 02:49:42.660
Boardroom: Well, I'll talk regarding IT. So, one of our primary responsibilities is security, and as you know, everyone owns a computer. You gotta buy a new computer every few years. So,

1240
02:49:43.460 --> 02:49:55.720
Boardroom: who are impacted by that, you know, our firewalls and everything, they need to continue to be upgraded. Just the rising cost of subscription software, there's an annual escalator every year, that gets a little bit out of hand.

1241
02:49:55.940 --> 02:50:12.539

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Boardroom: And then we have this little thing called AI coming up, which, you know, as more of us are gonna start to use it, that consumes a lot of server power and things like that. So there's gonna be additional costs in that, just in the licensing, and then how much we're gonna use it, right? So those are the things that come to mind.

1242
02:50:12.540 --> 02:50:25.760
Boardroom: Then you got the other stuff that, just like sewers, right? You don't think about it, but we have fiber that's underground, that deteriorates, and, so we need, just like we need to keep the sewers running, we need to keep those fibers in good shape.

1243
02:50:26.100 --> 02:50:26.840
Boardroom: So…

1244
02:50:27.350 --> 02:50:27.690
Brent Blackaby: Great.

1245
02:50:27.690 --> 02:50:28.420
Boardroom: I'm smiling.

1246
02:50:29.510 --> 02:50:38.099
Brent Blackaby: That's something… over time, I'd love to see, again, understand more of this, and if it's in the full report, I was kind of flipping through it in the full document, it may not be in the…

1247
02:50:38.110 --> 02:50:49.170
Brent Blackaby: in the presentation, maybe if offline someone could point me at those numbers, because I… I am really curious, like, you know, this is one of the things I've kind of… I've… I've been curious about for a while, that, like, because I know, like.

1248
02:50:49.170 --> 02:50:59.000
Brent Blackaby: conceptually, it makes sense. We're investing, but things are atrophying at the same time. And so, it's this question of how much do we actually need to be investing to be moving the needle overall.

1249
02:50:59.040 --> 02:51:12.390
Brent Blackaby: And not just treading water. And, so I'm… I'm really heartened to see that, like, we're investing enough in streets and we're investing enough in sewers that, like, we're, like, as you, on the next slide, we're, like, we're making a big dent in those.

1250
02:51:12.490 --> 02:51:24.519

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Brent Blackaby: But I would just love, not for now necessarily, but offline, to know where things are really getting worse, because those are going to be the next attention areas in the next 5-year CIP, potentially. So, that's one question. Second question is,

1251
02:51:25.180 --> 02:51:28.429
Brent Blackaby: If the infrastructure bond does pass.

1252
02:51:28.640 --> 02:51:39.580
Brent Blackaby: what does that do to the 5-year plan? Would we re-update the plan? Maybe it's a question for the city manager. Would we update the plan? What happens in the middle of the 5-year CIP if the infrastructure bond passes, and how do we make decisions about that?

1253
02:51:41.640 --> 02:51:44.080
Boardroom: Well, we…

1254
02:51:44.240 --> 02:51:57.790
Boardroom: You've seen the project list for the 5-year plan, so that 5-year plan project list would be incorporated into the part of the CIP, and we would be looking at, how do we, how do we bring those new revenues in, and,

1255
02:51:58.010 --> 02:52:07.400
Boardroom: Obviously, we'd have to hire new staff, create new contracts with people to do a lot of that work, and build that into this. So, it would be a process.

1256
02:52:07.870 --> 02:52:22.500
Brent Blackaby: Okay. Okay. But we wouldn't necessarily… we do this every 5 years. We wouldn't necessarily re-update the plan in year 2 or year 3. I mean, we'll have the project list, and we'll know what we're doing, and we'll come back and look at this again in, you know, in the next budget cycle to set the new… the next 5-year plan from there, basically.

1257
02:52:22.500 --> 02:52:22.990
Boardroom: Right.

1258
02:52:22.990 --> 02:52:24.079
Brent Blackaby: Okay, got it.

1259
02:52:24.080 --> 02:52:39.080
Boardroom: to comment on that, it'll generally reduce, I mean, if the bond measure passes, we're talking about in the first 5 years, probably

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spending $100 million. So it's generally going to reduce, I would venture to say, somewhere our unfunded list, between…

1260
02:52:39.210 --> 02:52:43.650
Boardroom: you know, $100 and $150 million. And I think…

1261
02:52:43.790 --> 02:53:01.010
Boardroom: And that increase over 100 is because we know that that funding we could use to leverage for a variety of grants and other, funding sources that are out there. So, you saw earlier with Maricar's graph around,

1262
02:53:02.160 --> 02:53:08.529
Boardroom: the $66 million of current grants that Public Works and Parks is operating out of.

1263
02:53:09.580 --> 02:53:19.950
Boardroom: But, in total in T1, we were able to leverage that $100 million for another $83 million, so we anticipate being able to do the same thing with

1264
02:53:20.110 --> 02:53:21.850
Boardroom: Additional funds.

1265
02:53:22.040 --> 02:53:28.580
Boardroom: There are… many of our grant sources out there require 10, 20, 25, 50% leverage.

1266
02:53:28.710 --> 02:53:35.049
Boardroom: So we'll be able to, make a significant dent in the next 5 years in our unfunded list.

1267
02:53:36.110 --> 02:53:37.130
Boardroom: Can I add…

1268
02:53:37.130 --> 02:53:38.920
Brent Blackaby: Last point, and then… oh, sorry, keep going.

1269
02:53:38.920 --> 02:53:54.180
Boardroom: Councilmember Blackaby, I wanted to also say that, to point out that the attachment, this capital improvement program overview, the last two pages, has a detailed breakdown of the unfunded capital needs by category in the last… in the next five years.

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1270
02:53:54.230 --> 02:54:02.190
Boardroom: And hopefully that will, answer your question. If not, we can definitely provide something, more granular for you if you need to.

1271
02:54:02.190 --> 02:54:20.240
Brent Blackaby: I'll dive into that. That's helpful, thank you. Last thing, I think I mentioned this budget committee. I am concerned that, like, in the out years, we have no new investment in IT. I don't know what our options are there, what we can do, because, again, you know, we invest money in IT, it also helps us save money in operations down the line, so…

1272
02:54:20.590 --> 02:54:31.430
Brent Blackaby: do we have… is it just an allocation decision, kind of a council priority kind of policy thing, if we wanted to move more money into IT, or is that… is there some restriction in terms of the balance of that fund?

1273
02:54:32.060 --> 02:54:50.820
Boardroom: No, it is. It'd be a council prerogative on that, and looking at the IT needs in some of the out years on this plan is something that, you know, we definitely need to sit down with the ID department and get, you know, more… dig into that a little bit more and be able to come back to you all with some concrete proposals.

1274
02:54:51.180 --> 02:54:53.039
Brent Blackaby: Okay, thank you. Thanks, Mayor.

1275
02:54:53.090 --> 02:55:07.549
Boardroom: Thanks. Did you have comments as well? Because I just realized if you have some brief comments just on… specifically on the CIP. Okay. I'm going to come back to Councilmember Taplin then. Thank you. Thank you very much, and thanks to the team here. I've always felt that the CIP never got the attention that it deserves.

1276
02:55:07.580 --> 02:55:26.800
Boardroom: I actually begin every year by reviewing the CIP as I prepare my work plan for the year. I want to commend PRW, PW, and IT for your work on T1 and systems modernization, as well as the grants and awards received. I'm glad the CAMPS Fund is back online and grateful for the capital improvements on the waterfront and at Dreamland.

1277
02:55:26.800 --> 02:55:46.330

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Boardroom: the stormwater improvements to Aquatic Park and elsewhere in the city, the Vision Zero update, the Citywide Traffic Calling Program, and the Strawberry Creek culvert repairs. I know we have a long road ahead of us, with some tough choices that may call for some deep restructuring, but I wanted you to know that you have my support and commitment to ensure that you have the capital resources necessary.

1278
02:55:46.840 --> 02:55:47.610
Boardroom: Thank you.

1279
02:55:47.990 --> 02:55:50.549
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember. Vice Mayor Tracob.

1280
02:55:51.200 --> 02:56:04.120
Boardroom: Sorry, so just to clarify, so folks, you can ask your questions and give some brief comments on CIP now, and then what I want to do is give us, like, a 5-minute stretch break, because I think we've been sitting a long time here, so… go ahead.

1281
02:56:04.570 --> 02:56:14.219
Boardroom: Okay, thank you. I have, 6 questions, and the rest I'll submit in writing.

1282
02:56:14.760 --> 02:56:29.600
Boardroom: Councilmember, you may not have time for all of those questions, so I would prioritize, recommend prioritizing, and keeping anything that you can keep for follow-up briefing. Absolutely. That's my prioritized list. I had 12.

1283
02:56:29.790 --> 02:56:46.679
Boardroom: Otherwise. On slide 27, can you… the North Berkeley Senior Center Road Collision Damage Repair, could you, edify me on what that is, or what precipitated the damage?

1284
02:57:00.130 --> 02:57:06.210
Boardroom: What was the North Berkeley Senior Center damage repair?

1285
02:57:06.640 --> 02:57:26.650
Boardroom: Or collision damage repair? Yeah, I don't have the immediate numbers in front of me, but we had two phases, one, an emergency just to patch things up with temporary infrastructure, and we're going through the contract now with Bros to be able to do the permanent repairs, but the good news is that's not coming out of our funds. We have our

1286

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02:57:26.650 --> 02:57:28.889
Boardroom: operations team that are also working

1287
02:57:28.900 --> 02:57:37.019
Boardroom: And I believe also City Attorney's Office, for insurance claims. So whatever the cost is, they'll be reimbursed through the insurance claim.

1288
02:57:37.460 --> 02:57:46.929
Boardroom: Okay, I'll… I'll follow up offline, on that. Still not clear what the collision was, but…

1289
02:57:47.340 --> 02:58:01.300
Boardroom: I wanted to dig into, I had a broad question around… I think this… in the past, there was alignment between the five… the CIP and the 5-year paving plan.

1290
02:58:01.510 --> 02:58:16.739
Boardroom: And I know you spoke a little bit about this in fights, fights broken out, but, what… can you speak to the alignment or the difference between the two?

1291
02:58:17.180 --> 02:58:33.129
Boardroom: So the alignment is that the 5-year, paving rehabilitation is part of the overall CIP, which, again, also includes Measure FF right now as well, too. It includes all of the paving rehabilitation, safety initiatives, safety projects, sidewalks, and so forth, all inclusive.

1292
02:58:34.090 --> 02:58:35.120
Boardroom: Okay.

1293
02:58:35.500 --> 02:58:47.560
Boardroom: Moving to IT, I had a, could you speak broadly, around… I mean, we…

1294
02:58:48.510 --> 02:58:57.970
Boardroom: we had a referral, from the Council, I understand there is a draft, guidance,

1295
02:58:58.040 --> 02:59:12.240
Boardroom: And then there's a resolution around responsible use of AI. Could you speak to how you're thinking about the integration of AI, and also, talk about which

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1296
02:59:12.500 --> 02:59:25.169
Boardroom: Which aspects of the workflow right now that are public-facing, like when you go pay your bills, still, are in need of,

1297
02:59:25.380 --> 02:59:32.970
Boardroom: Having automation, or being able to, have online payment functionality.

1298
02:59:34.470 --> 02:59:37.279
Boardroom: Okay, let me start with the AI,

1299
02:59:37.520 --> 02:59:48.909
Boardroom: We are in the final steps of publishing an AI administrative regulation. That should be coming out shortly, I hope, and that provides some, good guidance in terms of how we use AI.

1300
02:59:49.140 --> 02:59:58.299
Boardroom: We purposely designed it so it doesn't specifically guide you to a particular AI solution. It guides you in how to properly and responsibly use it.

1301
02:59:58.470 --> 03:00:01.580
Boardroom: We are, internally right now.

1302
03:00:02.240 --> 03:00:12.650
Boardroom: prototyping or proof of concepting on a limited basis, Microsoft's Copilot, because we are already licensed for that under a government cloud license.

1303
03:00:12.650 --> 03:00:25.959
Boardroom: Which, by the way, means that, unlike other AIs, anything that we do within the Copilot AI within the government cloud keeps it within our bubble, so it doesn't share that information. And that's very important, right, because

1304
03:00:25.970 --> 03:00:41.759
Boardroom: If you go to a general public AI and you prompt it with something, you've effectively discussed that topic with somebody else. So the litmus test that we basically follow by is, would you talk to somebody in the streets about what you want to talk about? If the answer is no, you shouldn't use AI.

1305
03:00:41.900 --> 03:00:44.769

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Boardroom: So we're, we're getting close to that.

1306
03:00:44.800 --> 03:01:00.819
Boardroom: And we have to move on that, because many employees are kind of going off on their own, and, you know, we get constant bombardment about, you know, what do you recommend, and honestly, we don't have a recommendation right now, we're working on it ourselves. So hopefully that addresses the, the AI concern.

1307
03:01:00.820 --> 03:01:07.070
Boardroom: In terms of, I think your last question was, more self-service functionality.

1308
03:01:07.070 --> 03:01:26.980
Boardroom: Right? So, I don't know if you were… so we had credit card payments by phone processed by 311 about 2 years ago. That wasn't PCI compliant, so we had to stop doing that. And, the impact on the community was bad because people were complaining, hey, you know, now you're forcing me to either mail in a payment or come in person.

1309
03:01:26.980 --> 03:01:34.789
Boardroom: So… It took a little while, but we managed to implement that credit card payment by phone solution.

1310
03:01:34.800 --> 03:01:51.420
Boardroom: We made it universal, so right now 311 is using it, but we're in a position where we might be able to expand it in the next year to any department, because it's tied in tightly to our phone system. So, other departments, like maybe finance, for example, if they want to start processing it, it's a matter of

1311
03:01:51.520 --> 03:01:55.959
Boardroom: Configuring the phone system to direct it to that solution.

1312
03:01:58.490 --> 03:02:14.510
Boardroom: Is that seamlessly integrated to online payment capability? Like, I know RPP parking, you can now do that online, but I understand from constituents that not all,

1313
03:02:14.520 --> 03:02:30.709
Boardroom: that functionality is limited to certain… Yes, so the solution we have is a universal solution, it's just where we apply it to. So, when we decide to go that direction, we can apply this solution to our PPP payments or whatever, right?

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1314
03:02:32.030 --> 03:02:39.089
Boardroom: Okay, would love to dig in a little more at a later time. But, moving on,

1315
03:02:39.600 --> 03:02:47.410
Boardroom: Right now, I believe you're using two systems. There's Clarity for planning, or…

1316
03:02:47.450 --> 03:03:02.129
Boardroom: for planning, it's being migrated to Clarity, but then a seller is still being used, so, what is the longer-term plan, and I guess, what are the costs

1317
03:03:02.130 --> 03:03:07.839
Boardroom: That we are holding while we're using two separate systems.

1318
03:03:08.090 --> 03:03:18.369
Boardroom: So that is a concern of ours. So yes, the answer is we are using Excela. Accela supports the finance department, planning.

1319
03:03:18.480 --> 03:03:37.200
Boardroom: And who else? Public Works, right? And I think some fire permitting, and environmental health, right? So Accela supports those three departments. Planning is looking at a replacement for Accela to just replace their permitting solution. So that's that…

1320
03:03:37.380 --> 03:03:42.390
Boardroom: $150,000 that we alluded to, that… because we don't know, there's gonna be some integration effort.

1321
03:03:42.450 --> 03:03:54.190
Boardroom: But either way, we are gonna have two systems, because if Clarity goes live, that's just for the planning department. We still need to maintain Excela for, the finance department and the other departments, right?

1322
03:03:54.190 --> 03:04:02.729
Boardroom: So until we… we come up with a better master plan, we're gonna actually end up with two parallel systems.

1323
03:04:03.950 --> 03:04:18.060

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Boardroom: Okay, thank you. And my last question, I have some brief comments, but, funds, did I hear correctly? Funds migration is beginning in FI29?

1324
03:04:18.060 --> 03:04:32.630
Boardroom: No, no, no, no. Funds migration has been going on, and it's going on now, but we have two major modules, which is, parcel tax and land management. Those are the two behemoths that we still need to migrate off of funds.

1325
03:04:32.650 --> 03:04:42.840
Boardroom: So right now, we have sufficient funding in the IT cost allocation to address, some of the smaller modules, like accounts receivable and general billing and customer master.

1326
03:04:42.840 --> 03:04:52.850
Boardroom: But when those are completed, then that's gonna be around FY28-29. We still need to address those last two big modules, which currently is unfunded. And our 680 cost allocation.

1327
03:04:52.850 --> 03:04:58.439
Boardroom: doesn't have the money to pay for that right now. So that's why I raised it in the, the unfunded CIP issue.

1328
03:04:59.120 --> 03:05:02.290
Boardroom: Okay, thank you. And I…

1329
03:05:02.660 --> 03:05:25.709
Boardroom: I know there's more opportunity to dig in. I'll just say that IT needs a dedicated funding stream, and I'm looking forward to, if I have the opportunity to continue this work on the Council, that my intention is to, work with you, kind of focus some of my future efforts.

1330
03:05:25.820 --> 03:05:37.270
Boardroom: in that direction. I firmly believe that, all city departments, including semi-autonomous departments,

1331
03:05:37.920 --> 03:05:58.919
Boardroom: I, I will leave it at that. Need to budget for and pay their fair share in terms of, IT expenditures. On the, on the CIP, I, I really appreciate, the call-out to, to Councilmember Taplin's point, around sometimes.

1332
03:05:58.950 --> 03:06:11.179

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Boardroom: CIP not always getting the, the visibility that it deserves. I, I really appreciated the comprehensive nature of this presentation.

1333
03:06:11.480 --> 03:06:20.160
Boardroom: And we have to continue to prioritize essential infrastructure investments that keep Berkeley safe, accessible, and resilient.

1334
03:06:20.160 --> 03:06:31.500
Boardroom: Repairing and improving streets and sidewalks, upgrading sewer and stormwater systems, and enhancing ADA accessibility throughout public spaces is immensely important.

1335
03:06:31.500 --> 03:06:44.859
Boardroom: And we, of course, live in, earthquake country, and so this plan also advances seismic retrofits and ongoing maintenance of city facilities, along with upgrades to park and recreation amenities.

1336
03:06:44.860 --> 03:07:00.420
Boardroom: As someone who has dedicated the better part of my adult life to working on climate protection and climate justice, I'm really proud that the city is also expanding its commitment to climate action through projects

1337
03:07:00.420 --> 03:07:13.769
Boardroom: focused on building electrification and energy efficiency, and I appreciate how integrated that is, along with resiliency, into the plan. So, thank you so much.

1338
03:07:13.900 --> 03:07:27.529
Boardroom: Councilmember, if I can, your inquiry about the North Berkeley Senior Center wall project, the contract was awarded at $61,168 to, as I mentioned earlier, Bibros Construction.

1339
03:07:27.960 --> 03:07:33.409
Boardroom: And again, the main point of issue there was a vehicle ran into the wall, so while we are making

1340
03:07:33.510 --> 03:07:40.170
Boardroom: repairs to… the location is open, but I believe that regarding hot food, there's still an issue.

1341
03:07:40.340 --> 03:07:50.729

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Boardroom: But once we repair, everything is fully operational. As I mentioned earlier, the city is going for reimbursement through the reinsurance from that resident who ran into it, unfortunately.

1342
03:07:50.900 --> 03:07:53.080
Boardroom: Hope that answers your questions and inquiries.

1343
03:07:54.350 --> 03:08:05.779
Boardroom: It… it answers part of my question. Thank you. Thank you. Councilmember Humber Humbert? Madam Mayor, I don't have any questions, I just have comments, so I can save those for later.

1344
03:08:06.470 --> 03:08:19.499
Boardroom: If you would like on the CIP, though, you're welcome to. Oh, sure. Yeah, okay, thank you. I want to thank all of you sitting up there, our spectacular directors and the staff that works

1345
03:08:19.680 --> 03:08:27.020
Boardroom: with you for this incredible report, and all the work that, you know, that you do, and all the work that went into it.

1346
03:08:27.330 --> 03:08:36.909
Boardroom: I just want to kind of, rhapsodize a little bit. I really appreciate the photos of the great projects that have been completed in your presentation.

1347
03:08:36.990 --> 03:08:48.960
Boardroom: The beautiful stormwater swale facilities that preserve and filter our stormwater include beautiful native grasses and plants. The photo of the recently completed Willard Clubhouse.

1348
03:08:49.120 --> 03:09:08.700
Boardroom: Which I just… I mean, I'm just so… still so thrilled about it. A facility that was designed as LEED Silver, and was awarded LEED Gold, and… and it's garnered incredible numbers of awards. The photos of Southside Complete Streets, the Woolsey-Eaton intersection, which I think is a work of art.

1349
03:09:08.760 --> 03:09:27.450
Boardroom: These are just a few of the great accomplishments recently completed by all of you, and I want to say that I'm thrilled that the Fulton-Woolsey Bike Boulevard improvements have been completed, including the important safety crossing improvements at Shattuck and Woolsey between Districts 8 and 3.

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1350
03:09:27.470 --> 03:09:42.950
Boardroom: I'm thrilled that we're underway with the quick-build safety improvements on the Claremont Avenue corridor. They're happening right now. We're moving toward final design, adoption, and bids on the critical safety improvement at Zachary's Corner, Waring and Derby.

1351
03:09:42.950 --> 03:09:48.240
Boardroom: After an inclusive public process that included Zachary's father and grandmother.

1352
03:09:48.380 --> 03:09:57.720
Boardroom: I see this report shows the work we're going to be able to do to make our streets safer and sidewalks better and safer through Measure FF funds.

1353
03:09:57.720 --> 03:10:13.570
Boardroom: And I'm so grateful that Berkeley residents supported that by an almost supermajority. In D8, I see that we'll finally get to work on the dangerous crossing at Claremont and Eaton, where our D8 resident, Paul Fogel, was so grievously injured several years ago.

1354
03:10:13.660 --> 03:10:27.050
Boardroom: This will be an FFCIP project. I see the first year of the 5-year CIP plan includes an expenditure for commencing the process of designing permanent corridor improvements on Claremont Avenue.

1355
03:10:27.400 --> 03:10:41.299
Boardroom: There will be substantial public outreach on this, of course. I'm thrilled, generally, to see that we'll be spending FF monies on repairing the worst of our sidewalks and the worst of our streets, and specifically some of our streets in the worst

1356
03:10:41.570 --> 03:10:53.439
Boardroom: conditions with PCIs hovering in the single digits, and these are things we weren't able to tackle until FF. So thanks to all of you and your staff.

1357
03:10:53.480 --> 03:11:05.490
Boardroom: for this report, and also to every member of our staff and contractors who have done and will do the work shown in this report. Thank you. Big hound of applause for…

1358
03:11:06.110 --> 03:11:21.330

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Boardroom: All of you. Thank you. Thank you, Councilmember. Councilmember Wrightlett? Thank you, Madam Mayor. I, too, want to thank you all for your work. Your work. These last few years, you've accomplished so much. And with, a very creative process.

1359
03:11:21.730 --> 03:11:27.180
Boardroom: Resources become challenging, constrained, found new buckets of resources, new workflows.

1360
03:11:27.180 --> 03:11:42.049
Boardroom: And, dedicate yourselves to making our city, great, again, if you will. And, so… and you've done a lot of great work in my district, you named it all, and I want to thank you, again. And so I'm curious, though, as we look at…

1361
03:11:42.050 --> 03:11:56.440
Boardroom: sort of the next 5 years, and you know, the… and I wanted to just harken back to Councilmember… Vice Mayor Triggub's, comments. You know, it's a shame that the IT budget is not, vigorous, because, so much of the savings are gonna come from

1362
03:11:56.480 --> 03:12:06.160
Boardroom: Bless you, are gonna come from IT, ultimately. We know this, as we get better processes and more efficiencies and do more, with the new tools we have.

1363
03:12:06.160 --> 03:12:31.070
Boardroom: And then the other savings in the, on the physical side, the CIP, I'm curious about the… the cost trajectories, across these, these different facets of the next few years. I know they're… I know they're protected to go up, they were last, 5 years ago, too. And so I'm looking at the, you know, the… the core, sort of the core components that are, that are subject to inflation, inflationary pressures.

1364
03:12:31.270 --> 03:12:49.689
Boardroom: The concrete, asphalt, electrical components, labor. So I'm wondering, what sort of, sort of structural, issue, structural techniques, structural strategies are we deploying, to kind of get the cost curve?

1365
03:12:49.740 --> 03:12:59.350
Boardroom: Because our buckets of money are, are gonna… are finite. And so I'm wondering what are… are we looking at new forms of procurement?

1366
03:12:59.600 --> 03:13:14.559

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Boardroom: You know, large, procurement, at scale? Is it, new materials that last longer, or new, new things like concrete made of hemp, things like that? You know, I'm curious as to what we're looking at to get at the cost curve.

1367
03:13:18.690 --> 03:13:31.730
Boardroom: I can certainly, I can hand it over to our… my colleagues to chime in. So, unfortunately, as you mentioned, Councilmember, we really don't have too much control as far as inflation. We do have some wild cards as far as the oil prices. Hopefully, they're gonna come down.

1368
03:13:31.760 --> 03:13:47.740
Boardroom: So, there's not too much limitation that we have, and there's… we tend to keep a tight pulse as far as technology and what's trending. Obviously, with GI, we look at pavers, so we have a good, robust toolbox to be able to implement.

1369
03:13:47.930 --> 03:14:00.160
Boardroom: whatever is the most efficient means and methods to treat the location. But the majority of the savings comes with the way we strategize, how we package our contracts, where we do what we work.

1370
03:14:00.200 --> 03:14:14.710
Boardroom: where we compile a lot of infrastructure work at specific locations based on the needs to be able to get competitive costs, meaning, save in mobilization and traffic control costs. So those elements

1371
03:14:14.850 --> 03:14:32.599
Boardroom: from an engineering, construction, project management, construction management perspective, we do have a little bit of wiggle room, and we can be strategic, but unfortunately, to your point, as far as the material cost and escalation, that's not within our limitation or our wheelhouse to be able to control it. But we do look at

1372
03:14:32.600 --> 03:14:43.600
Boardroom: The trends, and we look at how do we competitively get the best pricing by combining projects, by pulling in from all of the adopted plans that we have.

1373
03:14:43.620 --> 03:14:51.549
Boardroom: That is, you know, close to being shovel-ready to be able to get the most infrastructure and maximize the limited funds that we have.

1374
03:14:51.580 --> 03:15:04.549

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Boardroom: And also, to your point for pavement, I think our team, who… a bunch of them are behind me in support for today, the engineering team, Public Works, is in full force behind me, and they're the brains behind all of this.

1375
03:15:04.740 --> 03:15:13.459
Boardroom: We look at, through our engineering lens, where do we have critical, you know, point management, meaning that if we do have infrastructure.

1376
03:15:13.550 --> 03:15:23.340
Boardroom: that if we give a little bit of love today, it'll save us $2 million in 2 years, and we take that route. And that becomes our first and foremost professional recommendation, to be able to

1377
03:15:23.340 --> 03:15:41.529
Boardroom: control costs, to be able to extend the life cycle of our infrastructure that is already aging, so that way it gives us a little bit more flexibility to maneuver and do more within the city with our limited resources. So again, as I mentioned, I want to give huge shout-outs to our engineering team, transportation, who's behind us.

1378
03:15:41.570 --> 03:15:57.959
Boardroom: Because they're, day in, day out, they do this, you know, and try to maximize the limited funds that we have, and roll out as much safety and infrastructure as we can efficiently. Big ups to the team. I'm curious, just as we have, this sort of…

1379
03:15:57.990 --> 03:16:11.950
Boardroom: this jurisdictional spanning energy system here, Ava Energy. Do we ever have that possibility of, sort of, group buying for materials with other jurisdictions to lower the cost by its scale, you know?

1380
03:16:13.370 --> 03:16:14.749
Boardroom: Not a call.

1381
03:16:16.150 --> 03:16:24.780
Boardroom: So, we use a variety of methods to lower our cost, and I think he touched on some of them.

1382
03:16:27.530 --> 03:16:36.330
Boardroom: So, but others of them are making sure our bids are competitive, meaning that there are multiple bids on

1383

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03:16:36.430 --> 03:16:39.630
Boardroom: On our, our,

1384
03:16:40.010 --> 03:16:51.100
Boardroom: On our construction projects, and that… it's always worrisome when you do, a mandatory bid walk, and you have 2 or 3 contractors show up.

1385
03:16:51.630 --> 03:17:10.899
Boardroom: As opposed to 13 or 14, because you know you're going to get a much better price with more contractors. So reaching out to those contractors, making sure they're sure they're all aware of those bids, and quite frankly, a lot of it comes down to the relationship with our project managers. So contractors are willing to bid on projects

1386
03:17:11.150 --> 03:17:17.630
Boardroom: the City of Berkeley, because they know they're gonna work with, oftentimes, very qualified,

1387
03:17:18.560 --> 03:17:22.050
Boardroom: And, efficient project managers.

1388
03:17:22.100 --> 03:17:28.919
Boardroom: And so, that makes their job so much easier if you're working with somebody who can guide you through the process of

1389
03:17:28.920 --> 03:17:46.460
Boardroom: Of the bureaucracy, of our bureaucracy, and construction management and inspection. And we work hand-in-hand with those contractors, so the relationship between our project managers and the contractors is really important, and oftentimes increases the number of bids we get.

1390
03:17:46.670 --> 03:17:49.220
Boardroom: So they're a stable of contractors.

1391
03:17:49.840 --> 03:18:04.489
Boardroom: And right now, you know, what we're seeing, we're in this little lull here where there's… and will be probably for the next few years, where there's not a whole lot of municipal money out there. And so, and a lot of my peers are talking about, hey.

1392
03:18:04.660 --> 03:18:08.990
Boardroom: The projects that they are bidding out are coming back.

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1393
03:18:09.120 --> 03:18:22.209
Boardroom: you know, around the engineer's estimate, and are much more predictable than they have been in the last 2 to 3 years, because there's less municipal projects out there. And that will be… it'll be that way for the next, probably.

1394
03:18:22.210 --> 03:18:32.500
Boardroom: 4 to 6 years. And so we've got a window where we can roll out as many projects as we're going to be more competitive. And so that… those… all those type of things keep our prices down.

1395
03:18:34.240 --> 03:18:42.680
Boardroom: you know, the Santa Fe right-of-way bid, which I was talking about earlier, came back in today. We had a lot of very competitive bids, and we had…

1396
03:18:42.710 --> 03:18:54.620
Boardroom: several of those bids that were below our construction estimated cost. But it's because we had a fair amount of bidders there, and people were looking for work.

1397
03:18:54.800 --> 03:19:14.019
Boardroom: So, all those factors go into what, you know, how the contractor sharpens their pencil. Okay, last question here. And on this bid topic, too, have we had any, any sense that the new entities envisioned under the Birth Inclusion Diversity Index

1398
03:19:14.020 --> 03:19:20.910
Boardroom: Have any of these new companies been applying? Have they been competitive? Have they been partnering with some of the existing legacy companies? Just curious.

1399
03:19:22.560 --> 03:19:24.340
Boardroom: We've seen more…

1400
03:19:25.160 --> 03:19:31.630
Boardroom: A much more variety of companies, and a lot of newer companies bidding on our projects than ever before.

1401
03:19:33.050 --> 03:19:44.740
Boardroom: Yeah, as an example, our current fiscal year 26 paving project that just went out is hitting the streets. This… the contractor who won the competitive bidding is new.

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1402
03:19:44.990 --> 03:19:51.589
Boardroom: So, a lot of times, it was a previous contractor that, was awarded, but this time around, it is a new…

1403
03:19:51.840 --> 03:19:59.000
Boardroom: contractor, again, they were… went through the public bidding process, they were the most qualified, responsive, responsible bidder.

1404
03:19:59.190 --> 03:20:00.949
Boardroom: We're looking forward to working with them.

1405
03:20:02.450 --> 03:20:05.860
Boardroom: Very good, thank you, thanks for the question. Councilmember O'Keefe.

1406
03:20:07.020 --> 03:20:11.010
Boardroom: I forgot I pressed the button. Just a quick appreciation,

1407
03:20:11.660 --> 03:20:21.870
Boardroom: It's a thought that I had during the presentation, which was, what, 40 slides? It was very long, but that's… that's not a criticism. I want to say that in recognition for how…

1408
03:20:22.350 --> 03:20:27.540
Boardroom: complex… Of a system this represents.

1409
03:20:27.600 --> 03:20:37.350
Boardroom: And I was really struck somewhere during the presentation that, like, each… each single slide represents an unbelievable amount of person hours.

1410
03:20:37.350 --> 03:20:48.469
Boardroom: for whatever projects were depicted on the slide. And I was just, like, when I kind of thought of that, and then there's, like, 40 slides, it was just incredible how much work has been done, and what we're looking at today is

1411
03:20:48.470 --> 03:20:59.490
Boardroom: how well-organized and executed it is, because it's a really, really complicated thing to manage, so I just wanted to give props to all of you, and City Manager, and every… all the people who execute. It's really, I'm very impressed.

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1412
03:20:59.890 --> 03:21:16.539
Boardroom: And, that was my general appreciation. I have a very specific appreciation, which is for, Acting Director Amiri, thank you so much for putting McGee on the FF paving plan. It's a small, seemingly random street, but it's, like, basically rocks.

1413
03:21:16.540 --> 03:21:32.439
Boardroom: And the residents are very appreciative, so that's all. Thank you so much. Again, I want to give the credit to Measure FF team, transportation, Engineering, and honestly, it gave us an opportunity for, like, what I call the 360 perspective, to be able to look at all of our network, where

1414
03:21:32.440 --> 03:21:41.580
Boardroom: street segments that were missed for 30 years, they have an opportunity now. As they all pay their taxes, this gives them an opportunity for a fresh pavement, and also.

1415
03:21:41.580 --> 03:21:48.070
Boardroom: It safeguards the road for bicyclists, pedestrians, you know, strollers, because when you're in gravel.

1416
03:21:48.200 --> 03:21:56.560
Boardroom: That's not a safe means of travel path. I think if I tried to ride my bicycle on that road, I think it would destroy the entire thing, so…

1417
03:21:57.930 --> 03:22:00.589
Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember Kesarwani.

1418
03:22:03.900 --> 03:22:21.500
Rashi Kesarwani: Thank you very much, Madam Mayor. I, I just, you know, this is actually my second time getting this presentation, because we did receive it at the Budget and Finance Committee as well, so I just want to thank you again, for all of the detail that is presented here.

1419
03:22:21.500 --> 03:22:29.079
Rashi Kesarwani: And I, specifically wanted to call out the work on streets. I know you did already, you know, talking about that

1420
03:22:29.080 --> 03:22:33.430
Rashi Kesarwani: 8 million general fund increase

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1421
03:22:33.590 --> 03:22:43.719
Rashi Kesarwani: I authored that, and I just want to take us down memory lane, because when I first got on the council back in 2019,

1422
03:22:43.940 --> 03:22:52.129
Rashi Kesarwani: 2020, we would pass our 5-year paving plan, and our Public Works Director at the time

1423
03:22:52.240 --> 03:23:05.969
Rashi Kesarwani: would tell us, and he sort of glossed over it, and that's not a criticism, because we were always in the habit of seeing our pavement condition index decline every time we approved the 5-year paving plan.

1424
03:23:06.290 --> 03:23:15.660
Rashi Kesarwani: And, the reason for that is because we were not investing enough general fund resources to actually see the pavement condition index improve.

1425
03:23:15.970 --> 03:23:33.600
Rashi Kesarwani: And I really zeroed in on that, and recognized that as a major problem. Others did as well, you know, I don't want to take singular credit, and I really wanted to see us commit more general fund dollars to that, and we made that commitment, and I want to thank the advocates

1426
03:23:33.800 --> 03:23:36.770
Rashi Kesarwani: who rallied around Measure FF,

1427
03:23:37.090 --> 03:23:51.899
Rashi Kesarwani: to draft that and collect the signatures and get it on the ballot. What that measure does, as this presentation shows, it doubles down and gives us even more resources so that people

1428
03:23:52.050 --> 03:24:01.169
Rashi Kesarwani: Who live on McGee. That used to be District 1, it's now District 5. I'm happy to hand it over, and I'm even happier to see it.

1429
03:24:01.490 --> 03:24:20.990
Rashi Kesarwani: finally get repaved. We had Holly Street that was in similar condition, and we worked to get that one repaved a couple years ago. So… and I did want to briefly mention that Measure FF has language in it that says, if we don't continue to do the $8 million general fund commitment.

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1430
03:24:21.050 --> 03:24:38.470
Rashi Kesarwani: that that parcel tax revenue will also go down. And I really appreciate that, because I feel very confident that it has… it has really locked in that general fund commitment. And this is really hard stuff, because think about the deficit that we're in right now.

1431
03:24:38.470 --> 03:24:47.779
Rashi Kesarwani: It would have been… if we didn't have that guarantee in FF that we cannot pull these dollars, it would have been really tempting, and that's what prior councils did.

1432
03:24:47.790 --> 03:24:52.720
Rashi Kesarwani: Reduce the investment in capital, streets that we all use every single day.

1433
03:24:52.800 --> 03:25:00.550
Rashi Kesarwani: to close deficits. You know, that's really a big part of why we're in the unfunded

1434
03:25:00.790 --> 03:25:09.819
Rashi Kesarwani: deferred maintenance, right, of a lot of our capital. So, I mean, a lot of cities have this problem, though. You know, it's… things are…

1435
03:25:09.960 --> 03:25:26.019
Rashi Kesarwani: you know, things, wear out and degrade, and the costs continue to grow. So we have this problem, and so I just feel like there… despite the 1.8… I think you said $1.8 billion, right, of unfunded infrastructure liability.

1436
03:25:26.020 --> 03:25:36.289
Rashi Kesarwani: I really think that there's a bright spot here for our streets and the sidewalks, and then we have our $300 million general obligation bond that the voters will

1437
03:25:36.840 --> 03:25:53.870
Rashi Kesarwani: we'll take a look at and hopefully, authorize so that we can do more, do more of all of this work that we all benefit from as a community. So, thank you again, and, really glad to see where we are on the streets, especially.

1438
03:25:54.630 --> 03:26:00.390

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Boardroom: If I can add, thanks to Measure FF and the approach that we're taking between the baseline two programs.

1439
03:26:00.820 --> 03:26:11.849
Boardroom: We run some modeling, and our 12-year projections, they show that our PCI as a whole network throughout the city will be in the 60s. So that's a huge accomplishment. That's only 12 years, and again.

1440
03:26:11.970 --> 03:26:22.219
Boardroom: That goes based on the framework that we're addressing the city complete network, so that's great. I mean, as I said earlier, we're definitely heading in the right direction, and kudos.

1441
03:26:22.260 --> 03:26:34.300
Boardroom: to council members who made the $8 million decision. As I said, we're still not in the 70s, but hey, we're in a great place in the 60s and 12 years, that's great. We just gotta keep heading in that direction.

1442
03:26:34.430 --> 03:26:50.279
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes, and just quickly, Mr. Amiri, for people who don't know what 60s mean, I mean, that's a bad grade, but, you know, on a test, but 60s here, because we… just translate that. That's not very good, but is it, like, good or fair?

1443
03:26:50.280 --> 03:27:11.389
Boardroom: It's very good for where we're at right now. When you think about PCI of 6, and when the sweeper goes by and the dust cloud comes up in a, you know, established corridor, I think, as I said, we're heading in the right direction. Again, it shows a commitment from the residents, from council.

1444
03:27:11.390 --> 03:27:16.500
Boardroom: to, again, provide the resources so we can deliver the goods. So, kudos to all of you guys.

1445
03:27:16.500 --> 03:27:23.969
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes, and because also, just really quickly, I know it's getting late, we have another big item to do. When you're at 6,

1446
03:27:24.050 --> 03:27:34.870
Rashi Kesarwani: You know, in the past, we would tell you, well, we're really sorry, tough luck now, because your street is in such bad condition that it would be too expensive.

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1447
03:27:34.870 --> 03:27:54.759
Rashi Kesarwani: to fully repair your street, to fully reconstruct your street. And so, we need to put ourselves in a position where we're not letting things get to that point, right? That I think we have that cost curve for streets, right? Where a dollar early saves $8 later on the reconstruct.

1448
03:27:54.760 --> 03:28:07.369
Rashi Kesarwani: So that's why we did the $8 million. You know, we're trying to save money by maintaining, and I think that's where we're gonna be, and so I'm really, I'm really pleased to see that.

1449
03:28:08.090 --> 03:28:10.560
Boardroom: Thank you. Moving on to Councilmember Lunopara.

1450
03:28:11.940 --> 03:28:19.309
Boardroom: Thank you. I don't have any questions, I just… I really want to thank all of the people who have worked on this,

1451
03:28:19.750 --> 03:28:27.170
Boardroom: And I… during the conversation, I was reminded of the origins of Measure FF, and…

1452
03:28:27.400 --> 03:28:41.469
Boardroom: how three of us, after the failure of Measure L, came up with this idea, and it was a couple of 20-somethings that cared enough about this that started it, but it was so many people along the way that… that…

1453
03:28:41.530 --> 03:28:51.740
Boardroom: that worked on the campaign, that volunteered, that voted for it, and now it's the work of our incredible staff that's going to implement it. So I just…

1454
03:28:52.020 --> 03:28:54.669
Boardroom: I'm very grateful for all of that. Thanks.

1455
03:28:55.140 --> 03:29:00.489
Boardroom: Thank you so much. I just have some comments. Again, thank you all so much for your presentation.

1456
03:29:03.310 --> 03:29:05.540
Boardroom: Sure. Okay.

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1457
03:29:05.730 --> 03:29:11.260
Boardroom: I'm gonna interrupt myself and open up the public hearing on the… on the budget.

1458
03:29:13.150 --> 03:29:15.440
Boardroom: Thanks. Thanks, Mark.

1459
03:29:15.440 --> 03:29:36.309
Boardroom: Alright, so, I mean, you all know infrastructure is one of my top priorities, and I'm very proud of all the work that we've done here, especially on our T1 projects, it's already been mentioned, I guess, but new Willard Clubhouse, restrooms and lighting in Ohlone Park, Civic Center Upper Plaza, the dock repairs, and so much more has really improved the quality of life for our residents, and also for our visitors.

1460
03:29:36.310 --> 03:29:56.879
Boardroom: We've completely, we've completed safety projects on several intersections and streets in Berkeley, working towards our Complete Streets goals. I see these projects every single day as I go around the city, and I hear from people in the community that they see it too. So I know that you all don't get to hear appreciation all the time, but know that the public really does appreciate your work.

1461
03:29:56.880 --> 03:30:11.950
Boardroom: And, you know, we've done so much here, and I know there's a lot more to do. I know that, as Mari Kar was saying, the end of the presentation's a little bit hard, because there is so much to do, and yet I know that we're really working on chipping away at this, and, that…

1462
03:30:11.950 --> 03:30:21.879
Boardroom: I really see that the next steps that we're moving forward, will get us in a good spot in really making significant, work of this,

1463
03:30:21.940 --> 03:30:27.270
Boardroom: this great need. As my colleagues have also said, I'm committed to addressing

1464
03:30:27.590 --> 03:30:39.230
Boardroom: funded and unfunded capital improvement needs, and I know that this will take many years to get to the point where we're adequately maintaining our infrastructure versus just crisis management, which I know is what folks feel like it is right now.

1465

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03:30:39.230 --> 03:30:56.920
Boardroom: We've done a really amazing job at leveraging funding. You all have done an amazing job of leveraging funding, and I want to make sure that we're continuing to do that, and that's why it's so important that we set aside funding from our general fund, and also, of course, that we are supporting this infrastructure bond that's coming up as well.

1466
03:30:57.670 --> 03:31:05.659
Boardroom: Because this will really address some of our most urgent needs, while also investing in capital projects that are critical to ensuring that Berkeley continues to thrive.

1467
03:31:05.790 --> 03:31:29.720
Boardroom: I also, you know, just want to thank everyone for just the work that we have coming up, because, of course, this is the plan. Once we approve it, there's work to do here, so, I just want to say thank you again. Thank you to all of you, thank you so much to your staff, thank you to everyone who put this presentation together. It's a massive lift, and my staff and I have really spent a lot of time with it. It's my second time hearing it, and I just feel more grateful the second time around.

1468
03:31:29.880 --> 03:31:34.249
Boardroom: So, thank you all. We are gonna take a…

1469
03:31:35.290 --> 03:31:42.669
Boardroom: I think we need to take a 10-minute stretch break, because we've been sitting a long time. So we're gonna take a 10-minute stretch break, and we're gonna come back, and…

1470
03:31:42.770 --> 03:31:50.279
Boardroom: The, we're… the city manager will go over his budget, or his staff will. I'll present, my…

1471
03:31:52.270 --> 03:32:05.430
Boardroom: Clearly, we need this break, because… Yeah, I'm gonna present my amendments, and then, we will have council questions, public comment, and then council comments. So, 10 minutes, we'll be back. Thank you.

1472
03:32:17.370 --> 03:32:18.610
Boardroom: Alright.

1473
03:32:20.640 --> 03:32:23.139
Boardroom: We need to stick around? There.

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1474
03:32:24.200 --> 03:32:25.380
Boardroom: I'll turn this on.

1475
03:32:37.700 --> 03:32:53.069
Boardroom: Thanks for your statement. So I want to ask the City Clerk, you know,

1476
03:33:08.350 --> 03:33:32.219
Boardroom: So, you know, I don't want to make a big scene about it, but it is quite dramatic how much… and it was actually not unlike this across… I knew they were coming, and I thought, you know, that's our Thursday, we can't park.

1477
03:33:32.220 --> 03:33:44.410
Boardroom: It's really something. So, anyway, I don't know if I need to be here. You know, I think, I mean, I am so grateful for all that you and Mary Wolf does.

1478
03:33:44.900 --> 03:34:03.780
Boardroom: Yeah, but do you have an intervening… do you have an intervening item about the smaller stroll, no? I'll keep my fingers crossed.

1479
03:34:04.120 --> 03:34:28.760
Boardroom: Anyway, I'm confident. But there's another hearing next week. Yeah, yeah. Which will be here, right? Yeah, okay, I'll be here. Okay, thank you.

1480
03:35:24.490 --> 03:35:26.870
Boardroom: We also live down too long.

1481
03:35:33.870 --> 03:35:47.080
Boardroom: But you're gonna talk?

1482
03:36:05.890 --> 03:36:18.160
Boardroom: I saw that I had no idea.

1483
03:39:57.490 --> 03:40:03.799
Boardroom: Okay, thanks everyone. Thank you for your patience.

1484
03:40:04.040 --> 03:40:08.610
Boardroom: All right. Coming back into session.

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1485
03:40:08.780 --> 03:40:14.859
Boardroom: Thank you so much. I'm gonna pass it over to our city manager to present us with his budget.

1486
03:40:15.800 --> 03:40:17.240
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor.

1487
03:40:17.440 --> 03:40:27.820
Boardroom: I'll be brief, and then I'll hand it over to Budget Manager Mark Dupaya. We have a short slide, a short deck, 10 slides, 10 minutes,

1488
03:40:27.990 --> 03:40:37.069
Boardroom: You know, reaching… getting into the final lap of what's been a very long and hard budget process, that we started many months ago.

1489
03:40:37.570 --> 03:40:55.630
Boardroom: With the idea that we would work as hard as we could to minimize the impact of a very significant, nearly $30 million structural deficit, on both the services and programs and impacts that are felt by residents, and also on impacts to our staff.

1490
03:40:55.750 --> 03:41:00.659
Boardroom: And it has been a very hard journey. We are…

1491
03:41:00.780 --> 03:41:10.419
Boardroom: Proposing to eliminate 183 positions from the budget, including fiscal year 26, and then the two years that we're talking about tonight.

1492
03:41:10.730 --> 03:41:22.179
Boardroom: And I'm proud to say that while it is deeply painful to lay off any staff, we have really focused hard on making that number as small as possible.

1493
03:41:22.410 --> 03:41:27.579
Boardroom: Of that 183 staff, about 20 are filled positions who are on the layoff list.

1494
03:41:28.190 --> 03:41:39.630
Boardroom: Our Human Resources Department Director, Janelle Rodriguez, and her team have worked very hard to, to make that number smaller.

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1495
03:41:40.080 --> 03:41:43.689
Boardroom: Some people ha- some people will be,

1496
03:41:44.160 --> 03:41:50.510
Boardroom: We'll be bumping into vacant positions, so that 20 will go down to approximately 14.

1497
03:41:50.870 --> 03:42:10.370
Boardroom: And of the 14, she and her team are working very hard in partnership with our labor partners, who have been very good partners throughout this process, on, on a flexible placement program whereby, we've frozen hiring, in most, classifications and positions to.

1498
03:42:11.160 --> 03:42:23.580
Boardroom: Preserve the opportunity for people to move into jobs that are vacant, even if they are not in the same classification in which they currently reside, as long as they meet the minimum qualifications.

1499
03:42:23.580 --> 03:42:40.009
Boardroom: That is a… that will be a voluntary offer that is made to people who are in that category, and I really do want to extend my thanks to our HR Director, Janelle Rodriguez, and her team, who've been working very hard to go through that tremendous amount of analysis and work to

1500
03:42:40.020 --> 03:42:45.399
Boardroom: Minimize, to the greatest extent possible, the impacts to our staff.

1501
03:42:45.720 --> 03:42:58.449
Boardroom: And prevent as many people as possible from losing a job. So, it has been a hard period. I really want to also extend thanks to Deputy City Manager David White, who's done a tremendous, tremendous amount of work.

1502
03:42:58.860 --> 03:43:03.110
Boardroom: Our budget manager, Mark Hardupai, who's done a tremendous amount of work, as well as her

1503
03:43:03.350 --> 03:43:12.979
Boardroom: Her small team. It's a very small team who put in a lot of hours, and, will continue to put in a lot of hours until we wrap this whole thing up over the next…

1504

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03:43:13.150 --> 03:43:19.559
Boardroom: week or so here. So, with that, I will turn it over to Marikar to walk through the slide deck.

1505
03:43:22.690 --> 03:43:23.820
Boardroom: Thank you, Paul.

1506
03:43:25.160 --> 03:43:27.620
Boardroom: My laptop's not working, so bear with me.

1507
03:43:28.950 --> 03:43:35.470
Boardroom: This is just a recap of what we proposed, and presented, on May 19th.

1508
03:43:35.620 --> 03:43:40.709
Boardroom: To the full council, the proposed fiscal year 27 and 28 annual budget.

1509
03:43:41.200 --> 03:43:42.679
Boardroom: Next slide, please, Mark.

1510
03:43:46.970 --> 03:43:56.730
Boardroom: So the purpose of overview, the purpose of this is to have a public hearing number 2 on the proposed biannual budget and 5-year CIP.

1511
03:43:57.430 --> 03:44:04.509
Boardroom: Continued discussion on the proposed fiscal year 27 and 28 budget, as well as the 5-year CIP that you just heard.

1512
03:44:04.970 --> 03:44:12.249
Boardroom: And of course, it allows for City Council and public input, to allow for adoption of a balanced budget.

1513
03:44:12.440 --> 03:44:16.049
Boardroom: Scheduled on June 23rd, 2026.

1514
03:44:16.370 --> 03:44:17.889
Boardroom: The short slide will.

1515
03:44:18.190 --> 03:44:26.149
Boardroom: cover a recap of the proposed biennial budget, as well as some tech, you know, technical changes since May 19th.

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1516
03:44:27.900 --> 03:44:29.250
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

1517
03:44:30.880 --> 03:44:31.660
Boardroom: I love that.

1518
03:44:32.590 --> 03:44:35.659
Boardroom: Apologies for this, very small font.

1519
03:44:35.770 --> 03:44:44.779
Boardroom: Budget engagement timeline. This is just to show you that how we have been extremely engaged throughout this whole biennial budget development process.

1520
03:44:44.860 --> 03:45:01.810
Boardroom: We started way before January 2026, but just wanted to highlight what's been happening the past 6 months. We've had, budget and finance policy committees throughout. The very first time, we presented an update of the 27-28

1521
03:45:02.190 --> 03:45:16.319
Boardroom: Proposing the baseline, presenting the baseline budget. February 2026, we received a general fund revenue update from our finance director, as well as an overview of revenue enhancements.

1522
03:45:17.310 --> 03:45:23.039
Boardroom: We also have an overview of our fund, CIP fund, which is when we,

1523
03:45:23.290 --> 03:45:30.279
Boardroom: Propose and share that it does not have enough, funding balance, and it's expecting a structural deficit.

1524
03:45:30.730 --> 03:45:41.100
Boardroom: April 2026 is when it really picked up. We had a budget, and finance policy committee where we had charter officers' budget reduction plans.

1525
03:45:41.350 --> 03:45:46.929
Boardroom: And also, we had the overview of the 27 and 28 proposed budget balancing plan.

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1526
03:45:47.400 --> 03:45:50.750
Boardroom: As well as, budget referrals.

1527
03:45:52.460 --> 03:45:54.419
Boardroom: May 2026.

1528
03:45:54.680 --> 03:46:13.700
Boardroom: Couple more Budget and Finance Policy Committee, meeting. We presented the proposed biannual budget. We also presented the proposed 5-year CIP and a budget referral to Sonest Stroll. And on May 19th, as mentioned, we presented to the full council the 27-28 proposed budget.

1529
03:46:13.870 --> 03:46:20.640
Boardroom: And here we are now in June. We've had two Budget and Finance Policy Committee meetings, on the 11th, the Mayor's proposed budget.

1530
03:46:20.740 --> 03:46:23.280
Boardroom: And the Community Agency Contracting Overview.

1531
03:46:23.410 --> 03:46:31.150
Boardroom: And tonight, we're here to continue discussion on the budget, as well as we presented the 5-year CIP to you.

1532
03:46:31.250 --> 03:46:43.700
Boardroom: And next Tuesday, is the adoption of the proposed biannual budget and the 5-year CIP, as well as our fiscal year 2027, annual appropriation ordinance.

1533
03:46:44.920 --> 03:46:46.910
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

1534
03:46:49.300 --> 03:47:02.079
Boardroom: I just wanted to really briefly go over… I'm sure you know this already, but our fiscal context of impacts and unknowns. We mentioned already that we are experiencing a structural deficit and challenges, not only in the general fund.

1535
03:47:02.210 --> 03:47:16.260
Boardroom: Which is what we have mainly focused on, but also in our special funds, like parking funds, marina, and our CIP fund. There's a rising cost in personnel, pension, healthcare, and our liability insurance.

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1536
03:47:16.550 --> 03:47:32.259
Boardroom: As well as labor negotiations, inflation, I think it went up 4.2%, which is the highest, I believe, since 2023, and we don't know how far… how high it's gonna go still. Our historical reliance on one-time sources.

1537
03:47:32.700 --> 03:47:40.289
Boardroom: We still, our fiscal year 2026 year end results are still pending, so we don't know how we're gonna end fiscal year 26.

1538
03:47:40.670 --> 03:47:47.830
Boardroom: And we just did a whole presentation in front of you about deferred maintenance and significant Unfunded infrastructure needs.

1539
03:47:48.240 --> 03:47:51.730
Boardroom: Increased service demands and community expectations.

1540
03:47:52.510 --> 03:48:02.489
Boardroom: Of course, our November 2026 ballot measures, both local and statewide, that could impact our budget significantly going forward. And…

1541
03:48:03.030 --> 03:48:09.719
Boardroom: Last, but certainly not least, State, federal revenue limitations, economic and political uncertainty.

1542
03:48:10.270 --> 03:48:11.759
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

1543
03:48:13.140 --> 03:48:18.010
Boardroom: Just want to emphasize again that when we started this budget development.

1544
03:48:18.280 --> 03:48:23.450
Boardroom: The goal is a structurally balanced, budget that protects core services.

1545
03:48:23.690 --> 03:48:26.520
Boardroom: Reduces reliance on one-time funds.

1546
03:48:27.180 --> 03:48:31.290
Boardroom: And sets the foundation for long-term fiscal sustainability.

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1547
03:48:32.080 --> 03:48:37.679
Boardroom: We did that by, first and foremost, establishing our 27-28 baseline budget.

1548
03:48:38.030 --> 03:48:40.280
Boardroom: By using actuals.

1549
03:48:40.480 --> 03:48:43.409
Boardroom: Plus, service needs going forward.

1550
03:48:44.960 --> 03:48:55.789
Boardroom: Budget Balancing Framework. After the revenue and expenditure adjustments, the general fund deficit ranged from $31.3 million in 27 to $29.5 in 28.

1551
03:48:56.190 --> 03:48:59.150
Boardroom: Then there was an immense citywide effort.

1552
03:48:59.440 --> 03:49:02.880
Boardroom: To reduce 10 to 12.5% of general fund.

1553
03:49:03.050 --> 03:49:04.660
Boardroom: baseline budget.

1554
03:49:04.960 --> 03:49:10.120
Boardroom: Other fund-specific fixes that are also in structural deficit, and revenue ideas.

1555
03:49:10.640 --> 03:49:15.130
Boardroom: This included strategic cost shifts, non-departmental refinements.

1556
03:49:15.410 --> 03:49:19.389
Boardroom: And requires debt service support and parking fund stabilization.

1557
03:49:21.250 --> 03:49:34.910
Boardroom: Even though we say that we want to move away from relying on one-time resources, there are strategic times where it must be done, and as long as you use it, if it's a one-time source, it must be used for a one-time need.

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1558
03:49:35.210 --> 03:49:44.210
Boardroom: So the use of one-time resources in fiscal year 27, we have identified $12.06 million of one-time funds used to smooth out the deficits.

1559
03:49:44.800 --> 03:49:51.550
Boardroom: And this is being used to sustain services in public safety, youth, and adult programs in fiscal year 27.

1560
03:49:51.900 --> 03:49:56.550
Boardroom: Until the outcome of a potential November 2026 sales tax measure is known.

1561
03:49:58.260 --> 03:49:59.680
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

1562
03:50:02.720 --> 03:50:08.989
Boardroom: This was also part of the May 19th slide, presentation, but the General Fund Budget Balancing Phase Recap

1563
03:50:09.300 --> 03:50:18.979
Boardroom: We started off, the initial was $32.3 million in 27. With an updated revenue, it became $27.14.

1564
03:50:19.660 --> 03:50:23.489
Boardroom: And, as I mentioned, there's the, adjustments that happened.

1565
03:50:23.940 --> 03:50:29.799
Boardroom: And our total deficit before one-time use of resources in 27 was $33.3.

1566
03:50:30.960 --> 03:50:35.699
Boardroom: We used $2.1 million of that to smooth out the 27 and 28.

1567
03:50:35.930 --> 03:50:45.840
Boardroom: So it'll be easier to develop a budget, a balanced budget. In 27, we ended with a general fund deficit after revenue and expenditure adjustment of $29.2.

1568
03:50:46.020 --> 03:50:49.910
Boardroom: In 28, we started with $33.2 million deficit.

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1569
03:50:50.460 --> 03:50:55.410
Boardroom: After revised, revenue projection, 20… almost $25 million.

1570
03:50:55.640 --> 03:51:07.040
Boardroom: And all of the changes and adjustments, we ended with 29.5. So those two bottom numbers were the numbers that we were working with when we initiated the budget balancing exercise for the whole organization.

1571
03:51:07.320 --> 03:51:08.869
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

1572
03:51:12.990 --> 03:51:20.609
Boardroom: Proposed revised changes all funds revenue, so there are some technical changes that happened from the amounts that we proposed and presented on May 19th.

1573
03:51:22.510 --> 03:51:29.120
Boardroom: I will not go over every single slide, every single one. There's a summary page on the next, couple of slides.

1574
03:51:29.300 --> 03:51:38.050
Boardroom: But overall, there's, a variance of $13.7 million from the numbers, from May 19th to now.

1575
03:51:38.840 --> 03:51:40.310
Boardroom: On the revenue side?

1576
03:51:40.540 --> 03:51:41.919
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

1577
03:51:44.940 --> 03:51:56.889
Boardroom: And on the all-funds expenditure side, some of the technical changes that happened, resulted in about an $11.6 million change from the amounts proposed on May 19th to now.

1578
03:51:57.160 --> 03:52:01.100
Boardroom: And in 2028, it is, $6.6 million.

1579
03:52:02.260 --> 03:52:04.300
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

1580

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03:52:06.370 --> 03:52:09.000
Boardroom: This is a summary of the proposed all funds.

1581
03:52:10.150 --> 03:52:17.909
Boardroom: So the 2027 original proposed for May 19th, the revenue was cited as $772.1 million.

1582
03:52:18.200 --> 03:52:22.640
Boardroom: The 27 revised today is $785.8 million.

1583
03:52:23.210 --> 03:52:31.400
Boardroom: The expenditure was $905.2 million. The revised proposed is now $916.8.

1584
03:52:32.680 --> 03:52:49.209
Boardroom: In the 2028 proposed original, on May 19th, the revenue was $773.4 million, the revised is $788.2. On the expenditure side, it's $865 million, and the revised proposed is $871.8.

1585
03:52:49.210 --> 03:52:59.810
Boardroom: On the staffing side, it was 1,600.84 FTEs. The revised is an increase of 2, so 1,606.84.

1586
03:53:00.270 --> 03:53:03.469
Boardroom: And it's the same number, in 2028.

1587
03:53:03.880 --> 03:53:08.980
Boardroom: So, the changes from the 519-26 reflects capturing capital grants.

1588
03:53:09.130 --> 03:53:11.120
Boardroom: And other capital funding.

1589
03:53:11.500 --> 03:53:17.530
Boardroom: That were not included in the 20… in the May 19th, proposed amounts.

1590
03:53:17.710 --> 03:53:29.010
Boardroom: Also, we did not yet know what the consumer price index and personal income growth rates were going to be. They were not yet available on 519, and they are now, so we adjusted for that.

1591

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03:53:29.290 --> 03:53:37.900
Boardroom: And also, the REN board budget approved, their budget by its board, so we had to implement that as well and incorporate that in the budget.

1592
03:53:38.740 --> 03:53:43.430
Boardroom: Detailed explanation of the changes can be found in the schedule of changes in the attachments.

1593
03:53:44.140 --> 03:53:48.149
Boardroom: The 27 and 28 staffing count that increased to 2.

1594
03:53:48.610 --> 03:53:54.969
Boardroom: It's due to the Rent Board's additional 1, OS3, and one project-based assistant planner.

1595
03:53:55.400 --> 03:53:57.670
Boardroom: Position had to exceed 3 years.

1596
03:53:59.060 --> 03:54:00.659
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

1597
03:54:02.960 --> 03:54:09.179
Boardroom: This is the proposed general fund summary. Nothing's changed on the revenue side, on the expenditure side.

1598
03:54:09.570 --> 03:54:14.489
Boardroom: It is now $313.8 million in 2027.

1599
03:54:14.670 --> 03:54:26.099
Boardroom: And in 2028, it is now $319.5 million. And that can be explained, the change in the expenditure stems from the part of the City Auditor's budget balancing plan.

1600
03:54:26.270 --> 03:54:39.479
Boardroom: That were not reflected in the May 19th, 26 numbers that the Budget Office caught and have now put into the proposed amount. The general fund staffing count, increased by 0.5,

1601
03:54:39.660 --> 03:54:48.350
Boardroom: And that is, again, due to the Rent Board's, additional 2 FTEs. And 1.5 of that is their special funds, and 0.5 of that is

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1602
03:54:48.500 --> 03:54:49.859
Boardroom: is general fund.

1603
03:54:50.020 --> 03:54:58.630
Boardroom: But it does not increase their general fund allocation. I just wanted to point that out. What they did was they decreased their non-personnel that they get from the general fund.

1604
03:54:58.770 --> 03:55:00.830
Boardroom: And moved that up to their personnel.

1605
03:55:02.150 --> 03:55:15.340
Boardroom: So that concludes this very short presentation. Again, the point of this is to continue our discussion and provide comments on the proposed budget, as well as the proposed 5-year CIP. Thank you very much.

1606
03:55:16.070 --> 03:55:23.790
Boardroom: Thank you very much. And if it's okay with my Council colleagues, I'll present, my amendments to this budget, and then we can take questions at the same time.

1607
03:55:24.320 --> 03:55:25.260
Boardroom: Does that work?

1608
03:55:26.170 --> 03:55:28.030
Boardroom: Alright, very good. So…

1609
03:55:28.850 --> 03:55:41.629
Boardroom: I want to start with some comments, some introductory comments. So, as was mentioned by Marikar's presentation, we are in a $30 million structural deficit. Simply put, that means our expenses exceed our costs.

1610
03:55:41.740 --> 03:55:48.930
Boardroom: With the reliance on one-time resources, cuts at the federal and state levels, the slow recovery from the pandemic, the increase in cost.

1611
03:55:49.120 --> 03:55:58.590
Boardroom: And continued financial uncertainty from international conflicts, tariffs, and unstable federal administration, we have exhausted our options of one-time cuts.

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1612
03:55:58.790 --> 03:56:15.289
Boardroom: We can no longer rely on these one-time fixes, and as a leader, as mayor, as your mayor, it's my job to tell it to you straight, make hard decisions, try to reduce the impacts of these cuts, and work towards increased revenues and a sustainable budget.

1613
03:56:16.100 --> 03:56:24.060
Boardroom: Together with city staff and the city manager, we've been working to balance our two-year budget in ways that don't continue to kick the can down the road.

1614
03:56:24.590 --> 03:56:32.720
Boardroom: My recommendations seek to address the priorities that my Council colleagues have expressed, while also leaving room for the uncertainty of this November's election.

1615
03:56:33.960 --> 03:56:47.490
Boardroom: I want to make sure the public understands that the entire Council is concerned about the uncertain future of FY28, and this isn't just about the possible closure of a fire station, additional loss of staff, etc, if the sales tax doesn't pass.

1616
03:56:47.610 --> 03:56:53.579
Boardroom: I can speak for all of us that public safety is a priority, and we will continue to work hard to keep our stations open.

1617
03:56:53.760 --> 03:56:58.570
Boardroom: I want to assure folks that there is no closure planned for FY2027.

1618
03:56:59.090 --> 03:57:02.119
Boardroom: And I really don't know what November will bring.

1619
03:57:02.900 --> 03:57:12.649
Boardroom: On the ballot this November is a state ballot measure that will require two-thirds for special taxes and prohibit charter cities from levying transfer taxes.

1620
03:57:12.940 --> 03:57:14.240
Boardroom: I'm gonna say that again.

1621
03:57:14.650 --> 03:57:23.849

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Boardroom: This is a state ballot measure that will require two-thirds for special taxes and prohibit charter cities, which we are, from levying transfer taxes.

1622
03:57:24.470 --> 03:57:38.570
Boardroom: If we lose our ability to have transfer taxes in Berkeley, we will be losing an additional $35 million. Keep in mind that we are right now working to close a $30 million deficit, and we could be losing another $35 million if this measure passes in November.

1623
03:57:39.000 --> 03:57:42.320
Boardroom: So believe me when I say that this budget has been stressful.

1624
03:57:42.450 --> 03:57:45.679
Boardroom: But what might happen in November would be cataclysmic.

1625
03:57:47.420 --> 03:57:54.219
Boardroom: My Budget Brown X Circle did everything we could to fight for our whole Council's priorities, while also being conscious of the challenges that lie ahead.

1626
03:57:54.450 --> 03:58:02.030
Boardroom: As mayor, it's my job to think about the entire city. Every department, every person, every resident, every business.

1627
03:58:02.270 --> 03:58:10.739
Boardroom: We can only get through this challenging time if we stick together, so I ask you all for your patience, your compassion, and for your support as we move forward.

1628
03:58:13.260 --> 03:58:21.000
Boardroom: So I'm now gonna move into a little bit more detail about my amendments. These were also presented at a previous Budget and Finance Committee meeting.

1629
03:58:21.950 --> 03:58:27.609
Boardroom: So first, we took into consideration the Council referrals dating back from September of this fiscal year.

1630
03:58:27.860 --> 03:58:35.369
Boardroom: Three of the referrals identified non-general fund sources, so we're continuing to move those forward in the FY2027 budget.

1631

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03:58:36.380 --> 03:58:55.740
Boardroom: When we did a deep dive on the budget reduction plan from the City Manager's office and balanced the priorities, identified by City Council members, we first focused on identifying priorities that do not require general fund dollars. These priorities included the council referrals on downtown revitalization, car-free Berkeley, Car Free Telegraph.

1632
03:58:55.770 --> 03:58:58.949
Boardroom: Small sites, and the Sacred Rest drop-in Center.

1633
03:58:59.130 --> 03:59:09.740
Boardroom: These projects draw from the LRDP settlements, which is the settlement we have with UC Berkeley, SOSIP, which is funding set specifically for downtown, Measure FF, and the Housing Trust Fund.

1634
03:59:09.740 --> 03:59:19.670
Boardroom: These sources of funding can only be used for specific purposes, so I want to make sure folks understand that those kind of big-ticket items are coming from alternate sources, not the general fund.

1635
03:59:19.960 --> 03:59:28.060
Boardroom: Then we looked at projects and programs that council members named as priorities, particularly those that have a potential for economic impact and revenue generation.

1636
03:59:28.230 --> 03:59:39.609
Boardroom: One of those was the full-time employee… a full-time employee in the Office of Economic Development, of which 7 of us identified as a priority at the May 19th Council meeting to support small businesses.

1637
03:59:40.510 --> 03:59:46.599
Boardroom: a project to increase housing at Telegraph and Claremont Housing, that's called Pitch.

1638
03:59:46.800 --> 03:59:48.730
Boardroom: Which will increase our tax base.

1639
03:59:48.980 --> 03:59:53.699
Boardroom: The DBA outreach worker helping to support our unhoused community.

1640
03:59:53.840 --> 04:00:05.310

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Boardroom: Solano Stroll, the largest East Bay street fair in a commercial corridor bringing hundreds of thousands of people to Berkeley, and Live Free, our gun violence prevention program that helps to make our streets, neighborhoods, and schools safer.

1641
04:00:06.510 --> 04:00:23.840
Boardroom: We identified $514,000 in general fund sources, which I'll review in a moment, drawn from salary and cost savings that we're proposing to support the five strategic projects in FY2027, which I'm going to go over in a bit. I'll show you all this and go over it in more detail, but I want to give an overview first.

1642
04:00:24.460 --> 04:00:37.690
Boardroom: There are 4 other line items in the City Manager's budget reduction plan that were identified by council members or commissions as priorities that we are not putting forward as a result of our follow-up with discussions… of our follow-up discussions with staff.

1643
04:00:38.000 --> 04:00:53.569
Boardroom: So, these are the vegetation and fuel reduction. It was reduced from $450K to $207K. This was Councilmember Blackbee, by the way. Staff reported that the work that's needed to be done can be covered by the $207K in funding that remains.

1644
04:00:53.750 --> 04:01:02.989
Boardroom: The Street Trauma Prevention Program. This position was established to increase cross-departmental collaboration,

1645
04:01:03.130 --> 04:01:06.979
Boardroom: And I believe that moving forward, this can be accomplished without dedicated staff.

1646
04:01:07.490 --> 04:01:16.059
Boardroom: CERT program, staff reported that they are transitioning to a volunteer instructor model and are not planning to expand the Berkeley Ready program. And Heart to Heart.

1647
04:01:16.100 --> 04:01:27.590
Boardroom: the Community Health Commission prioritized this program, and the city contract for lifelong Medical Care expired in June 2026, and without that partnership, the success of the program was already in jeopardy.

1648
04:01:27.850 --> 04:01:38.590
Boardroom: So, I'm now gonna walk you all through… The document.

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1649
04:01:41.430 --> 04:01:42.410
Boardroom: Sure.

1650
04:01:42.700 --> 04:01:49.510
Boardroom: Yes. I'd also like to move to… Accept my supplemental… Second. Rise.

1651
04:01:49.920 --> 04:01:51.030
Boardroom: Thank you.

1652
04:01:52.300 --> 04:02:00.770
Boardroom: This is to accept the supplemental, revised material that was, handed out at the meeting today. Councilmember

1653
04:02:01.000 --> 04:02:03.880
Boardroom: This is for item 40A, Councilmember Kessler-Wani.

1654
04:02:03.880 --> 04:02:04.640
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

1655
04:02:05.180 --> 04:02:07.040
Boardroom: Kaplan? Aye.

1656
04:02:07.300 --> 04:02:10.109
Boardroom: Bartlett? Yes. Drago? Aye.

1657
04:02:10.250 --> 04:02:12.500
Boardroom: O'Keefe? Yes. Blackby?

1658
04:02:12.500 --> 04:02:13.020
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

1659
04:02:13.240 --> 04:02:23.099
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes. Okay, motion carries. Thank you, folks. Alright, so I'm gonna put this up on the screen so folks can see.

1660
04:02:23.280 --> 04:02:31.080

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Boardroom: There are also a number of these that are printed in the back, so feel free to check that out, and I will highlight any of the differences that are the ones that are online.

1661
04:02:33.150 --> 04:02:34.540
Boardroom: Okay.

1662
04:02:35.230 --> 04:02:53.709
Boardroom: Alright, so as was mentioned, these… these ones on the top are all have… all have special fund allocations. So this is the Downtown Berkeley Revitalization Projects, which includes, funding for the Canonary, actually, I think this is spelled wrong, Canonary Lighting Project, as well as Oxford for All.

1663
04:02:54.480 --> 04:02:57.390
Boardroom: This was an item brought forward by Councilmember Tragub.

1664
04:02:57.880 --> 04:03:06.859
Boardroom: And it will be paid for out of the Streets and Open Space Improvement Plan, SOCIP, which can only be used for funding for downtown projects in a certain geographic area.

1665
04:03:07.180 --> 04:03:22.110
Boardroom: The next one is the Car Free Berkeley item, or Car Free Telegraph, as I think many of us call it. This has been referred to the LRDP funding process, and it… and the difference here is that it was split between FY2027 and FY2028, so half and half.

1666
04:03:23.260 --> 04:03:28.310
Boardroom: This was a referral from Councilmember Lunapara, Kesarwani, and myself.

1667
04:03:28.810 --> 04:03:30.810
Boardroom: And,

1668
04:03:31.070 --> 04:03:38.169
Boardroom: Additional information here was added about that the total request… what the total request is, and how it was split in half.

1669
04:03:39.660 --> 04:03:44.480
Boardroom: Alright, small sites is listed on here, $3.8 million.

1670
04:03:44.600 --> 04:03:57.060

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Boardroom: This funding, is carryover of the $2.5 million unspent budgeted for small sites from FY2026, and an added $1.3 million of currently unallocated funding.

1671
04:03:57.060 --> 04:04:06.280
Boardroom: So I also want to make it clear that the HACC had recommended, that we actually put additional funding for Measure U1, and so this is actually scaled back.

1672
04:04:06.350 --> 04:04:15.470
Boardroom: From what they had requested, because we wanted to just use funding that would be set aside for small sites, not funds that could go into the general fund.

1673
04:04:16.310 --> 04:04:17.840
Boardroom: And,

1674
04:04:18.420 --> 04:04:29.640
Boardroom: Next on here is Sacred Rest slash Village of Love. Lrdp funding for 100K for FY27, with the stipulation that UC Berkeley must match the $100K allocation.

1675
04:04:31.840 --> 04:04:41.830
Boardroom: And then, as you can see in red, the… these numbers were adjusted because we had separated FY27 and FY28 for car-free telegraphs, so it changed the totals.

1676
04:04:43.480 --> 04:05:02.949
Boardroom: Alright, so the general fund direct transfers, again, the pitch project that I had mentioned earlier, that's $180K from, FY26 District 8 salary savings, so that's Councilmember Humbert's office salary savings, and also $70K from FY27 from Councilmember Humbert's office budget as well.

1677
04:05:03.210 --> 04:05:07.630
Boardroom: And so that's a total of $250,000 specifically for the pitch project.

1678
04:05:08.420 --> 04:05:18.850
Boardroom: Now, moving on to the general fund expenses, this would be the one OED full-time position identified for removal in the initial reduction plan.

1679
04:05:18.960 --> 04:05:27.389

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Boardroom: $236,000. And again, the reason why this was a focus for so many of the council members was because of revenue generation.

1680
04:05:27.750 --> 04:05:30.340
Boardroom: $40,000 for a Solano stroll.

1681
04:05:30.340 --> 04:05:50.879
Boardroom: And so there is an item tonight that's specifically set aside for, for Solano Stroll, and I have included that instead in this budget, and we've made adjustments to this, to this number. Councilmember O'Keefe has also put forward a D13 item, which, has funding set aside for that, and we've also had conversations with.

1682
04:05:50.880 --> 04:05:58.640
Boardroom: Folks… Who runs Solano Stroll, to help support them in finding fundraising for the additional money.

1683
04:05:59.050 --> 04:06:09.209
Boardroom: Live Free, we were able to identify an additional $100,000 so that they could reach the $200,000, which is needed to fill the gap from FY27.

1684
04:06:10.950 --> 04:06:17.959
Boardroom: Unfortunately, there was not funding that we were able to find for FY28, so I want to be clear about that.

1685
04:06:18.410 --> 04:06:27.870
Boardroom: And the city managers also, we've had conversations about continuing to assist in applying for grants and supporting them in trying to find this funding.

1686
04:06:28.250 --> 04:06:43.340
Boardroom: Dba outreach worker, $38,000, which was not the full $40K, but this is basically all we were able to add from it, for a total of $514,000. And so where is all of that coming from? Those are all general fund expenses.

1687
04:06:43.340 --> 04:06:49.010
Boardroom: These are general fund revenue transfers that would be coming from my office, $160,000,

1688
04:06:49.010 --> 04:07:02.400

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Boardroom: from the city attorney's office, she'd done additional work to find, additional funding from her budget, so that's non… $52,000 of non-personnel, $100,000 from city attorney's office salary savings.

1689
04:07:02.540 --> 04:07:06.950
Boardroom: And then, variable time off, which is…

1690
04:07:07.370 --> 04:07:15.580
Boardroom: For general fund savings only, an additional 11 days, all set around holidays that already exist. And again, it's…

1691
04:07:15.690 --> 04:07:20.140
Boardroom: Oh, actually, I think the V is…

1692
04:07:21.800 --> 04:07:38.850
Boardroom: Anyway, but this is optional, is my point. It's not required. And then $15,000 from the City Council catering from the City Clerk's budget, and then also a settlement, a cannabis settlement, for $100,000. And that is $514,000.

1693
04:07:39.200 --> 04:07:57.649
Boardroom: So, I believe my Councilmember colleagues, you should have this printed in front of you, and folks, who are out here, also, there are some printed in the back if you want to take a look a little bit more in detail. But I will take questions now from both my budget recommendations and the City Manager's budget. And I'm gonna…

1694
04:07:57.860 --> 04:08:14.259
Boardroom: I don't… I'll leave this open up here just for a little bit in case folks have specific questions. Alright, starting with Councilmember Taplin. Thank you very much to Mr. Senior Manager and Madam Mayor. I did watch the Budget and Finance presentation. I just had one question.

1695
04:08:15.080 --> 04:08:26.089
Boardroom: The additional $100K for Live Free, I'm wondering where you found that. From the, city attorney's office had some salary savings in her budget. Wonderful, thank you.

1696
04:08:28.570 --> 04:08:34.879
Boardroom: Other questions for my council call? Oh, sorry, folks online, I'm gonna start with Councilmember Kesserwani, and then Councilmember Blackaby after.

1697
04:08:37.740 --> 04:08:41.049

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Rashi Kesarwani: Okay, I'm on tap. You all can hear me?

1698
04:08:41.450 --> 04:08:42.240
Boardroom: Yes.

1699
04:08:42.240 --> 04:08:51.289
Rashi Kesarwani: Okay, well, I want to thank, I believe it's Mr. White and Ms. Dupaya who are at the table. I can see the back of your heads at this point.

1700
04:08:51.290 --> 04:09:03.479
Rashi Kesarwani: But, I want to thank you for your presentation. I know you've been coming to the Budget and Finance Committee regularly. You've come to the Council once already with a very detailed presentation.

1701
04:09:03.480 --> 04:09:05.449
Rashi Kesarwani: Where we, you know, we did…

1702
04:09:05.630 --> 04:09:12.410
Rashi Kesarwani: See in that presentation, positions that are proposed for elimination, that are vacant.

1703
04:09:12.430 --> 04:09:31.320
Rashi Kesarwani: At that time, we were working with a number of 20 people, you know, real people being laid off, and so, I just want to center this on, you know, what the mayor already said, that this is a really challenging budget. This is the most challenging budget

1704
04:09:31.400 --> 04:09:51.240
Rashi Kesarwani: That I have been involved in, and this is my 8th year on the council, and, you know, I did want to just do some Budget 101 really briefly, because I'm seeing… I'm getting emails in my Council inbox of people asking, what is the quote-unquote cause of the structural deficit?

1705
04:09:51.250 --> 04:10:00.800
Rashi Kesarwani: I think the mayor tried to explain this, you know, it's a condition in which our expenditures as our city are consistently

1706
04:10:01.510 --> 04:10:10.810
Rashi Kesarwani: greater and growing faster than our revenue sources. That's what it is. And in the last couple of budgets.

1707
04:10:11.080 --> 04:10:23.199

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Rashi Kesarwani: what we have done is look at one-time fixes. For example, we borrowed money from our workers' comp fund, or workers' compensation fund.

1708
04:10:23.590 --> 04:10:36.939
Rashi Kesarwani: That was one of our solutions. We did less to our sec… contributed less to our Section 115 trust for our pension obligations, for instance. The problem with that is…

1709
04:10:37.370 --> 04:10:49.100
Rashi Kesarwani: Those one-time fixes are only available one time, and the costs that are growing faster than revenues, it's… it's our labor costs, primarily, right? It's… it's…

1710
04:10:49.320 --> 04:11:01.590
Rashi Kesarwani: salaries and benefits. And so, we have to figure out how to right-size our organization. Let me pause there and see if Mr. White would like to add any further context there.

1711
04:11:01.960 --> 04:11:04.849
Rashi Kesarwani: In terms of cost drivers.

1712
04:11:05.120 --> 04:11:05.639
Boardroom: He's shaking hands.

1713
04:11:05.640 --> 04:11:06.760
Rashi Kesarwani: revenue sources.

1714
04:11:07.280 --> 04:11:09.889
Rashi Kesarwani: Oh, can you speak into the mic? I couldn't…

1715
04:11:10.730 --> 04:11:13.559
Boardroom: No, I have nothing to add, Councilmember.

1716
04:11:13.780 --> 04:11:25.579
Rashi Kesarwani: Okay, so, so, so for folks watching at this, at this hour at home, you know, I hope that explains what's going on, and, and, and I, I, I really wanna…

1717
04:11:25.830 --> 04:11:39.640
Rashi Kesarwani: speak directly to our… our city staff and say that I… I really feel this, on a really personal level, and I, you know, I'm getting emotional as I talk about this.

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1718
04:11:39.990 --> 04:11:48.209
Rashi Kesarwani: And, you know, I spoke last time about one city, one team, And I have been meeting

1719
04:11:48.910 --> 04:11:51.040
Rashi Kesarwani: weekly,

1720
04:11:51.200 --> 04:11:57.500
Rashi Kesarwani: sometimes more than weekly with the city manager and the deputy city manager. You know, we met on Saturday.

1721
04:11:57.680 --> 04:12:01.840
Rashi Kesarwani: And I was looking at… vacant positions.

1722
04:12:01.980 --> 04:12:07.120
Rashi Kesarwani: that are not proposed to be eliminated. I was looking at that list.

1723
04:12:07.310 --> 04:12:12.009
Rashi Kesarwani: Of people who are slated to be laid off, And,

1724
04:12:12.950 --> 04:12:15.640
Rashi Kesarwani: Looking at all of our revenue sources.

1725
04:12:15.940 --> 04:12:29.880
Rashi Kesarwani: And, I just want to tell you that I have looked at this really, really carefully, and I'm going to continue to do that up until June 23rd to look… to make sure that I have looked at every single option that is available.

1726
04:12:30.010 --> 04:12:34.649
Rashi Kesarwani: And the way I have to think about this is, I can't,

1727
04:12:35.360 --> 04:12:43.109
Rashi Kesarwani: you know, I really want to avoid the one-time fixes for ongoing costs, so what that means is

1728
04:12:43.390 --> 04:12:48.339
Rashi Kesarwani: I could… I could try to find a one-time way to pay for a position.

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1729
04:12:48.550 --> 04:12:56.460
Rashi Kesarwani: But next year, we have the same challenge to figure out what is that one-time fix for that position.

1730
04:12:56.630 --> 04:13:03.180
Rashi Kesarwani: So we really do have to look at, you know, all of the work that has gone in

1731
04:13:03.860 --> 04:13:12.160
Rashi Kesarwani: From every department to look at, you know, which positions R…

1732
04:13:12.640 --> 04:13:20.510
Rashi Kesarwani: Are ones that we're gonna have to let go of so that we can make sure that our expenditures are in line with our revenues.

1733
04:13:20.670 --> 04:13:22.999
Rashi Kesarwani: And it is really tough.

1734
04:13:23.360 --> 04:13:26.690
Rashi Kesarwani: And, I just want to tell you…

1735
04:13:27.050 --> 04:13:30.540
Rashi Kesarwani: That… that it really is weighing on me.

1736
04:13:30.660 --> 04:13:39.280
Rashi Kesarwani: And, I… I know we're going to continue to work through this, so… so let me… let me get to some of my questions. So I did want to…

1737
04:13:39.410 --> 04:13:44.469
Rashi Kesarwani: ask you, Mr. City Manager, can you talk about

1738
04:13:44.840 --> 04:13:55.289
Rashi Kesarwani: what the process is for those 20 people who are on this layoff list? What options that they are being offered? Can you walk us through that?

1739
04:13:57.300 --> 04:13:59.919
Boardroom: Yeah, yes, Councilmember, so the…

1740

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04:14:00.800 --> 04:14:14.150
Boardroom: As I mentioned, there's 20 people, out of the 183 positions that got eliminated who are actually in filled positions that are slated to be eliminated, and thus those people will be laid off.

1741
04:14:15.690 --> 04:14:18.160
Boardroom: We've worked really hard to try and figure out

1742
04:14:18.440 --> 04:14:25.450
Boardroom: ways for them not to be laid off, and that's a sort of a three-fold strategy. One is that any

1743
04:14:25.930 --> 04:14:32.869
Boardroom: Any classification that had a person in it that was slated to be laid off was frozen for hiring.

1744
04:14:33.210 --> 04:14:40.059
Boardroom: And the whole series was frozen if it had, like, a 1, 2, and a 3 progression up through the classification.

1745
04:14:40.400 --> 04:14:52.669
Boardroom: And the goal there is that, you know, when we did this back on April 10th, that there would be, hopefully, some attrition, some people might retire, or get a new job, or, for whatever reason, leave the organization, and therefore.

1746
04:14:52.670 --> 04:15:01.339
Boardroom: there would be an open position for someone who was on this layoff list to bump into and maintain their job. So that's… that's one category.

1747
04:15:02.340 --> 04:15:10.689
Boardroom: And our anticipation is that Probably after people bump into open positions, we'll have, 14 people left.

1748
04:15:10.960 --> 04:15:11.890
Boardroom: on that.

1749
04:15:12.340 --> 04:15:23.879
Boardroom: list, that layoff list. And then, as I mentioned, we've been working hard, our HR director and her team, to figure out other open jobs that they could bump into.

1750

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04:15:23.880 --> 04:15:37.120
Boardroom: And what this has, required is for me to freeze all hiring and positions, so that, again, we would have, first, an understanding clearly of what vacant positions exist, and we wouldn't be filling those positions.

1751
04:15:37.220 --> 04:15:44.199
Boardroom: Until we get through the budget adoption. And then second, maybe there would be some additional attrition that would allow for

1752
04:15:44.400 --> 04:15:56.629
Boardroom: vacancies to open up into which people could be placed into. That flexible placement program is part of our MOUs with our labor groups, and we work together to

1753
04:15:57.240 --> 04:16:08.989
Boardroom: Come to agreements that we would start, you know, figuring out who had the minimum qualifications to go into a job, even if it was a completely different job and classification from the one that they're currently in.

1754
04:16:09.650 --> 04:16:21.310
Boardroom: And that cannot be effectuated until a budget is adopted and we have certainty about which positions are vacant and which positions are filled. So it's important for us to

1755
04:16:21.890 --> 04:16:31.240
Boardroom: maintain this vacancy list as it is, and then the budget gets adopted, and then we can effectuate the flexible placements for people who meet the MQs.

1756
04:16:31.430 --> 04:16:47.490
Boardroom: or could meet them very shortly, for any job in the city. Those people would be offered those jobs, and after HR has done a significant amount of analysis to think through who might be eligible for what jobs and what jobs are open.

1757
04:16:47.820 --> 04:16:53.789
Boardroom: We anticipate that, Somewhere between another 6 and 7 people.

1758
04:16:54.050 --> 04:16:56.320
Boardroom: Could be flexibly placed.

1759
04:16:56.860 --> 04:17:00.960

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Boardroom: into one of those jobs. And again, this is voluntary, and we don't know for sure.

1760
04:17:01.470 --> 04:17:18.179
Boardroom: If that will happen or not, but we have worked aggressively to open up those pathways for people to remain employed with the city, even if it's not in the same job, and in some cases it would be a job that paid less, but it would be a job with benefits.

1761
04:17:18.360 --> 04:17:21.959
Boardroom: And so, those are the two… those are the two main strategies.

1762
04:17:22.490 --> 04:17:23.960
Boardroom: That we've used.

1763
04:17:25.330 --> 04:17:33.260
Boardroom: Why don't I just pause there and see if that makes sense, and if you have questions, we also have our HR Director here, if there's more detailed questions, then she could step in as well.

1764
04:17:33.570 --> 04:17:38.410
Rashi Kesarwani: Okay, thank you, Mr. City Manager. So, I know you, you were speaking

1765
04:17:39.150 --> 04:17:49.389
Rashi Kesarwani: city government hiring speak. The MQ is minimum qualifications. So I'm gonna try to put that into layperson's terms.

1766
04:17:49.590 --> 04:17:54.999
Rashi Kesarwani: You know, because we have vacant positions that are not being eliminated.

1767
04:17:55.300 --> 04:18:00.069
Rashi Kesarwani: And on the other hand, we have some people who are on a layoff list.

1768
04:18:00.770 --> 04:18:13.470
Rashi Kesarwani: you know, I feel it's really important that we pause hiring people from outside our organization, and give those 20 or so people an opportunity to figure out if they're qualified

1769
04:18:13.490 --> 04:18:24.109

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Rashi Kesarwani: for vacant positions in our organization. You know, I think we should be doing that, to minimize and mitigate the human impact of

1770
04:18:24.110 --> 04:18:40.879
Rashi Kesarwani: right-sizing our budget, and that's what the City Manager just described, that opportunity for people, if they're qualified, to be able to go into those vacant positions that remain. And so I just want to thank you, Mr. City Manager. I want to thank our Human Resources Director and the HR team, because

1771
04:18:41.000 --> 04:18:47.409
Rashi Kesarwani: you know, there is a lot of back and forth, I can imagine, in trying to figure all this out.

1772
04:18:47.480 --> 04:18:51.779
Rashi Kesarwani: And, I know it can be stressful for people who are thinking about

1773
04:18:51.810 --> 04:19:03.060
Rashi Kesarwani: taking advantage of this opportunity, but, you know, this is something that, I talked to the city manager about and wanted to make sure that we did as an organization. So.

1774
04:19:03.060 --> 04:19:12.389
Rashi Kesarwani: So… so thank you, Mr. City Manager, for just explaining that. The other request that I had made at the Budget and Finance Committee

1775
04:19:12.640 --> 04:19:18.690
Rashi Kesarwani: Was to, look at A possible revenue source.

1776
04:19:18.890 --> 04:19:29.989
Rashi Kesarwani: for 8 positions in the fire department, 5 firefighters, and 3 paramedics. Mr. City Manager, do you… can you update us on the status of that?

1777
04:19:31.710 --> 04:19:42.890
Boardroom: Yes, Councilmember, we have been diligently looking at revenues. You know, our finance team last updated revenues in February.

1778
04:19:43.580 --> 04:19:49.840
Boardroom: And since then, We… there's a couple of potential revenue increases.

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1779
04:19:50.270 --> 04:19:51.169
Boardroom: That,

1780
04:19:51.960 --> 04:20:07.559
Boardroom: you know, we don't have exact projections yet for some of them, but, there's a utility users tax that, was, when it was initially, created, was mostly generating revenue from people who had cable TV.

1781
04:20:07.560 --> 04:20:13.269
Boardroom: Since a lot of people have moved from cable TV to streaming services like Netflix, etc.

1782
04:20:13.450 --> 04:20:28.730
Boardroom: We are eligible to apply the UUT to… utility users tax to those streaming services. We anticipate that will generate some additional revenue. Again, we don't have an exact figure on what that might be yet, but we are working on that. Additionally, we've been

1783
04:20:29.750 --> 04:20:33.700
Boardroom: Negotiating with the county and looking at ambulance transfer fees.

1784
04:20:33.910 --> 04:20:39.379
Boardroom: And expect that through several different ambulance transport.

1785
04:20:40.360 --> 04:20:45.689
Boardroom: Fees, we would have, revenues exceeding what our projections currently are.

1786
04:20:46.570 --> 04:20:48.249
Boardroom: So those are the two…

1787
04:20:48.790 --> 04:20:53.220
Boardroom: I would say those are the two revenue streams that we've been most focused on and looking at.

1788
04:20:53.720 --> 04:20:57.169
Boardroom: Thank you. I'm sorry, we have to actually make a motion to extend the meeting.

1789
04:20:57.170 --> 04:20:58.810

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Rashi Kesarwani: Oh, okay.

1790
04:20:59.780 --> 04:21:01.550
Rashi Kesarwani: Do you want to pick a time, Madam Mayor?

1791
04:21:01.550 --> 04:21:05.010
Boardroom: Yeah, I… let's just to be safe, 11.45.

1792
04:21:05.440 --> 04:21:06.300
Rashi Kesarwani: Second.

1793
04:21:09.220 --> 04:21:12.389
Boardroom: Can you take the role on that, please, Clerk?

1794
04:21:13.090 --> 04:21:16.869
Boardroom: To extend the meeting to 1145. Councilmember Kesarwani?

1795
04:21:16.870 --> 04:21:17.490
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

1796
04:21:17.660 --> 04:21:23.980
Boardroom: Taplin? Aye. Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

1797
04:21:23.980 --> 04:21:24.840
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

1798
04:21:24.970 --> 04:21:31.070
Boardroom: Unapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mary Ishii? Yes. Okay, motion carries.

1799
04:21:32.090 --> 04:21:48.010
Rashi Kesarwani: Okay, and I'm just about done with these questions, and then finally, you know, I just wanted to briefly touch on the mayor's amendments or proposal to fund certain priorities.

1800
04:21:48.020 --> 04:21:54.070
Rashi Kesarwani: You know, I want to thank the mayor and her Brown Act Circle for those proposals.

1801
04:21:54.160 --> 04:22:04.850

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Rashi Kesarwani: on the housing trust fund allocation for small sites. Mr. White, can you… Brief us on…

1802
04:22:05.010 --> 04:22:17.060
Rashi Kesarwani: what new affordable housing projects are in need of GAAP funding at this point, additional GAAP funding from the Housing Trust Fund? Can you give us a rundown of that?

1803
04:22:17.890 --> 04:22:25.129
Boardroom: Sure, I'd be happy to. So, in working with our Housing and Community Services team.

1804
04:22:25.200 --> 04:22:40.179
Boardroom: They've done an assessment of the Housing Trust Fund portfolio, and, you know, there are a variety of projects that we believe over time will need, additional funding, some of which is known today and some of which is not known, just because the projects are in the process of

1805
04:22:40.180 --> 04:22:45.329
Boardroom: securing funding, but we do know that the project at 1740 San Pablo

1806
04:22:45.330 --> 04:22:57.460
Boardroom: Likely will need anywhere from $2 to $4 million of additional money. There are some smaller asks, associated with a couple of small sites projects, one at 2321 10th Street.

1807
04:22:57.470 --> 04:23:11.710
Boardroom: And another one is the Solano Avenue Cooperative. But I think more importantly, and I think what is, particularly germane to this City Council is, you know, there have been, over time some very substantial commitments associated with North Berkeley BART and Ashby BART station as well.

1808
04:23:11.710 --> 04:23:17.480
Boardroom: Those projects are in early stages of pre-development and moving their projects along, and so…

1809
04:23:17.480 --> 04:23:27.539
Boardroom: Given the timeframe that it's taken for those projects to come to fruition, we certainly anticipate, in an environment with rising construction costs, as you heard from our CIP presentation.

1810

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04:23:27.540 --> 04:23:41.070
Boardroom: rising labor costs, that for sure those projects are going to need additional funding. The amounts are to be determined, but given the constraints are on our Housing Trust Fund, we naturally are concerned about adequate funding being available for them.

1811
04:23:42.390 --> 04:23:49.160
Rashi Kesarwani: Okay, thank you very much, Mr. White, and so I'm very closely tracking projects in my district.

1812
04:23:49.250 --> 04:24:05.910
Rashi Kesarwani: And I had an opportunity to talk to Colleen Egan, the CEO of Insight Housing. Insight is one of the affordable housing developers on the team at North Berkeley BART, and they're doing a new building of 83 units

1813
04:24:06.080 --> 04:24:16.440
Rashi Kesarwani: of permanent supportive housing at the North Berkeley BART station for formerly homeless people. She told me they submitted their Homekey Plus application today.

1814
04:24:16.520 --> 04:24:21.239
Rashi Kesarwani: But, they are still gonna need additional GAAP funding.

1815
04:24:21.250 --> 04:24:35.729
Rashi Kesarwani: And so… so I want us to be mindful of these asks when we're thinking about how to allocate from the Housing Trust Fund. And I did want to just highlight 1740 San Pablo. This is the corner of San Pablo and Delaware.

1816
04:24:35.730 --> 04:24:43.099
Rashi Kesarwani: It is a short biking distance to North Berkeley BART, so to me, you know, anything on San Pablo Avenue is a transit-oriented development.

1817
04:24:43.210 --> 04:24:57.599
Rashi Kesarwani: And that is 54 units of new affordable housing from RCD, Resources for Community Development, and they have an actual ask that's 2 to 4 million. This is a blighted property.

1818
04:24:57.600 --> 04:25:00.969
Boardroom: Councilmember, sorry, you're about 2 minutes over your time, so…

1819

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04:25:00.970 --> 04:25:06.559
Rashi Kesarwani: Okay, I can't see the clock, so I'm just about to wrap up. This is a blighted property,

1820
04:25:06.730 --> 04:25:11.100
Rashi Kesarwani: gas station slash tax service, I don't know what it is, it's fenced off.

1821
04:25:11.290 --> 04:25:27.189
Rashi Kesarwani: You know, I want us to think about investments that can transform blighted properties into new homes for people. Those people aren't able to come to the Budget and Finance Committee and advocate for funding, so I am here tonight to advocate on their behalf.

1822
04:25:27.190 --> 04:25:36.300
Rashi Kesarwani: I am advocating for the formerly homeless people who are going to move into North Berkeley BART. I'm advocating for the low-income families

1823
04:25:36.550 --> 04:25:40.629
Rashi Kesarwani: who I would like to see move into 1740 San Pablo.

1824
04:25:40.760 --> 04:25:46.240
Rashi Kesarwani: within a couple years. This project has been in the pipeline since I started on the Council.

1825
04:25:46.440 --> 04:25:53.980
Rashi Kesarwani: So these are the trade-offs we have to decide about next… next Tuesday, June 23rd.

1826
04:25:54.780 --> 04:25:56.290
Rashi Kesarwani: Thank you very much.

1827
04:25:56.460 --> 04:26:01.649
Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember, Taplin had given you some of his time, so… go ahead, Councilmember Blackaby.

1828
04:26:01.920 --> 04:26:09.989
Brent Blackaby: Thanks, Madam Mayor, and thank you so much to the team, and look, and thanks to the Mayor. I want to, again, associate my comments with the Mayor, and Councilmember Casawani said about

1829
04:26:10.170 --> 04:26:19.329

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Brent Blackaby: How, weighty these decisions are, how much we know these are affecting, real people, our residents, but also our working staff.

1830
04:26:19.470 --> 04:26:37.350
Brent Blackaby: And so none of these are easy, these are all hard conversations, and… but we're trying… I appreciate the city manager's effort, really kind of grabbing the structural deficit by the horns, and saying, we've got to really make a dent in it. I'll observe that I think that, you know.

1831
04:26:37.640 --> 04:26:48.029
Brent Blackaby: we're gonna make a lot of progress this year, but we also know the full closure of the structural deficit is pending potentially some things that might happen this November.

1832
04:26:48.190 --> 04:27:06.049
Brent Blackaby: And I think, potentially, it's also pending… you know, I do think there are a couple of other things we need to have a look at that we can't before this, end of this fiscal year, but things like questions around the public health, environmental health, some of these other functions that the county also provides.

1833
04:27:06.240 --> 04:27:15.559
Brent Blackaby: And that other cities in our county are relying on the county to provide, rather than providing them in their own municipal form.

1834
04:27:15.760 --> 04:27:20.890
Brent Blackaby: So, again, I don't think… we don't have the time or the effort to properly, sort of.

1835
04:27:20.990 --> 04:27:30.379
Brent Blackaby: figure that out now, but I will say, I think there are some pretty big other things to look at after we get through this budget cycle.

1836
04:27:30.410 --> 04:27:45.159
Brent Blackaby: to kind of finish the closure of the structural deficit ahead of next year. But I do appreciate the fact that we're making substantial progress here. I wanted to, in addition to what Councilmember Kassarwani asked about the

1837
04:27:45.160 --> 04:28:04.699
Brent Blackaby: 8 firefighter positions, which I know we're trying to fund. I'd also want to encourage us to look at the three additional, the

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operations captain, the fire marshal, and fire inspector in particular. Some of those roles are both important for what's happening in terms of wildfire safety in the hills. They're also really important to getting

1838
04:28:04.770 --> 04:28:13.240
Brent Blackaby: Building projects approved and constructed, which is a source of economic development for the city as well.

1839
04:28:13.320 --> 04:28:17.999
Brent Blackaby: So, I think as we're… I know the city manager and team are looking at

1840
04:28:18.220 --> 04:28:20.720
Brent Blackaby: How we can find funding for that.

1841
04:28:20.950 --> 04:28:38.049
Brent Blackaby: But I'd advocate not just for the 8, but I'm advocating for the larger group. If we can, you know, again, put our pencil to that, I'd support that. The last question I had is this… we've heard this a few times in the Budget Committee, and as we've been talking to some of our labor partners.

1842
04:28:38.060 --> 04:28:50.049
Brent Blackaby: the question versus about freezing versus eliminating positions. I wonder if the city manager or HR team could talk about that, because I'd also support the idea of

1843
04:28:50.180 --> 04:28:58.610
Brent Blackaby: There is something that feels like a bigger hurdle if you eliminate a job or a classification entirely.

1844
04:28:58.630 --> 04:29:12.299
Brent Blackaby: Because adding that back down the road feels a lot harder than saying, hey, look, we want to freeze it at least for the next year, two years, take it off the budget books, and then look at it and keep it. And if it's something that we can fill at a later point, we could consider filling it.

1845
04:29:12.300 --> 04:29:21.559
Brent Blackaby: But practically, what is the difference between freezing and eliminating, and are there some of these jobs that we could freeze versus eliminate? And would that make any difference from the budget process?

1846

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04:29:23.470 --> 04:29:33.280
Boardroom: Well, you could freeze positions rather than eliminate them with clarity that they're frozen because we don't have funding to pay for them.

1847
04:29:33.850 --> 04:29:37.700
Boardroom: And in that way, you know, in some ways, it's semantic.

1848
04:29:37.880 --> 04:29:40.170
Boardroom: I guess I would… I would say that

1849
04:29:40.370 --> 04:29:55.110
Boardroom: you could always, whether they're frozen or removed from the budget, they could always be added if the Council wanted to add positions and there was a need for whatever the position was doing. So, that is always something that could be brought forward, it could be brought forward in the AA01.

1850
04:29:56.520 --> 04:30:03.919
Boardroom: As a way to look towards, you know, we've right-sized our budget, we've removed these positions from it, and we're gonna grow

1851
04:30:04.310 --> 04:30:08.400
Boardroom: You know, based on where we think it's most appropriate to grow.

1852
04:30:09.380 --> 04:30:16.110
Boardroom: Rather than have a list of positions to fill because they used to be filled, and perhaps those are the right ones, or perhaps they're not.

1853
04:30:18.520 --> 04:30:19.060
Brent Blackaby: Got it.

1854
04:30:19.330 --> 04:30:31.309
Brent Blackaby: Last thing on revenue is transfer tax. I know there's a couple of big commercial transactions, one in particular I'm thinking about that are in the process of closing, as we're forecasting transfer tax revenue.

1855
04:30:31.760 --> 04:30:43.010
Brent Blackaby: You know, how closely do we look at those individual things, or do we look at kind of a trend line when we're kind of coming

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up with our revenue target for something like transfer tax? Because that can be spiky, especially on commercial activity.

1856
04:30:43.930 --> 04:30:46.219
Boardroom: That, that is Spocky, and we…

1857
04:30:46.780 --> 04:31:06.599
Boardroom: you know, I mean, I guess… I do want to emphasize the point that the mayor made, because it's a really significant one about the Taxpayer Protection Act that has been qualified for the statewide ballot. As she said, if it passes, it would be a $35 million annual hit to our budget, because it would essentially eliminate all transfer tax, so…

1858
04:31:07.240 --> 04:31:17.570
Boardroom: The… their governor is working on a compromise by which the… that bill would be pulled off of the ballot, and in return, they would have some sort of an agreement to

1859
04:31:17.590 --> 04:31:27.790
Boardroom: limit transfer taxes, but not totally do away with them. You know, we don't know exactly what that would look like, even if it does happen, but last… the last sort of numbers they were…

1860
04:31:27.790 --> 04:31:44.240
Boardroom: talking about when we projected the impact to the city, it would be approximately a $10 million annual hit to us, because they would reduce… right now, our top transfer tax rate goes up to 3.5%. What they were talking about is limiting it to a 1.5%.

1861
04:31:44.240 --> 04:31:49.550
Boardroom: And applying that only to single-family homes, but not applying anything to commercial and multifamily, so…

1862
04:31:49.960 --> 04:31:54.290
Boardroom: So, all that to say, there's a lot of unknowns.

1863
04:31:54.690 --> 04:31:55.440
Boardroom: And…

1864
04:31:55.640 --> 04:32:01.379
Boardroom: I would say not unlikely that we'll have another significant hit on the transfer tax side, which makes it…

1865

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04:32:01.700 --> 04:32:14.689
Boardroom: you know, might make it easier to forecast transfer tax if they take it away, but right now, Henry and the team does a good job of looking at what's happened in the past and kind of basing it on a 5-year average, or, you know, working through that.

1866
04:32:15.450 --> 04:32:23.749
Brent Blackaby: Thank you. Thanks for all the work, and I look forward to hearing public comment and feedback as we try and kind of bring this over the finish line in the next week. Thank you.

1867
04:32:24.030 --> 04:32:31.839
Boardroom: Thank you. Folks, can we just keep it to questions, please, so we can get to public comment, then we'll come back and do final comments. Councilmember Lunapara?

1868
04:32:32.090 --> 04:32:35.369
Boardroom: Thank you. I have a couple questions.

1869
04:32:35.550 --> 04:32:39.980
Boardroom: First, for the mayor, the city attorney's savings…

1870
04:32:40.400 --> 04:32:44.220
Boardroom: City attorney's Office Savings, those are one-time funds.

1871
04:32:44.360 --> 04:32:46.470
Boardroom: Not permanent. Okay, thank you.

1872
04:32:46.650 --> 04:32:51.529
Boardroom: I, oh, sorry, just for the public, that's correct. Okay, thank you.

1873
04:32:52.340 --> 04:33:06.750
Boardroom: I'm curious, I think how… I'm curious how the referral, the pitch referral is going to slot into the RRV list, as in how does it work in terms of prioritizing planning referrals?

1874
04:33:10.900 --> 04:33:20.369
Boardroom: Well, it's a great question, and, you know, I would ask the Council to help us prioritize and answer the question that you just asked.

1875
04:33:20.680 --> 04:33:34.340

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Boardroom: Because there are other projects that are on the list, and if they don't… but if they don't have funding, and this does have funding, maybe you want to prioritize this, but however you all want to do it, it would be very helpful for us to get clear direction from you.

1876
04:33:35.590 --> 04:33:50.639
Boardroom: We've talked about doing, like, kind of a mid-year ROV, and I think that that would make sense, given that we've made some adjustments here. So I think it would be worthwhile to look at our prioritization, make sure it's clear, so we can give you clear guidance.

1877
04:33:52.380 --> 04:33:53.480
Boardroom: Mmm, okay.

1878
04:33:54.040 --> 04:33:55.099
Boardroom: I…

1879
04:33:56.290 --> 04:34:06.910
Boardroom: There are currently referrals on the ROV list that are on planning's list that are ranked highly, and so I just want to make sure that those don't get

1880
04:34:07.369 --> 04:34:09.169
Boardroom: Left behind.

1881
04:34:10.640 --> 04:34:13.329
Boardroom: Okay, I have some questions,

1882
04:34:13.529 --> 04:34:16.349
Boardroom: Is the police chief on the call?

1883
04:34:17.029 --> 04:34:24.839
Boardroom: Okay, thank you. I know we've asked a lot of questions, and you sent an amazing memo. Thank you so much for that information.

1884
04:34:25.090 --> 04:34:33.029
Boardroom: I have a… I'm wondering how… can you tell us what the amount of officers that are budgeted for an FY26 budget?

1885
04:34:38.800 --> 04:34:39.510
Boardroom: I don't know.

1886

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04:34:39.680 --> 04:34:48.700
Boardroom: Are you asking about the most recently adopted budget, FY26? There are… 174.

1887
04:34:50.290 --> 04:34:57.329
Boardroom: Okay, thank you. And if there are less… Hired police officers,

1888
04:34:57.550 --> 04:35:00.979
Boardroom: I believe 154 is the amount right now.

1889
04:35:01.770 --> 04:35:06.839
Boardroom: Does that mean that there's a surplus in the FY26 budget on the salary side?

1890
04:35:09.840 --> 04:35:14.329
Boardroom: Yes, it would mean that there would be salary savings from positions that are not filled.

1891
04:35:14.820 --> 04:35:23.529
Boardroom: Okay, that's helpful. And those… we could, we could, how are those being allocated, reallocated within…

1892
04:35:24.990 --> 04:35:26.359
Boardroom: Those salary savings.

1893
04:35:27.300 --> 04:35:31.990
Boardroom: Is the… Is the Chief? The chief is on, and I think she could,

1894
04:35:32.570 --> 04:35:36.669
Boardroom: help with some of these questions that you're asking, Councilmember.

1895
04:35:37.439 --> 04:35:40.710
Boardroom: If it's easier, we can also take this offline. I…

1896
04:35:41.669 --> 04:35:44.029
Jen Louis: I'm here if you want to ask the question again.

1897
04:35:44.950 --> 04:35:46.390
Boardroom: Yeah, sorry,

1898

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04:35:46.610 --> 04:35:57.009
Boardroom: If there… in FY26, are 174 officers at budget, but we only have 154 hired officers, that surplus

1899
04:35:57.270 --> 04:36:00.869
Boardroom: Salary savings, how is it being reallocated?

1900
04:36:01.660 --> 04:36:15.980
Jen Louis: So that, salary savings, is, we're experiencing that both in our overtime costs, the increase in our overtime costs, and some of that salary savings has also been absorbed back into the general fund for, for other funding.

1901
04:36:18.060 --> 04:36:18.939
Boardroom: Okay.

1902
04:36:19.130 --> 04:36:38.289
Boardroom: Is there… I think it'd be helpful to know what… where those funds are going to. I have another question around the funding that was unspent in the Edgeworth contract and rolled over in anticipation of an expansion of the flock contract in FY26, and I'm curious if there's a surplus in that.

1903
04:36:39.220 --> 04:36:40.279
Boardroom: those funds.

1904
04:36:48.259 --> 04:36:51.860
Boardroom: Chief, you're muted. Okay. Sorry, I can see your.

1905
04:36:51.869 --> 04:36:54.539
Jen Louis: Sorry, I'm working on it, sorry,

1906
04:36:54.539 --> 04:37:15.359
Jen Louis: Yes, there is. There is funds that are in the Public Works budget right now that were, are held for the Edgeworth contract. Some of those are, already allocated to some other Edgeworth, or some other camera projects that Public Works had underway, but the… those, funds are, are frozen as part of,

1907
04:37:15.359 --> 04:37:19.669
Jen Louis: The, council direction to do the install on the, fixed cameras.

1908

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04:37:21.759 --> 04:37:25.539
Boardroom: Okay, thank you, but they're… so they're just sitting there right now.

1909
04:37:26.340 --> 04:37:27.110
Jen Louis: That's correct.

1910
04:37:27.119 --> 04:37:34.229
Boardroom: Okay, thank you so much. Thanks for that information. Those are all my questions. Thank you. Other questions from council members before we move on to public comment?

1911
04:37:35.659 --> 04:37:43.929
Boardroom: Okay, I will take… we will take public comment, and this, by the way, is for, item 40, which includes A, B, and C.

1912
04:37:44.209 --> 04:37:52.149
Boardroom: I addressed Solano Stroll in my comments, and so feel free to address this in your public comments. Come on up!

1913
04:37:55.909 --> 04:37:57.989
Boardroom: Is it a 1-minute clock or a 2-minute clock?

1914
04:37:58.399 --> 04:38:14.359
Boardroom: One minute clock. Okay, well, thank you for the opportunity to speak. My name is Thomas Greger, I'm speaking on behalf of SEIU 1021 CSU PTRLA, and our chapter is looking at 8 layoffs, human beings being, shown to the door, next month.

1915
04:38:15.979 --> 04:38:35.309
Boardroom: Our chapter understands that the city needs to, end its, reliance on one-time monies, and, and we understand and agree with that. We, we don't think it needs to… we don't need to end that addiction cold turkey in fiscal year 27, and we're not. The plan proposed by management in.

1916
04:38:35.309 --> 04:38:45.169
Boardroom: fiscal, in mid-April, earmarked, $9.4 million to, fund, and bridge money to fund 33 positions.

1917
04:38:45.169 --> 04:38:57.399
Boardroom: In the hopes that the sales tax will pass in November and could pick up that bill come fiscal year 28. So, and, I have a gentleman who's willing to cede their minute to me, if that's possible.

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1918
04:38:57.469 --> 04:39:00.549
Boardroom: Yeah, and

1919
04:39:00.659 --> 04:39:14.949
Boardroom: Out of those 33 positions, 15 of them are vacant. And, our chapter feels strongly that it's more important to fill… more important to fund filled positions than vacancies. Vacancies don't produce any outcomes for constituents.

1920
04:39:14.949 --> 04:39:38.099
Boardroom: vacancies don't have mortgages to pay or family expenses to cover, so we feel strongly about that. And it would only cost $1.7 million to save our Chapter's 8 jobs for one more year, which would not greatly increase the amount of money already being earmarked for one-time funds, or to save jobs. And that year could go, be spent,

1921
04:39:38.099 --> 04:40:03.099
Boardroom: more thoroughly conducting, planning for an austerity plan. An example of errors we're making is the elimination of the mobility, the street mobility team is going to force calls on the more expensive police officers, and in a June 12th Daily Californian article, a department head said that was an unintended consequence. There shouldn't be unintended consequences.

1922
04:40:03.099 --> 04:40:07.179
Boardroom: this plan, they should all be, even the unpleasant consequences planned out. Thank you. Thank you.

1923
04:40:10.639 --> 04:40:15.579
Boardroom: Good evening. Vinita Goyle with Full Spectrum Labs and a Berkeley resident.

1924
04:40:16.349 --> 04:40:23.529
Boardroom: Berkeley, San Francisco, and many other cities with a relatively high cost of living have all been experiencing a heightened pace of

1925
04:40:23.539 --> 04:40:41.929
Boardroom: market rate development, but the creation of affordable housing has lagged. Our cities are seemingly well-intentioned and mission-aligned in prioritizing the needs of historically underserved residents in the context of a stark income inequalities. But something is amiss, since on-the-ground reality in all these cities suggests the positive impact is not there.

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1926
04:40:41.929 --> 04:40:47.129
Boardroom: Berkeley alone has lost over 100,000 unsubsidized, unaffordable.

1927
04:40:47.209 --> 04:41:01.569
Boardroom: affordable homes since 2020, thousands more are at risk in the next 5 years. More so, without sufficient city resources to fund permanently affordable housing, displacement in the city is and will be inevitable. As I join advocates presented to ask

1928
04:41:01.659 --> 04:41:21.089
Boardroom: For city's allocation of $2.5 million, for the small size program in the upcoming budget, I would sincerely urge you to consider answering these questions. What kind of housing are we creating, and who will we get to live in it, and to what end? Thank you. Mainly the city's political will to fund affordable housing now. Thank you, sir. Thank you.

1929
04:41:25.959 --> 04:41:30.919
Boardroom: Good evening, my name is Jean Clinton. I live on Ward Street between Shattuck and Telegraph.

1930
04:41:30.929 --> 04:41:49.469
Boardroom: We're one of the long-time failed and abandoned streets. We've been working diligently over the last year with City Councilmember Bartlett's office, Public Works staff, all of the relevant council committees and citizen commissions. I want you to know we've witnessed really hard work by the Public Works staff.

1931
04:41:49.639 --> 04:41:56.299
Boardroom: To wrestle with multiple goals and objectives, while embracing Council priorities and policies.

1932
04:41:56.409 --> 04:42:10.509
Boardroom: We're impressed by the resulting 5-year CIP project plans. We're pleased to see that our street is included in the Measure FF plan for street repairs, but still 3 more years away.

1933
04:42:11.079 --> 04:42:13.529
Boardroom: Two years ago, we were scored a 12.

1934
04:42:13.809 --> 04:42:24.019

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Boardroom: on the PCI index, we're probably down to single digits now. The street sweepers came by today, and we had a cloud of dust for about 5 minutes.

1935
04:42:24.179 --> 04:42:27.269
Boardroom: I have a suggestion. I invite…

1936
04:42:28.149 --> 04:42:39.219
Boardroom: Could I have one more sentence? Thank you. I'm sorry, unless someone else gives you a minute. Oh, sorry, you're getting a minute from James in the back. Go ahead. Thank you. We invite cash flow permitting.

1937
04:42:39.379 --> 04:42:52.909
Boardroom: We invite the Council and Public Works staff to consider placing the two worst blocks of Ward Street into the Carlton Street project, just two blocks away, which would allow the work to occur in the first two years of the CIP.

1938
04:42:53.189 --> 04:42:54.009
Boardroom: Thank you.

1939
04:42:54.479 --> 04:42:55.519
Boardroom: Thank you.

1940
04:42:58.679 --> 04:43:04.979
Boardroom: Do you wanna get minutes from folks? Yeah, I'm gonna grab these two guys right here. Do you want another one? You can have 3.

1941
04:43:05.099 --> 04:43:12.069
Boardroom: people. Okay, so you will have 4 minutes total. Thank you. Amoria Lingmo, President of the Berkeley Firefighters Association, Local 1227.

1942
04:43:12.069 --> 04:43:25.669
Boardroom: We are slated for 20 positions to be eliminated. 9 of those would be restated, with Station 4 if the sales tax passes, but there's another 11 positions that would be eliminated. 5 firefighters, 3 paramedics.

1943
04:43:25.669 --> 04:43:30.189
Boardroom: The fire marshal, sworn fire inspector, and a, fire captain.

1944
04:43:30.499 --> 04:43:47.549

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Boardroom: Those 5 firefighters and 3 paramedics, those are, like, operational positions. We already work 56 hours a week. With elimination of those positions, we're gonna work significantly more over that, 72 and 96 hours a week, on a regular basis, with those positions gone.

1945
04:43:47.989 --> 04:43:55.869
Boardroom: I want to thank our council members and city manager for looking for funding for those positions, including the fire marshal, sworn inspector, and the

1946
04:43:55.869 --> 04:44:10.929
Boardroom: the fire captain. Those are essential to the development and safety of that downtown corridor. The fire marshal and the sworn fire inspector enforces all the safety stuff that goes into all the construction of those buildings, as far as, like, all the fire prevention fees that we collect.

1947
04:44:11.009 --> 04:44:13.169
Boardroom: They handle all that stuff as well.

1948
04:44:13.509 --> 04:44:20.059
Boardroom: As I looked at the budget over the last, 10 years, I went back to 2016,

1949
04:44:20.249 --> 04:44:23.899
Boardroom: The fire department brings in a significant amount of its own revenue.

1950
04:44:24.269 --> 04:44:37.089
Boardroom: We have special use taxes, that come in. We have money from the UC Berkeley Settlement Fund that comes in. And when you take a look at all the special use taxes and how much it funds our department, we're probably at a third.

1951
04:44:37.209 --> 04:44:40.469
Boardroom: That we are funded… are self-reliant on.

1952
04:44:40.489 --> 04:44:59.899
Boardroom: And when you factor in our fire prevention inspection fees that go to the general fund, and our ambulance transport revenue that also goes to the general fund, that's about $10 million going towards the general fund. And so when you factor all of that in, our net reliance on the general fund for the fire department is actually closer to.

1953

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04:44:59.959 --> 04:45:18.889
Boardroom: Only half. We're picking up half the tab. And so… but we're also being hit the hardest of all the departments in this city. So, I just ask you guys to please, think about that, and how much we bring in, and how much we do for this community, and how much we show up every day, every night.

1954
04:45:18.929 --> 04:45:22.819
Boardroom: For all other citizens of Berkeley when you're debating these cuts. Thank you.

1955
04:45:23.709 --> 04:45:31.269
Boardroom: Thank you. Oh, sorry. One other thing on that. We're actually 15% less reliant on general funds today than we were 10 years ago.

1956
04:45:32.619 --> 04:45:33.739
Boardroom: Thank you.

1957
04:45:37.579 --> 04:45:49.219
Boardroom: Hi, Mayor, and Mayor, and members of the City Council. My name is Asa NDI. I'm Executive Director of the Northern California Land Trust. First of all, I want to thank Council Members, Mayor, and staff.

1958
04:45:49.269 --> 04:46:11.589
Boardroom: For, dealing with this really difficult, budget season and cycle. Second, I want to thank the Council and the board for supporting the small sites program, particularly, having the, hopefully, enough funding for us to be able to move forward with projects. We're currently looking at a property, actually, that's really close to here in District 1.

1959
04:46:11.589 --> 04:46:16.669
Boardroom: on Curtis, and then the last point I wanted to make was really about trying to,

1960
04:46:16.669 --> 04:46:29.819
Boardroom: help support all three P's by addressing preservation. We want to make sure that when we're adding new affordable housing units, we're not losing existing affordable, naturally occurring units. Thank you so much.

1961
04:46:30.559 --> 04:46:31.579
Boardroom: Thank you.

1962

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04:46:37.869 --> 04:46:54.069
Boardroom: Good evening, Councilmembers and Mayor Ishii. My name is Angela, and I'm a resident of Addison Court Housing Cooperative, just down the street. I'm here to urge you to accept the HACC recommendation to allocate $2.5 million from the Small Sites Program and protect Measure U1.

1963
04:46:54.249 --> 04:47:06.619
Boardroom: Low-income folks are fighting to stay in Berkeley, and Small Sites has worked for this. Recipients at 2627 California Street are converting their building into a permanently affordable, self-managed co-op.

1964
04:47:06.989 --> 04:47:11.529
Boardroom: Kind landlords who limited rent hikes at similar properties are aging and looking to sell.

1965
04:47:11.869 --> 04:47:25.719
Boardroom: Housing preservation isn't just about affordable housing, it's also about keeping communities whole. It reduces gentrification by letting our elders and families age in place, preserving the heart and soul of neighborhoods, like Ms. Betty Gray, who lives in a small sites building.

1966
04:47:25.939 --> 04:47:32.019
Boardroom: Once they are ready to move on, it naturally creates ways for other folks to join and stabilize local culture and history.

1967
04:47:32.129 --> 04:47:40.859
Boardroom: This is how I moved into my co-op. Please continue to fund small-sized program in the upcoming fiscal year and protect Measure U1 dollars in affordable housing. Thank you.

1968
04:47:46.469 --> 04:47:54.789
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council. My name is Matt Gustafson. I'm the Organizational Director at the Bay Area Community Land Trust and a District 2 resident. I'm here

1969
04:47:54.789 --> 04:48:14.339
Boardroom: As you know, to speak in support of the small sites program, and prioritizing this in the FY27-28 budgets, I want to thank you, Mayor Ishii, for including a small sites referral in your proposed budget, as well as Council Members Bartlett, and OPARA for including those as priorities, that you stated the first time that we had a budget hearing.

1970

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04:48:14.339 --> 04:48:38.709
Boardroom: I am here tonight with a letter of support that's been signed by almost 50 organizations plus individuals in… mostly in Berkeley, who I think all of you have already received this from me yesterday. Also joining in support of this ask to fund small sites in the upcoming year, RCD, by the way, as well as East Bay for Everyone, also sent in their own letters in support of the Small Sites program. So I just want to say that this

1971
04:48:38.899 --> 04:48:51.309
Boardroom: Preservation, as speakers before me have mentioned, deserves to have a seat in our holistic affordable housing strategy. Currently, it's only funded 3.7% of HDF, and it deserves more. Thank you. Thanks.

1972
04:48:56.159 --> 04:49:13.889
Boardroom: Carol Morasovic, I'm devastated, if I understand correctly, that if this passes on the ballot in November, does that mean we could lose Measure P, which is about to become Measure W, which is really gonna even make it more of a crisis situation, so that if I talk about

1973
04:49:13.889 --> 04:49:26.449
Boardroom: the shelter, I mean, this is just one thing that we're eliminating. It's just one thing on top of another, and that HUD is now moving forward with, the NOFA that was held up

1974
04:49:26.459 --> 04:49:37.679
Boardroom: Last year because they hadn't issued notice properly to eliminate subsidies and changing those permanent housing subsidies, of which we have 285 in Berkeley, into…

1975
04:49:38.079 --> 04:49:46.079
Boardroom: temporary shelters. And all of this is such a calamity, and I don't know that I have an answer for you. Thank you for,

1976
04:49:46.159 --> 04:49:58.849
Boardroom: for the DBA social worker, you know, but this is gonna be really a bad year coming up. Really a bad time we're going into. And the fi… I just want to say the fire department

1977
04:49:59.009 --> 04:50:02.309
Boardroom: They're always there. Thanks, Carol. Thank you.

1978
04:50:05.899 --> 04:50:13.239
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Berkeley City Council. My name is Alan Kane, I'm the Executive Director of the Solano Avenue Association.

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1979
04:50:13.549 --> 04:50:24.609
Boardroom: I'm horrified to hear about all of these events, and sad to see all the firemen here that are potentially going to lose their job. Given the climate of the situation, it's difficult for me to advocate for a street festival.

1980
04:50:25.129 --> 04:50:30.909
Boardroom: I'm here to advocate for a street festival. I think the Solano Avenue stroll is a one-of-a-kind event.

1981
04:50:31.109 --> 04:50:34.479
Boardroom: And I won't take up any more of your time than that. Thank you.

1982
04:50:37.899 --> 04:50:48.899
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Is there any public comment online on any of the item 4s? Looks like there's 8 hands, actually, so… Okay, let's start with, Claire…

1983
04:50:49.309 --> 04:50:51.229
Boardroom: Greensfelder.

1984
04:50:54.480 --> 04:51:06.710
Claire Greensfelder: Good evening, Mayor Ische and Councilmembers. I appreciate the difficulty that you're facing with all these budget cuts, but I'm here to speak on behalf of the arts organizations and the members of the Berkeley Cultural Trust.

1985
04:51:06.760 --> 04:51:14.980
Claire Greensfelder: Those of us that received grant funding were pretty shocked this morning to receive a notice that even our grant renewals for this year may be off by 10%.

1986
04:51:15.100 --> 04:51:37.730
Claire Greensfelder: I just want to factor that out for you. We've already given $248,000 in budget cuts from staffing losses, and we really appreciate all the efforts that are being made, but in my own case, $1,000 to cut from a $10,000 budget means 10 honorariums for 10 artists at $100 each. These are small amounts, and I just

1987
04:51:37.730 --> 04:51:39.839
Claire Greensfelder: Really urge you to look and

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1988
04:51:39.840 --> 04:51:53.649
Claire Greensfelder: not go forward with the 10% reduction for grants that have already been allotted and for next year, since we've already lost so many staff people that have more than accounted for the 10% cut that was requested by the Council. In fact, we've…

1989
04:51:53.800 --> 04:51:55.130
Claire Greensfelder: cut 20%.

1990
04:51:55.380 --> 04:51:59.279
Claire Greensfelder: by losing staff. So, please, consider. Thank you so much.

1991
04:51:59.280 --> 04:52:00.100
Boardroom: Thanks, Clara.

1992
04:52:00.500 --> 04:52:02.220
Boardroom: Next is Charlie.

1993
04:52:11.460 --> 04:52:14.210
Boardroom: Charlie, you should be able to unmute.

1994
04:52:17.310 --> 04:52:24.910
Charlie: Hi, good evening, everyone. Thank you for all of the community members who went ahead of me and spoke on

1995
04:52:24.910 --> 04:52:27.569
Charlie: 40A, I'm…

1996
04:52:27.570 --> 04:52:51.009
Charlie: speaking to advocate for the small sites funding, which was recommended directly from the Housing Advisory Commission. The line between housed and unhoused can be a very thin one. Displacement is real. I am a part of the community known as the Courtyard on Sacramento, and we are trying to work with the Bay Area Community Land Trust to secure housing for 23 units.

1997
04:52:51.080 --> 04:53:14.170
Charlie: Many of whom are, retirees, long-term members of Berkeley of over 50 years. And these are social workers, school teachers, non-profit workers, Section 8 housing, adults living with disabilities. Our property is up for sale for a commercial buyer, and we… people could be losing their homes, small sites.

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1998
04:53:14.180 --> 04:53:18.480
Charlie: Saves homes, keeps Berkeley residents in Berkeley. Thank you.

1999
04:53:18.480 --> 04:53:20.220
Boardroom: Thank you, Charlie.

2000
04:53:21.140 --> 04:53:23.240
Boardroom: Next is Artel.

2001
04:53:26.430 --> 04:53:27.689
artel: I'm unmuting.

2002
04:53:27.850 --> 04:53:29.379
artel: Yes,

2003
04:53:29.580 --> 04:53:46.770
artel: I'm Linda Artel, and I live on McGee Street, which has been mentioned, so I'm representing people who live there. And our street is a failed street that has not been paved in 33 years. The City Public Works people say there's zero remaining useful life.

2004
04:53:46.920 --> 04:54:03.409
artel: We've been passed over so many times because it was too expensive to fix, so we're very grateful to be considered, in, Measure FF. The street has ruts and pits and holes and gravel and dirt, and cyclists fall or avoid the place.

2005
04:54:03.430 --> 04:54:15.349
artel: Pedestrians have to be very careful, especially at night, at dusk, and in the rain. Again, many thanks to the staff and council members that are helping us.

2006
04:54:16.590 --> 04:54:17.110
artel: Thank you.

2007
04:54:17.220 --> 04:54:18.470
Boardroom: Thank you.

2008
04:54:19.650 --> 04:54:22.479
Boardroom: Next is, Jeff Lomax.

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2009
04:54:23.410 --> 04:54:36.049
Geoff Lomax - KK6IZS: So it's painful to listen to the human tragedy here, but as a reminder, four members of this council have endorsed a parcel tax to finance an experimental bank, and

2010
04:54:36.050 --> 04:54:55.290
Geoff Lomax - KK6IZS: that experimental bank is intended to fund projects in Oakland, Richmond, and other cities. So there's a huge opportunity cost here, because you're basically taking Berkeley funds, proposing to export them at a time when we're hearing about this human tragedy. Rather than endorsing this experimental bank.

2011
04:54:55.290 --> 04:55:14.390
Geoff Lomax - KK6IZS: you should be opposing this measure at this time, because we simply can't… we're hearing all this tragedy tonight, and you're endorsing a proposal that would take funds out of Berkeley for a purpose we don't even know is going to succeed. So please, change your position from endorsement to opposition. Thank you.

2012
04:55:15.560 --> 04:55:18.660
Boardroom: Thank you. Next is Kelvin Ward.

2013
04:55:22.960 --> 04:55:31.809
Kelvin Ward: Yes, good evening, Mayor, council members. My name is Kelvin Ward, I'm a regional organizer with Live Free California, and I…

2014
04:55:32.160 --> 04:55:43.149
Kelvin Ward: support the Mayor's proposed $200,000 reallocation to Live Free to close the fiscal year of 2027 funding gap.

2015
04:55:43.520 --> 04:55:49.079
Kelvin Ward: I want to thank you for investing in this work. I know this program is effective because I've…

2016
04:55:49.290 --> 04:55:53.429
Kelvin Ward: Led and supported community violence intervention efforts is both

2017
04:55:53.600 --> 04:55:57.089
Kelvin Ward: An organizer and advocate in, many cities.

2018
04:55:57.260 --> 04:56:14.530

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Kelvin Ward: And I've seen firsthand how intervention, mentorship, and trusted community relationships can change lives before violence occurs. This program more than pays for itself, so I respectfully ask you to support the mayor's reallocation. Thank you.

2019
04:56:15.220 --> 04:56:16.220
Boardroom: Thank you.

2020
04:56:17.160 --> 04:56:22.160
Boardroom: Okay, next is Teresa Gonzalez.

2021
04:56:25.960 --> 04:56:36.819
Teresa L. Gonzalez: Hello there, good evening, Madam Mayor, esteemed City Council members, and City Manager. My name is Teresa Gonzalez, and I am the State Director for Live Free California.

2022
04:56:36.820 --> 04:56:53.729
Teresa L. Gonzalez: And the Berkeley Gun Violence Intervention and Prevention Program with the city. I want to begin by expressing our profound gratitude, to Mayor Ishii, for her leadership and commitment in identifying $200,000, to close the FY27 funding gap.

2023
04:56:54.000 --> 04:57:06.290
Teresa L. Gonzalez: So Mayor Ishii, thank you. This decision reflects exactly the kind of courageous, values-driven leadership that Berkeley deserves, and has committed to including all of City Council who supported this initiative in its inception.

2024
04:57:06.620 --> 04:57:13.210
Teresa L. Gonzalez: We are respectfully, asking the full council to support this funding.

2025
04:57:13.340 --> 04:57:31.360
Teresa L. Gonzalez: And vote for it next week. I wanted to just remind everyone that the results of this program speak for themselves. In 2025, the second year of the pilot, we experienced zero fatal and zero non-fatal injury shootings, the first such year, marking history and even the pandemic.

2026
04:57:31.360 --> 04:57:32.140
Boardroom: Thank you.

2027
04:57:32.920 --> 04:57:34.789
Boardroom: Next is Kelly.

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2028
04:57:40.810 --> 04:57:42.110
Kelly's iPad: Can you hear me?

2029
04:57:42.520 --> 04:57:43.430
Boardroom: Yes.

2030
04:57:43.880 --> 04:57:44.720
Kelly's iPad: Okay.

2031
04:57:45.280 --> 04:58:03.730
Kelly's iPad: Just to add on to the comments about the small sites and all of the benefits for the people living them and having affordable housing, when we preserve buildings, we're also taking a sustainable action.

2032
04:58:04.080 --> 04:58:14.759
Kelly's iPad: by not tearing down housing that can be saved and used for affordable housing, so I'd like you also to keep sustainability in mind.

2033
04:58:15.310 --> 04:58:17.110
Kelly's iPad: When you look at this.

2034
04:58:17.680 --> 04:58:21.110
Kelly's iPad: It's a climate-friendly thing to do.

2035
04:58:21.320 --> 04:58:22.840
Kelly's iPad: Thank you, thank you.

2036
04:58:22.960 --> 04:58:24.010
Boardroom: Thanks, Kelly.

2037
04:58:24.540 --> 04:58:27.299
Boardroom: Next is Bryce Miller.

2038
04:58:29.940 --> 04:58:52.360
Bryce Miller: Good evening, Councilmembers and Mayor Ishii. My name is Bryce Miller. I'm a resident of Berkeley's District 4, and I'm a member of the Berkeley Tenants Union. I'm here tonight because I care deeply about keeping our communities intact, and I'm urging you to accept the HAC's recommendation to allocate $2.5 million for the Small Sites program in the upcoming budget.

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2039
04:58:52.360 --> 04:58:56.240
Bryce Miller: Small sites keeps affordable housing in community hands.

2040
04:58:56.240 --> 04:59:04.959
Bryce Miller: We're in a housing crisis, and small sites and programs like it are some of the only programs that can actually prevent displacement before it happens.

2041
04:59:05.170 --> 04:59:23.000
Bryce Miller: Small Sites helps people like my neighbors stay rooted here, but Small Sites is about more than just housing. It's about racial justice, economic justice, and climate justice. It protects families and our rights to stay. So please fund small sites and protect Measure U1 dollars for affordable housing. Thank you.

2042
04:59:23.180 --> 04:59:24.279
Boardroom: Thank you, Bryce.

2043
04:59:24.900 --> 04:59:30.550
Boardroom: Okay, next is… Avery Arbaugh?

2044
04:59:33.980 --> 04:59:38.650
Avery Arbaugh: Good evening, Councilmembers and Mayor. My name is Avery Arbaugh.

2045
04:59:38.710 --> 04:59:55.489
Avery Arbaugh: And I am chair of the Berkeley Tenants Union and head of the Berkeley Tenant Organizing Task Force. I'm here tonight to urge you to accept the HACC recommendation to allocate $2.5 million for the Small Sites program in the upcoming budget.

2046
04:59:55.840 --> 05:00:02.600
Avery Arbaugh: When Measure U1 was proposed by Council and passed by Berkeley residents at the ballot box.

2047
05:00:02.740 --> 05:00:04.859
Avery Arbaugh: It was passed with a promise.

2048
05:00:05.260 --> 05:00:15.310
Avery Arbaugh: that the funds would be used to create social and affordable housing. And by defunding small sites, this council would be breaking that promise.

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2049
05:00:15.380 --> 05:00:26.359
Avery Arbaugh: Especially in this moment of federal defunding of housing programs, it is more urgent than ever to expand the stock of permanently affordable housing through the Small Sites program.

2050
05:00:26.460 --> 05:00:32.479
Avery Arbaugh: I once again urge you to accept the HACS recommendation, and I thank you for your time.

2051
05:00:33.700 --> 05:00:34.760
Boardroom: Thank you, Avery.

2052
05:00:35.460 --> 05:00:37.720
Boardroom: Next is Sophia DeWitt.

2053
05:00:45.530 --> 05:01:03.570
Sophia DeWitt: Good morning, good morning, good evening, Council Members and Mayor. My name is Reverend Sophia DeWitt, Chief Program Officer at East Bay Housing Organizations. And as you know, we support affordable housing.

2054
05:01:03.800 --> 05:01:17.929
Sophia DeWitt: And I'm here tonight to, say that I'm in support of the HACC recommendation for $2.5 million for small sites. In the middle of, a funding

2055
05:01:18.560 --> 05:01:23.450
Sophia DeWitt: Reduction from the federal level, the city has to step up.

2056
05:01:23.810 --> 05:01:29.689
Sophia DeWitt: And, continue to fund, affordable housing.

2057
05:01:29.790 --> 05:01:42.839
Sophia DeWitt: And keep people in their homes. And Small Sites is, a program that, can do this, is already doing this. If you look at

2058
05:01:42.920 --> 05:01:52.700
Sophia DeWitt: examples like the California Street, tenants, and what they're doing, with their property, now that it.

2059
05:01:52.700 --> 05:01:55.339

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Boardroom: Thank you. Thank you, Sophia. Sure.

2060
05:01:56.440 --> 05:01:59.969
Boardroom: Last speaker is Live Free.

2061
05:02:00.340 --> 05:02:01.650
Boardroom: California.

2062
05:02:04.630 --> 05:02:10.630
Live Free California: Hello, everyone. My name is Santina Gonzalez. I'm a project manager with Live Free California.

2063
05:02:10.870 --> 05:02:22.420
Live Free California: I just want to say, you know, the National Institute for Temple Justice Reform, Nick Jr, has documented that a single fatal shooting cost Berkeley taxpayers $3.2 million.

2064
05:02:22.480 --> 05:02:31.610
Live Free California: In 2024, Berkeley had 3 fatal and 5 non-fatal shootings, which combined taxpayer costs of more than $13.3 million.

2065
05:02:31.630 --> 05:02:34.699
Live Free California: And in 2025, that cost was zero.

2066
05:02:34.700 --> 05:02:52.630
Live Free California: At $1 million annually, the GFIP delivered a 13 to 1 return on investment and avoided taxpayer costs alone, so the program really does pay for itself. Behind every one of those numbers is a life, a family, a community that doesn't have to deal with unimaginable grief.

2067
05:02:52.680 --> 05:03:07.460
Live Free California: And so we just want to say we are grateful for the fiscal year 27 commitment to Live Free California, and we are just asking this Council to take the next step, working with the mayor, the city manager, and our team to identify a sustainable million-dollar baseline for 27.

2068
05:03:07.460 --> 05:03:09.569
Boardroom: Thank you so much for your comment.

2069
05:03:10.530 --> 05:03:23.259

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Boardroom: That's it. Okay. So, it is 11.35, we have 10 minutes left in this meeting, I just want to get a sense from the Councilmember colleagues who else is planning to speak. So, I have 1, 2…

2070
05:03:23.420 --> 05:03:29.599
Boardroom: 3, 4… Sure. Okay, folks online, are you planning on speaking or saying anything else?

2071
05:03:30.170 --> 05:03:34.869
Boardroom: Okay, so we should extend till midnight, just in case, I think. Second.

2072
05:03:35.860 --> 05:03:41.820
Boardroom: Can we take the roll? To extend the meeting to 12 a.m, Councilmember Kesarwani?

2073
05:03:42.020 --> 05:03:42.620
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

2074
05:03:42.880 --> 05:03:48.909
Boardroom: Taplin? Yes. Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

2075
05:03:48.910 --> 05:03:49.600
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

2076
05:03:49.900 --> 05:03:55.479
Boardroom: Unapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mary Ishii? Yes.

2077
05:03:56.020 --> 05:04:07.859
Boardroom: Okay, motion carries. I like how you said 12 AM, just to, like, really make sure it was clear. Okay, so, Councilmember Taplin, go ahead. Thank you, and thanks, everyone.

2078
05:04:08.220 --> 05:04:11.440
Boardroom: I know that this ship has sailed, but…

2079
05:04:11.710 --> 05:04:24.529
Boardroom: I… I do have to preface this by saying I don't think it's wise to balance a budget on the assumption that the measure will pass. To correct course, we need to make… we need a sober and clear view into the streets before us.

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2080
05:04:24.660 --> 05:04:38.949
Boardroom: I applaud the Mayor's work to accommodate Council priorities. The prospect of layoffs, however, just doesn't sit right with me. These are people who show up day in and day out to serve the community. What I often hear from members of the public is a difficulty reconciling

2081
05:04:38.950 --> 05:04:46.729
Boardroom: Council's priorities and special projects with the reality of potential impacts and service disruption resulting from workforce reduction.

2082
05:04:46.840 --> 05:04:53.570
Boardroom: Public safety and core city services are the heart of our work as an organization, and they should be the last thing we cut.

2083
05:04:53.940 --> 05:05:09.230
Boardroom: There is still work to do to retain as many critical positions as possible. I know we're not voting tonight, but I will need to see a budget that also keeps the fire department positions in place and, to the extent possible, makeshold the city employees whose jobs are proposed for layoff.

2084
05:05:09.390 --> 05:05:11.589
Boardroom: layoffs. Lastly.

2085
05:05:11.770 --> 05:05:30.359
Boardroom: We do need to adopt some kind of policy around the use of council office salary savings. I recognize that discretion is charter officer prerogative, but respectfully, it is general fund, and during the budget crisis, I worry that by reverting to fiscal fiefdoms in order to support special projects, we risk inflicting iniquity.

2086
05:05:31.180 --> 05:05:32.580
Boardroom: Inequity, sorry.

2087
05:05:33.870 --> 05:05:39.310
Boardroom: and inequality. Thank you. Councilmember, Vice Member Tragub.

2088
05:05:40.320 --> 05:05:42.229
Boardroom: Thank you.

2089
05:05:42.410 --> 05:05:53.369

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Boardroom: I'd like to start off by, also thanking the mayor, with whom I had the deep honor of, working on the proposed budget.

2090
05:05:53.510 --> 05:05:55.570
Boardroom: And,

2091
05:05:55.770 --> 05:06:14.270
Boardroom: Just got to witness firsthand the incredible care that you put into every single line item, because you know, as we all do, that it's not… behind each of those line items are real people and real programs.

2092
05:06:14.640 --> 05:06:16.289
Boardroom: and real impact.

2093
05:06:17.130 --> 05:06:24.540
Boardroom: And of course, I want to express my deep gratitude to city staff and the city leadership.

2094
05:06:24.850 --> 05:06:29.719
Boardroom: And in particular, Paul, and David, and Monikar.

2095
05:06:29.970 --> 05:06:38.690
Boardroom: For diligently exploring every possible option for savings, cost recovery, and revenue generation.

2096
05:06:38.860 --> 05:06:44.199
Boardroom: I'm so grateful, in…

2097
05:06:44.350 --> 05:07:00.070
Boardroom: the way in which the city administration has approached this very difficult work with transparency and maintain consistent communication with city staff, leadership, and the Berkeley community throughout.

2098
05:07:02.690 --> 05:07:08.360
Boardroom: Moving on to… I just wanted to,

2099
05:07:08.830 --> 05:07:13.519
Boardroom: So I certainly support, the…

2100
05:07:14.090 --> 05:07:24.359

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Boardroom: the mayor's, budget. I just wanted to uplift, that we were able to,

2101
05:07:24.360 --> 05:07:37.319
Boardroom: preserve, some of my key, priorities, or, found… find a way to fund them through, some revenue transfers.

2102
05:07:37.630 --> 05:07:56.629
Boardroom: I… I'm looking forward to, the maintaining of a DBA outreach worker that lasts $2,000. We have a few possible pathways, one of which we might be bringing to the Council in the future.

2103
05:07:57.250 --> 05:07:59.950
Boardroom: on Live Free, I am…

2104
05:08:00.330 --> 05:08:22.780
Boardroom: 100% committed to, I support the approach of, finding a way to fund it for this coming fiscal year, and then looking for any and all opportunities to… for FI28, and, certainly lend my full support, to…

2105
05:08:22.780 --> 05:08:27.539
Boardroom: Helping you find, An approach to doing that.

2106
05:08:33.050 --> 05:08:40.319
Boardroom: I wanted to, just touch on the Small Sites program.

2107
05:08:41.220 --> 05:08:42.940
Boardroom: There are real costs.

2108
05:08:43.440 --> 05:08:47.560
Boardroom: to… People being put out on the streets.

2109
05:08:48.630 --> 05:09:01.789
Boardroom: I supported Measure U1 in 2016 because it was one of the most efficient and effective ways to preserve naturally occurring affordable housing.

2110
05:09:01.870 --> 05:09:11.650
Boardroom: and ensure that it is maintained in perpetuity, or near perpetuity, as affordable housing. And so, I support

2111
05:09:11.780 --> 05:09:18.919

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Boardroom: that part of the mayor's recommendation as well. I know it's not everything that the HAC recommended.

2112
05:09:18.950 --> 05:09:36.299
Boardroom: But it is a huge step forward and shows, the commitment that, I made when I was campaigning for Measure U1 in 2016, when I looked, voters in the eye and said, if you vote, for it,

2113
05:09:36.460 --> 05:09:45.329
Boardroom: the Council will, do what it can to appropriate it, as intended in the ballot measure.

2114
05:09:45.500 --> 05:09:53.170
Boardroom: I know that, there are ongoing efforts, to…

2115
05:09:53.320 --> 05:09:59.509
Boardroom: Preserve, the people that work so hard, day in and day out.

2116
05:09:59.720 --> 05:10:16.729
Boardroom: And I will continue to support those efforts. I have often said on the dice, I will say it again, people are our greatest, resource, and I appreciate, the city administration's

2117
05:10:16.900 --> 05:10:28.679
Boardroom: thoughtful approach, and we'll continue to support any which way to preserve as many positions as possible.

2118
05:10:28.990 --> 05:10:35.470
Boardroom: Lastly, I am troubled by the so-called Taxpayer Deception Act.

2119
05:10:35.630 --> 05:10:43.959
Boardroom: And, I'm working to bring something forward to, make certain our opposition of it. Thank you. Thank you.

2120
05:10:44.040 --> 05:10:55.959
Boardroom: Councilmember Bartlett. Thank you, Madam Mayor. And I want to thank you, and City Staff, City Manager, and yourself, and, and the Budget Committee people for such diligent work. This is very difficult.

2121
05:10:55.960 --> 05:11:10.079
Boardroom: Very hard, you know, they say a budget, it's a cliche, we all heard it, that a budget is a reflection of our city's values, right? And, all of our values are here, and they're all important. And all of our

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people are important, because they carry our values, and they themselves are valuable to us.

2122
05:11:10.130 --> 05:11:12.749
Boardroom: And, you know, this is one of those…

2123
05:11:13.100 --> 05:11:24.130
Boardroom: moments where we're faced with impossible decisions, and so, you know, I want to thank you for specifically your budget, Mrs. Mayor. Madam Mayor, Mrs. Mayor, Miss… you are married, Mrs.

2124
05:11:24.130 --> 05:11:38.829
Boardroom: Madam Mayor, and for my, this week, this, this last, this last chunk of days, I've had 3 calls and 3 visits that, that correspond directly to, 3 things in the budget that are super important to me, and one that needs to be beefed up.

2125
05:11:38.840 --> 05:11:48.769
Boardroom: I got a call from a constituent who… a new management company had taken over their building, and it's proceeding to basically take steps to move them out.

2126
05:11:48.770 --> 05:12:07.210
Boardroom: And do all those underhanded tricks we know that can happen, and they were terrified, so I had to go to another city and sit down with the owners of this company and let them know they're in Berkeley, and they're under my protection, and to watch yourself, right? And to do that. And so, you know, that was one thing, and so I think about small sites.

2127
05:12:07.360 --> 05:12:22.889
Boardroom: And their little building is a perfect candidate for this. It's naturally occurring affordable housing, and they could be brought into permanence and saved from displacement, which I also fought hard for U1 for this very purpose, and I ran for office.

2128
05:12:23.020 --> 05:12:40.809
Boardroom: for small sites. My very first campaign promise, I called it Homegrown Housing, was what is now called Small Sites, and it's something that's super important to me to maintain, the, the roots that people have in this community. And then I got another call, of course, when,

2129
05:12:40.870 --> 05:12:45.240
Boardroom: Someone that can sit… someone in my district was, was shot in the face.

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2130
05:12:45.850 --> 05:13:03.360
Boardroom: a young woman, shot in the face, 19-year-old woman. And so, people were scared, so I had to go see them, talk to them, try to calm them down, understand what's happening, and, you know, these programs, these intervention programs are valuable, they're important, and they save lives. They save dollars and lives.

2131
05:13:03.360 --> 05:13:14.670
Boardroom: And so, Live Free is super important, and it's something we fought for years to establish, this ceasefire-style program, and we're fortunate to have one now. And I tell you.

2132
05:13:14.980 --> 05:13:20.380
Boardroom: As the food becomes scarcer, as we talked about tonight earlier, the violence will increase.

2133
05:13:22.160 --> 05:13:24.749
Boardroom: with the head of it. But also.

2134
05:13:25.000 --> 05:13:28.430
Boardroom: The strenuous activity… the fire department!

2135
05:13:28.610 --> 05:13:33.630
Boardroom: Because when they have heart attacks, when they freak out, when they get injured, who's there?

2136
05:13:33.910 --> 05:13:35.030
Boardroom: BFT.

2137
05:13:35.850 --> 05:13:38.420
Boardroom: We've seen this repeatedly. And so…

2138
05:13:39.310 --> 05:13:48.840
Boardroom: There was a fire watch this weekend, a few days ago, and my neighbor, their kid is in camp, in the fire zone. They called me panicking.

2139
05:13:48.840 --> 05:14:04.890
Boardroom: So I had to call… James had to call up there and find out what's going on up there at the camp, if they had an escape… if the escape route planned, if they were prepared to defend these children in

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the event of a fire. And we all know there's only one way out up there, and we all know that we're due for a fire.

2140
05:14:05.240 --> 05:14:21.870
Boardroom: And we are definitely due for a big fire. And so, in the instance of… and the desire to preserve ourselves, our safety of our community, and our people, we've got to make sure we don't sacrifice the fire department. We need them now more than ever. And so…

2141
05:14:21.870 --> 05:14:44.089
Boardroom: you know, this is a snapshot in the service we give our people here in the last few days, and reflects adroatly on these three points here. The fire department, small sites, live free. And then, of course, our wonderful workers and other divisions and core services of the city, we need you as well, it's super important. And so, I support anything we can do to keep you in there for another year, at least.

2142
05:14:44.090 --> 05:14:46.969
Boardroom: To plan for the future, give you a little more time.

2143
05:14:46.970 --> 05:14:53.209
Boardroom: If need be, if we have to restructure, I understand that. But give somebody some time to plan for the future, because people have families.

2144
05:14:53.460 --> 05:14:54.390
Boardroom: Thank you.

2145
05:14:55.260 --> 05:14:57.250
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember Humbert.

2146
05:14:57.910 --> 05:15:15.890
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor, and I'll try to make my comments brief. I've appreciated all the things that my colleagues have said so far. I want to thank our budget manager, the city manager, the deputy city manager who's been in this so deeply.

2147
05:15:16.530 --> 05:15:18.229
Boardroom: You, Mayor Ishii.

2148
05:15:18.280 --> 05:15:29.320
Boardroom: the finance department and all the department heads who put so much work into what has been a very difficult budget. I know that all of

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you were called upon to make some incredibly difficult decisions and have had

2149
05:15:29.320 --> 05:15:44.619
Boardroom: you know, heartbreaking, hard conversations. I also want to express my gratitude for all of our city employees who've experienced a lot of heartache and stress as a result of this budget, and are still working hard to keep our city's services

2150
05:15:44.620 --> 05:15:46.679
Boardroom: Working and moving forward.

2151
05:15:46.770 --> 05:16:01.490
Boardroom: I know that it's cold comfort when you're facing increased workload, vacant positions, and absent colleagues, but please know that neither I nor anyone on this dais, I think, takes your dedication for granted. We do not.

2152
05:16:02.460 --> 05:16:21.500
Boardroom: I know that we're not taking a final vote, but overall, I support the City Manager's proposed budget and the Mayor's suggested savings and expenditures. I want to thank the Mayor for including me in her Budget Brown X Circle, and giving me the opportunity to share my candid opinions about the budget proposal.

2153
05:16:21.530 --> 05:16:34.939
Boardroom: Ahead of final adoption, I would certainly welcome city staff, constituents, community organizations, and others to communicate to my office their ideas for revenue, savings, or other changes to the budget.

2154
05:16:34.940 --> 05:16:42.400
Boardroom: There may yet be some change in the couch cushions and some coins in there, and I'd love to hear people's suggestions.

2155
05:16:42.450 --> 05:16:45.640
Boardroom: So thank you again to staff, and I look forward to

2156
05:16:45.800 --> 05:16:51.459
Boardroom: Looking at this more and more over the coming days, ahead of final adoption. Thank you.

2157
05:16:52.160 --> 05:16:54.880
Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember Lunapara.

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2158
05:16:56.010 --> 05:17:01.490
Boardroom: Thank you. I also want to thank the City Manager, the Deputy City Manager.

2159
05:17:01.490 --> 05:17:20.150
Boardroom: And the budget team, led by Budget Manager DePia, thank you so much. I also really want to thank the mayor for her very thoughtful proposal. I'm happy that we are moving toward a more sustainable, financially solvent budget moving forward by not overextending an already stressed general fund, and I believe that her proposal represents this.

2160
05:17:20.740 --> 05:17:39.949
Boardroom: I have one request. I think it would be really helpful if the City Manager could identify consultant studies in the queue that have not yet been encumbered and are no longer on RRV to bring back to Council for reconsideration. We sometimes receive studies a couple years after they were voted on that are no longer relevant or…

2161
05:17:39.950 --> 05:17:48.449
Boardroom: the Council might not necessarily prioritize anymore, or there's no longer funding available, and it would be great to get a list of those as part of budget consideration.

2162
05:17:50.390 --> 05:18:04.169
Boardroom: This has been an extremely stressful time for our city, and I think I can speak for many of us when I say that this is the hardest part of this work, and no one bears the stress more than the people who keep our city running every day. We see your work, and we are extremely grateful.

2163
05:18:04.360 --> 05:18:05.350
Boardroom: Thank you.

2164
05:18:05.590 --> 05:18:07.450
Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember O'Keefe.

2165
05:18:08.520 --> 05:18:11.360
Boardroom: Thank you, ms. Mayor.

2166
05:18:11.700 --> 05:18:20.300
Boardroom: Not Mrs. Not a mayor in this 1960s, come on. Or just Miss. We can do Ms. Mayor, not Mrs. Mayor.

2167

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05:18:20.430 --> 05:18:31.089
Boardroom: I've been holding onto that for a few minutes. I don't have a ton to say about this budget. I was, I'm grateful to have been a part of the mayor's Working Group on the budget, so I would say this,

2168
05:18:31.320 --> 05:18:46.589
Boardroom: what's being proposed, reflects my, my wishes, and I, I really want to thank her and her staff for all the work. They did. Most of the work, we had a lot of meetings and a lot of talk, a lot of discussions, but they really did work hard on this, and I, I think it actually just, it really, this budget.

2169
05:18:48.210 --> 05:18:56.960
Boardroom: really reflects… I actually told this to the mayor privately, I think, but, I want to say it in public, too. It really reflects strong leadership, the way you, really, like.

2170
05:18:57.530 --> 05:18:58.590
Boardroom: looked…

2171
05:18:58.820 --> 05:19:10.080
Boardroom: everywhere, really worked hard to try to, accommodate as many of our requests as possible, and spread it evenly around the districts, and I just, I think that's really good leadership, and I want to appreciate you for that.

2172
05:19:10.920 --> 05:19:16.840
Boardroom: I also want to appreciate you and all of us, and including, and especially city staff,

2173
05:19:17.100 --> 05:19:24.870
Boardroom: this has already been said a few times, but it's important, and I want to say it too, that this is such hard work that we,

2174
05:19:26.800 --> 05:19:31.500
Boardroom: This is the work… I mean, I don't want to… I'm not trying to trash other previous councils, I wasn't there, but…

2175
05:19:31.800 --> 05:19:40.649
Boardroom: this is… this is the work that's needed to be done. We need… we need to make our budget sustainable, and that's very, very hard, and I'm really proud that we're doing it.

2176
05:19:40.910 --> 05:19:53.690

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Boardroom: I'm really proud to be part of this council, doing this work, as painful as it is, and I just want to say, again, thank you so much for, in a David White, you've done a huge amount of this lift, and all of… a lot of, Marikar and Paul, too.

2177
05:19:53.690 --> 05:20:03.099
Boardroom: Just, you've worked so hard to make this happen, and it's just… it's been awful, and it's gonna keep being awful, but it's so important, and I'm just so proud of all of us. I really wanted to say that.

2178
05:20:03.270 --> 05:20:16.420
Boardroom: And then, lastly, I just wanted to clear up, we have this, Solano stroll item, I just wanted to give people a little context about where that is. I think we're gonna take no action on that, is, I think, the most appropriate,

2179
05:20:16.600 --> 05:20:19.820
Boardroom: way to deal with that, because, the mayor's,

2180
05:20:19.820 --> 05:20:37.159
Boardroom: already included a nice allocation for it, and in case anybody's worried about it, the numbers in the Solano Stroll item were very big, and I do want to make something… make other council members and the public aware of something, which is that because of the nature of this tight budget that we're dealing with now.

2181
05:20:37.160 --> 05:20:41.980
Boardroom: We can no longer kind of be hand-wavy around the true staff costs.

2182
05:20:41.980 --> 05:20:48.259
Boardroom: And that was the feedback I got from the city manager. And so, this budget actually… or this item.

2183
05:20:48.260 --> 05:21:03.340
Boardroom: includes the actual cost, including staff, overtime, and a lot of other expenses. So it is quite expensive. It's also, I want to say, it's the largest street fair in the East Bay, and it attracts 250,000 people, which is twice… more than twice the population of Berkeley.

2184
05:21:03.340 --> 05:21:08.909
Boardroom: If you think about that. So it's a really, really big deal. It brings a lot, a lot of value to our city.

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2185
05:21:08.910 --> 05:21:30.769
Boardroom: To our nonprofits, get to reach a lot of people, a lot of economic value, and it's just a wonderful, important cultural event, celebrating its 50th anniversary this year. So I'm really grateful that we're able to, not ignore it, you know, we're not funding it fully, but I have a D13 item, and the, Solano Avenue Association is gonna fundraise, and of course, Albany is also paying some. We had an Albany council member here.

2186
05:21:30.770 --> 05:21:39.850
Boardroom: So, I just want to say, you know, we're making it work all together, and I, I'm glad that, it's been included in this budget, and so I'm happy to take no action on my…

2187
05:21:39.850 --> 05:21:53.340
Boardroom: Do you want to make that motion? Oh, sure. Oh yeah, that's the only thing we have to decide on, right? Yeah. We do have to… Okay, I will move to take no action on my beloved… Second item. Can we… can we take the roll on that, please?

2188
05:21:53.340 --> 05:21:58.050
Boardroom: Okay. On 40B, to take no action, Councilmember Kisarwani?

2189
05:21:58.050 --> 05:21:58.800
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

2190
05:21:58.990 --> 05:22:04.480
Boardroom: Kaplan? Aye. Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Lackaby?

2191
05:22:04.480 --> 05:22:05.180
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

2192
05:22:05.670 --> 05:22:15.550
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mary Ishii? Yes. Okay, motion carries. Thank you. So I just have a few brief comments, and then, we, we have to finish. So,

2193
05:22:15.630 --> 05:22:40.300
Boardroom: just want folks to understand that, yes, we were looking at Council priorities, but Council priorities also included focusing more on unfilled positions and not cutting staff, so please be aware that, that that is something that we also were looking through. As Councilmember Kesarwani had stated, we also were looking over in our budget, process to try to look at unfilled positions more than

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2194
05:22:40.300 --> 05:22:41.960
Boardroom: than filled positions.

2195
05:22:41.960 --> 05:23:03.459
Boardroom: And, that also, I wanted to make sure it was really clear that not only has my staff been looking at revenue and other sources of revenue, because we don't believe that it's just about making cuts, we need to be finding funding in other places, that, that also, of course, the city staff have been looking at that quite a lot, and I don't think we got to spend very much time on it, but just wanted to make sure that was clear. And then also, just to thank

2196
05:23:03.460 --> 05:23:19.330
Boardroom: Of course, our city staff, again, so much for all of the work that they've done to go into this budget, and thank you so much to the city manager, who has really worked to help make sure that our city staff understand what's happening and where the process is. And just… you are someone who really leads with

2197
05:23:19.580 --> 05:23:23.249
Boardroom: So much compassion, and that is just…

2198
05:23:23.840 --> 05:23:29.409
Boardroom: Probably the, in my mind, the most important, really the most important,

2199
05:23:30.630 --> 05:23:38.500
Boardroom: skill, talent, ability characteristic that you should have as a leader, and I really want to thank you so much for your leadership. Yeah. Thank you.

2200
05:23:38.700 --> 05:23:41.039
Boardroom: Alright, and

2201
05:23:41.610 --> 05:23:51.320
Boardroom: I will… I know we have to have non-agenda public comment, I just realized, hopefully we have enough time for that. Is there anyone who has off-agenda public comment?

2202
05:23:54.650 --> 05:23:59.660
Boardroom: One hand raised. Yeah, this, this will be really quick.

2203

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05:23:59.860 --> 05:24:12.780
Boardroom: So, as, Councilor Lena Parra and Mayor Ishii, two unhoused men, just told me last week that they thought, Sacred Rest was understaffed or something because it's not.

2204
05:24:13.340 --> 05:24:26.069
Boardroom: open the hours that it's posted. Sometimes they find it's very erratic, so I hope as you bring this item forward, you can address that. Thank you. Thank you. Thanks, Carol. I think there's one online as well. Yes.

2205
05:24:29.930 --> 05:24:31.650
Boardroom: Collar? Yeah, go ahead.

2206
05:24:32.810 --> 05:24:36.719
1510****000: Well, I wish you a great, time with the city.

2207
05:24:36.880 --> 05:24:38.120
1510****000: budget.

2208
05:24:38.220 --> 05:24:42.519
1510****000: I'd like to mention that our great business contributed at least a million dollars, probably more.

2209
05:24:43.110 --> 05:24:46.350
1510****000: To the city over the last 53 years.

2210
05:24:46.630 --> 05:24:54.490
1510****000: what I'd like to make a point about what is happening by the monstrosity in the White House. It is awful.

2211
05:24:54.570 --> 05:24:59.020
1510****000: That war against Iran was illegal, it's criminal, and look what happened.

2212
05:24:59.090 --> 05:25:18.999
1510****000: He killed tens of thousands of Iranians. Meanwhile, the Gazakh genocide is going on. At least half a million Palestinians were killed by this criminal, war criminal, Netanyahu, bloodthirsty criminal, not only for war criminals, actual criminals. He stole money even from his servants.

2213
05:25:19.330 --> 05:25:36.719

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1510****000: Have a good night. We are living in a very bad time. We are going forward in a really bad time. I'm very scared. Good luck to all of you. Have a good night. Love to hear from any of you. I would love to hear from Mayor Ishii, City Councilmember. Let us talk. Let us talk. Have a good night.

2214
05:25:36.720 --> 05:25:39.930
Boardroom: Thank you so much. Alright, is there a motion to adjourn? So, second.

2215
05:25:40.380 --> 05:25:50.830
Boardroom: Can we take the roll on adjournment, please? Okay. To adjourn, Councilmember Kesarwani.

2216
05:25:52.410 --> 05:25:53.380
Rashi Kesarwani: Yes.

2217
05:25:53.380 --> 05:25:59.700
Boardroom: Yes. Taplin? Aye. Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye. O'Keefe?

2218
05:25:59.830 --> 05:26:01.970
Boardroom: Yes. Lackabee?

2219
05:26:01.970 --> 05:26:02.570
Brent Blackaby: S.

2220
05:26:02.770 --> 05:26:12.999
Boardroom: Unapara? Yes. Humber? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes. Okay. Alright, we are adjourned. Thank you so much. Thank you, everyone. Thank you all for staying late.

2221
05:26:14.990 --> 05:26:16.350
Boardroom: I wouldn't say it does.

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